

PAKISTAN:

Millions of IDPs and returnees face continuing crisis

A profile of the internal displacement situation

2 December, 2009

This Internal Displacement Profile is automatically generated from the online IDP database of the Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre (IDMC). It includes an overview of the internal displacement situation in the country prepared by the IDMC, followed by a compilation of excerpts from relevant reports by a variety of different sources. All headlines as well as the bullet point summaries at the beginning of each chapter were added by the IDMC to facilitate navigation through the Profile. Where dates in brackets are added to headlines, they indicate the publication date of the most recent source used in the respective chapter. The views expressed in the reports compiled in this Profile are not necessarily shared by the Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre. The Profile is also available online at www.internal-displacement.org.

About the Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre

The Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre, established in 1998 by the Norwegian Refugee Council, is the leading international body monitoring conflict-induced internal displacement worldwide.

Through its work, the Centre contributes to improving national and international capacities to protect and assist the millions of people around the globe who have been displaced within their own country as a result of conflicts or human rights violations.

At the request of the United Nations, the Geneva-based Centre runs an online database providing comprehensive information and analysis on internal displacement in some 50 countries.

Based on its monitoring and data collection activities, the Centre advocates for durable solutions to the plight of the internally displaced in line with international standards.

The Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre also carries out training activities to enhance the capacity of local actors to respond to the needs of internally displaced people. In its work, the Centre cooperates with and provides support to local and national civil society initiatives.

For more information, visit the Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre website and the database at www.internal-displacement.org.

Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre

Norwegian Refugee Council
Chemin de Balexert 7-9
1219 Geneva, Switzerland
Tel.: +41 22 799 07 00
idmc@nrc.ch
www.internal-displacement.org

CONTENTS

OVERVIEW.....6

MILLIONS OF IDPS AND RETURNEES FACE CONTINUING CRISIS 6

CAUSES AND BACKGROUND 14

DISPLACEMENT IN FATA 14

BAJAUR AND MOHMAND (OCTOBER 2009) 14

KHYBER AGENCY (SEPTEMBER 2009) 14

WAZIRISTAN (NOVEMBER 2009) 14

DISPLACEMENT IN NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE 16

DISPLACEMENT IN NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE (JULY 2009) 16

EXTREMISTS SEIZE CONTROL IN SWAT VALLEY IN THE NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE
(NOVEMBER 2007)..... 17

ARMED CONFLICT BETWEEN EXTREMISTS AND THE ARMY DISPLACES HUNDREDS OF
THOUSANDS (DECEMBER 2007)..... 18

DISPLACEMENT IN WAZIRISTAN..... 18

RENEWED CONFLICT IN NORTH WAZIRISTAN DISPLACES TENS OF THOUSANDS (OCTOBER
2008) 18

CLASHES BETWEEN ARMY AND MILITANTS IN SOUTH WAZIRISTAN DISPLACE THOUSANDS
(MARCH 2008)..... 20

HUNT FOR PRO-TALIBAN MILITANTS HAS DISPLACED THOUSANDS (MAY 2006)..... 21

DISPLACEMENT IN BALOCHISTAN 23

CONFLICT ONGOING IN BALOCHISTAN THOUGH MOMENTUM DECLINES (JANUARY 2008)..... 23

BACKGROUND: THE CONFLICT BETWEEN BALOCH TRIBES AND THE GOVERNMENT IS
DEEPENING (SEPTEMBER 2006) 24

FIGHTING BETWEEN SEPARATIST GROUPS AND THE ARMY HAS DISPLACED TENS OF
THOUSANDS (JULY 2006) 27

INTER-TRIBAL FEUDING FUELS MORE CONFLICT IN THE REGION (JUNE 2006) 28

DISPLACEMENT OF HINDUS 30

HINDUS IN BALOCHISTAN TARGETED AND DISPLACED (JANUARY 2006) 30

SECONDARY DISPLACEMENT 32

SECONDARY DISPLACEMENT (OCTOBER 2009) 32

SECTARIAN VIOLENCE..... 32

SECTARIAN VIOLENCE IS ON THE INCREASE, MINORITIES ARE VULNERABLE (APRIL 2006)..... 32

POPULATION FIGURES AND PROFILE 34

GLOBAL FIGURES 34

GLOBAL FIGURES (2009) 34

TENS OF THOUSANDS HAVE FLED CONFLICT, BUT NO ESTIMATE AVAILABLE ON TOTAL NUMBER
OF IDPS IN THE COUNTRY (APRIL 2008) 37

GEOGRAPHICAL DISTRIBUTION	37
HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS ESTIMATED TO BE SHORT-TERM IDPs IN NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE (FEBRUARY 2008)	37
TENS OF THOUSANDS DISPLACED IN NORTH AND SOUTH WAZIRISTAN FROM OCTOBER 2007 TO JANUARY 2008 (FEBRUARY 2008)	39
THOUSANDS REPORTED DISPLACED DUE TO FIGHTING IN NORTH WAZIRISTAN (MARCH 2006)	40
DIFFERING ESTIMATES OF DISPLACEMENT DUE TO CONFLICT IN BALOCHISTAN (APRIL 2008)	41
DISPLACEMENT OF HINDUS IN PAKISTAN (MAY 2004)	42
 <u>PATTERNS OF DISPLACEMENT</u>	 44
 GENERAL	 44
DISPLACEMENT IN NWFP, MALAKAND DIVISION (2009)	44
KHYBER AGENCY IDPs (SEPTEMBER 2009)	44
BAJAUR AND MOHMAND IDPs TO NOWSHERA (NOVEMBER 2009)	45
WAZIRI IDPs TO DI KHAN, TANK, ZHOB, BANNU, AND KARACHI (NOVEMBER 2009)	45
NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE/SWAT VALLEY: CIVILIANS FLEE TO OTHER PARTS OF SWAT AND NWFP (APRIL 2008)	45
WAZIRISTAN: IDPs FLEE AIR STRIKES AND ARTILLERY SHELLING (FEBRUARY 2008)	46
BALOCHISTAN: TENS OF THOUSANDS REMAIN DISPLACED (JUNE 2007)	48
BALOCHISTAN: CIVILIANS FLED TO SECURE AREAS OF BALOCHISTAN AS WELL AS TO THE SINDH AND PUNJAB PROVINCES	49
 <u>PHYSICAL SECURITY & FREEDOM OF MOVEMENT</u>	 50
 GENERAL	 50
GENERAL (NOVEMBER 2009)	50
BALOCHISTAN: LANDMINE ACCIDENTS ON THE INCREASE IN VIOLENCE AFFECTED AREAS	55
 <u>SUBSISTENCE NEEDS</u>	 57
 GENERAL	 57
FOOD (OCTOBER 2009)	57
SHELTER (NOVEMBER 2009)	58
HEALTH (OCTOBER 2009)	60
ACCESS TO EDUCATION (OCTOBER 2009)	65
NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE/SWAT VALLEY: IDPs UNABLE TO ACCESS RELIEF CAMP (APRIL 2008)	66
WAZIRISTAN: NEED FOR SHELTER, FOOD, MEDICINE (MARCH 2008)	67
BALOCHISTAN: DISPLACED REPORTED TO BE LIVING UNDER EXTREMELY DIFFICULT CONDITIONS (JUNE 2007)	68
 <u>PATTERNS OF RETURN AND RESETTLEMENT</u>	 71
 GENERAL	 71
GENERAL (JULY 2009)	71

NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE/SWAT VALLEY: MANY DISPLACED RETURN SOON AFTER END TO ARMED CONFLICT (DECEMBER 2007)	71
WAZIRISTAN: ROADS BEING OPENED CLEAR WAY FOR RETURN OF DISPLACED (APRIL 2008)	72
BALCOHISTAN: CONFLICTING INFORMATION ON NUMBER OF RETURNS (OCTOBER 2007)	73
ACCESS TO BASIC NECESSITIES IN AREAS OF RETURN	74
FOOD (OCTOBER 2009)	74
INFRASTRUCTURE (OCTOBER 2009)	75
 <u>HUMANITARIAN ACCESS</u>	 <u>77</u>
 HUMANITARIAN ACCESS TO CONFLICT AFFECTED AREAS.....	77
HUMANITARIAN ACCESS (NOVEMBER 2009).....	77
HUMANITARIAN ACCESS LIMITED BY GOVERNMENT AND DUE TO INSECURITY (APRIL 2008) ...	79
BALUCHISTAN: HUMANITARIAN ACCESS TO CONFLICT AFFECTED POPULATIONS DENIED (JULY 2006)	80
WAZIRISTAN: NO HUMANITARIAN ACCESS TO THE CIVILIAN POPULATION AFTER ARMY OPERATIONS (SEPTEMBER 2004)	81
 <u>NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL RESPONSES</u>	 <u>82</u>
 NATIONAL	82
NATIONAL RESPONSE (NOVEMBER 2009)	82
AD-HOC PROVINCIAL RESPONSE IN NORTH WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE AND WAZIRISTAN (MARCH 2008).....	85
INTERNATIONAL	86
HUMANITARIAN COMMUNITY (NOVEMBER 2009)	86
SLOW FUNDING (NOVEMBER 2009)	87
INTERNATIONAL AND NATIONAL AGENCIES DENIED ACCESS TO DISPLACED IN BALUCHISTAN AND WAZIRISTAN (MARCH 2008)	91
 <u>LIST OF SOURCES USED.....</u>	 <u>93</u>

OVERVIEW

Millions of IDPs and returnees face continuing crisis

The ongoing wave of displacement in Pakistan is the single largest population movement recorded in the country since it was created in 1947. Under pressure to tackle the militancy which has taken root in the country, the government has launched successive military offensives in the past months across several districts of North West Frontier Province (NWFP), including Swat, and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA), including Mohmand, Bajaur, and South Waziristan.

The scale and geographic spread of the displacement, the fact that up to 90 per cent of internally displaced people (IDPs) sought shelter with host families, and registration and access problems have made it difficult to evaluate the total number of IDPs. In early July 2009 there were between 2.7 and 3.5 million IDPs in NWFP alone, and 30 camps were operating across the Province. However, most were anxious to return to their home areas as soon as fighting had moved on, and in November the UN estimated around 1.25 million people were still displaced. In FATA districts of Dera Ismail Khan and Tank, no camps have been set up to date, though UNHCR has distributed tents to families hosting IDPs.

However, conditions facing many returnees have not allowed them to become self-reliant again, and there are reports that IDP figures have been underestimated, particularly in FATA. In any event, IDP numbers alone do not reflect the total number of people who will require assistance to become self-reliant again.

The international community has struggled to respond to this huge displacement. Many aid agencies had to divert resources from development programmes. Funds for elements of the international humanitarian response have been committed and distributed with varying speed and to varying extents. By early July, when IDPs in NWFP started going home, only one third of the amount requested through the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan had been funded, but by November funding stood at 70 per cent.

Problems with access to conflict areas and wider insecurity have hampered humanitarian efforts. In November 2009, in response to deadly attacks in Peshawar, Rawalpindi and Islamabad, the UN applied stringent restrictions on the operations of international staff.

With reports of entire villages destroyed in NWFP, winter presenting new challenges, and no end in sight to the current military operation, there seems little room to hope that the growing needs of the displaced will be solved any time soon.

General background

Since 2001, displacement in Pakistan has been linked to clashes between the armed forces and militant groups fighting for territorial control of regions near the border with Afghanistan. The North West Frontier Province (NWFP) and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA) have been the scene of continuing displacement. For example, in July 2007, violent clashes for control over the Swat District in NWFP caused the displacement of hundreds of thousands of civilians.

In Baluchistan, violence and displacement are reportedly linked to another militant group, sometimes described as the Baluchistan Liberation Army, which aims to establish an independent

Baluchi state. By May 2008, up to 60,000 people had been displaced as a result of fighting in Baluchistan (IRIN, 5 July 2009). In November 2009, recent figures for internally displaced people (IDPs) in Baluchistan were unavailable, though reports indicated ongoing violence, assassinations and kidnapping (IDSA, 5 October 2009).

Displacement in 2009

North West Frontier Province

The wave of displacement in NWFP which began in February 2009 is unprecedented in terms of its size and geographical spread. Up to three million people fled the districts of Swat, Shangla, Buner, Lower and Upper Dir after army operations designed to clear the areas of militants, and sought refuge in Mardan, Peshawar, Charsadda, Swabi, Nowshera, Abbottabad, Battagram, and Haripur (Swat Youth Front, 2009; Oxfam, Missing Pieces, 1 October 2009). They began to return in early July upon indications that the fighting had moved on. Many IDPs were eager to return in time for Ramadan, but many reportedly returned to encounter ongoing insecurity, curfews, and the destruction of infrastructure and means of livelihoods. In some cases, IDPs returned to camps to receive food packages, prompting aid agencies to shift resources to areas of origin (OCHA, 4 September 2009). Although there are currently no figures indicating the extent of the problem, there have been numerous reports of secondary displacement of IDPs.

Federally Administered Tribal Areas

In November 2008, a government-led military offensive against militants led to displacement in Bajaur and Mohmand Agencies, located in FATA. The UN estimated in October 2009 that up to 750,000 IDPs from Bajaur and Mohmand had been living in camps for the past year (IRC, 13 October 2009). In addition, up to 100,000 people reportedly fled the fighting in Khyber Agency in the first two weeks of September 2009 (IRIN, 16 September 2009). The vast majority stayed with host families or in rented accommodation (OCHA, 17 September 2009).

From October to November 2009, up to 428,000 civilians fled a second government offensive in South Waziristan, over half of that Agency's population, and most registered in Dera Ismail Khan (DI Khan) and Tank (OCHA, 27 November 2009). There are also concerns that fighting, military roadblocks, and lack of resources have prevented other civilians from leaving the areas of conflict. Aid agencies, including the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) had as of November been denied access since government forces started their offensive in the area on 17 October.

No camps were set up in DI Khan or Tank, and IDPs sought shelter and assistance with relatives, host families, or in rented accommodation. In late October, 17,000 IDPs displaced from FATA had also been registered to the north in Bannu District in NWFP, and to the south in Zhob District, Baluchistan. However, November reports indicated that most of these IDPs were on their way to DI Khan and Tank (OCHA, 5 November 2009). There were also reports that some IDPs were moving towards big cities such as Karachi (IRIN, 17 November 2009).

While it is customary for Waziris to spend winters in the milder southern districts of NWFP, there have been reports of tensions between IDPs and host communities in DI Khan and Tank. Many of the displaced from South Waziristan are from the Mehsud tribe to which reported Taliban militants Baitullah and Hakimullah Mehsud belong, and hundreds of civilians have died over the past year in attacks targeting Mehsud fighters (The News, 10 April 2009).

Security in areas of displacement and return

IDPs from the conflict-affected areas in NWFP started returning to their areas of origin in July, when reports suggested they had been cleared of militants. Fears were voiced over the safety of returnees, and some questioned whether the returns were voluntary. Many IDPs, although eager to return in time for Ramadan, may not have fully grasped or been informed of the risks entailed. Indeed, many IDPs were forced to move once again as a result of ongoing violence (ICRC, 6 October 2009).

Landmines and other unexploded devices are also a serious cause for concern. Several initiatives have been put in place to raise awareness within the IDP population. The UN-led Protection Cluster has distributed materials on mine risks in government schools (OCHA, 1 October 2009). In February, a tented hospital was set up in Peshawar to deal specifically with weapon-wounded victims, who by May already numbered in the hundreds, most of them civilians (ICRC, 18 May 2009).

Safety is not only a concern for returning IDPs, and other areas have faced ongoing security problems. An October attack in a crowded market in Peshawar, which until then had been a safe haven for many fleeing the violence, claimed at least 120 lives and wounded hundreds, mostly women and children. In October, there were also attacks in Islamabad, Rawalpindi and Lahore.

Up to 80 per cent of the IDPs are children. Many men stayed behind in the zones of conflict to watch over their houses (UNICEF, 8 July 2009). There were reports of orphans caught in the fighting being led by their teachers to security (UNICEF, 1 June 2009).

Access to basic necessities

Food

In June, over 20,000 metric tonnes of food was distributed to IDPs in camps and host communities (OCHA, 3 July 2009). From August to October, the Food Security Cluster distributed 4,600 tonnes of food to over 190,000 people in DI Khan and Tank Districts.

Humanitarian food assistance will be required at least throughout the winter. Pakistanis were already facing a food crisis due to the increase in prices over the two past years. Recent reports indicate that IDPs arriving at Jalozai camp in NWFP had initially stayed with host families but left as resources were depleted (UNHCR, 6 November 2009). Displacement interfered with the harvesting season and so food shortages are likely at the onset of winter. The government estimates the total wheat deficit at 82 per cent, with nearly 420,000 tonnes required to cover the population's estimated needs for the next 12 months.

Shelter

Hospitality, particularly in times of need, is a particular feature of Pashtun society (ICRC, 23 October 2009). Indeed, IDPs have overwhelmingly sought the support of their extended families and friends. Others were sheltered by complete strangers, sometimes for a fee. As a result, humanitarian assistance has progressively shifted towards support to hosting families.

In April and May, close to 90 per cent of IDPs in Malakand division sought shelter with hosts. As there are no camps in DI Khan and Tank, almost all Waziri IDPs are living with hosts, and in November tents were due to be distributed to families staying with hosts in these areas (UNHCR, 6 November 2009).

Many IDPs sought shelter in schools, because concrete infrastructures offered a better protection against the stifling summer heat than tents. In July 2009, a UNICEF goodwill ambassador

reported that at the Government Higher Secondary School in Takker, 110 families from Swat (some 700 people) were sharing three toilets.

Health

Due to the damage caused to health care infrastructure in areas of return, the shortage of supplies, and the limited access of aid agencies as a result of the security situation, most of the weapon-wounded have not received appropriate care. Accounts have been given of civilians with life-threatening wounds walking long distances in order to receive treatment (MSF, 29 June 2009).

The provision of safe drinking water was disrupted in conflict areas, which led across NWFP to severe outbreaks of waterborne diseases including severe diarrhoea, scabies, gastroenteritis and dysentery. There are also reports of a rising number of malaria cases and of acute respiratory tract infections in children, with upper respiratory tract infections the leading cause for medical consultations across all areas (WHO, 30 October 2009).

Aid agencies responded by providing purifying aqua tabs, and conducting anti-malaria spraying campaigns. However, due to the size of the displaced population, and the fact that so many are living with host communities, they have faced an ongoing challenge to reach people.

Since mid-October, limited resources have had to also cover the needs of IDPs in DI Khan and Tank, where supplies of medicine, equipment and personnel are urgently needed. One in seven IDPs originating from South Waziristan is said to be suffering from acute malnutrition, and outbreaks of respiratory infections and diarrhoea are also feared (Merlin, 30 October).

Agencies have conducted vaccination campaigns in all affected areas: 180,000 children from South Waziristan were vaccinated against measles, and just over 50,000 have received polio vaccinations (IRIN 26 October 2009; OCHA, 24 October 2009 and 5 November 2009). However, in areas where there is poor water, sanitation, and hygiene, children need more than ten doses to develop immunity (UNICEF, 29 October 2009).

IDPs are also displaying signs of trauma, anxiety, and depression. Islamic Relief (IR) has reported that 70 per cent of the children are displaying signs of trauma (IR, NWFP Emergency Appeal, 2009). There is a shortage of medical staff with technical expertise and language skills to respond to the situation. IR has recruited teachers amongst the local population, and trains them to deliver basic psychological support.

From the outset of the crisis, an insufficient number of female health care workers affected the provision of services to female patients. The lack of trained women in camps significantly hampered operations, given that the vast majority of IDPs were women and small children. In DI Khan and Tank, female health care workers are being trained to assist pregnant women and those with young children (OCHA, 5 November 2009).

Without access, little can be done to assist hospitals in conflict-affected areas, which deal with the weapon-wounded on a daily basis. As of October, ICRC did not have access to South Waziristan, but provided supplies to meet the needs of local doctors (ICRC, 29 October 2009).

Access to basic necessities in return areas

There is substantial damage to infrastructure in areas of return; in Malakand Division of NWFP, water services have been disrupted and hospitals destroyed. According to the government, 77 hospitals across NWFP were in need of repair in October, and at the onset of winter, the infrastructure necessary to deal with the likely outbreaks of communicable diseases was not in

place (communication with Permanent Mission of Pakistan to the UN, Geneva, 29 October 2009). As of November, it is difficult to quantify the damage in South Waziristan, but the violent fighting suggests that the situation there could be even worse, and the already poor pastoral communities, many of whom will have lost their livestock, will be reduced to living in miserable conditions.

Returnees in NWFP have faced ongoing food shortages. Fighting and displacement disrupted the harvest, and ongoing fighting and insecurity have prevented the planting of crops, which usually takes place in October. Markets have been suspended or closed, and curfews put in place (IR, 31 July 2009). Aid agencies set up food distribution points in the areas of return, after they noticed that IDPs who had left the camps were returning to pick up their food rations (OCHA, 4 September 2009). ICRC is set to oversee a recovery programme aimed at kick-starting local agriculture and promoting self-reliance. 315,000 people in Dir and Buner will receive wheat seed and fertilizer, and ICRC will assist the recipients until the May harvest (ICRC, 5 November 2009).

Education

As a result of the conflict, schools require rebuilding, teaching staff and programmes need to be put in place, and there is an overall shortage of school supplies. Across the three districts hit by the heaviest fighting in NWFP, 600,000 children are reported to have missed up to a year of school (Dawn, 30 July 2009). In early July, as IDPs started on their journey home, the UN warned that up to a million children could face disruption to their education.

Over 4,800 schools were occupied by IDPs across the hosting districts. By early October, 1,500 schools had been rehabilitated, while work was in progress on almost 1,300 more (OCHA, 1 October 2009). In the meantime, the Education Cluster provided mobile schools, learning kits and psychological assistance to displaced children. There is still an urgent need for educational supplies and temporary shelters to house schools.

As for the schools in conflict-affected districts, the government has reported that over 750 schools in Dir and Malakand housed IDPs. Over 400 schools were damaged, 230 of them in Swat. In areas of return, many schools remain closed because of the poor security situation. In South Waziristan, only a third of all children were enrolled in primary school in October; efforts were underway in Tank and DI Khan to provide supplies (UNICEF, 23 October 2009).

Government response

At the onset of the crisis in NWFP, the government set up the temporary Emergency Response Unit, and released \$10 million to cater to the needs of the displaced population. A specific IDP website was created to provide information to IDPs. As well as setting up camps, the government offered cash assistance whereby every displaced family was to receive Rs.5,000 (around \$60). The government decided to review entitlement when problems such as multiple registrations became apparent, and re-registered IDPs to verify their actual numbers (OCHA, 17 September 2009) and obtain a unified list (The Nation, 16 July 2009).

Successfully verified IDPs received cash cards with which they could withdraw money and buy the items they needed the most. By mid-July, approximately Rs.2.4 billion (\$29 million) had already been drawn out by over 145,000 families (The Nation, 16 July 2009). The cash-card system was praised as a more appropriate form of relief than the traditional food and non-food assistance provided by aid agencies. Indeed, where most IDPs were living with host families in and around towns and cities, the system allowed them to buy the goods they most needed from readily accessible shops (Oxfam, Millions of displaced Pakistanis, October 2009).

However, the system may not have benefited all those in need. Concerns were voiced that the registration and verification procedures did not recognise many female-headed households, while those who had lost their ID cards were unable to register to receive their food entitlements (OCHA, 11 September 2009). In addition, only those from areas deemed affected by the conflict have been eligible to register as IDPs, creating a protection gap for other vulnerable groups. Aid agencies are keen for the registration criterion to be changed from being area-based to needs-based (OCHA, 5 November 2009). In mid-September the government put a hold on the distribution of cash cards, whilst promising that all those registered and verified at that point would nevertheless receive their cards (OCHA, 1 October 2009).

Out of the estimated 428,000 IDPs in South Waziristan by November 2009, only around 165,000 have been verified. The government has indicated that it has already disbursed Rs.2.5 billion (\$30 million) to IDPs in Waziristan. Each family is due to receive credits of Rs.5,000 (\$60) a month (IRIN, 22 October 2009; Dawn 26 October 2009), and Rs.25,000 (\$300) upon return. In order to avoid a repeat of the multiple-registration problem in NWFP, the Provincial Relief, Rehabilitation and Settlement Authority which the government set up in July has urged displaced families not to register more than once (www.helpidp.org, accessed 29 October 2009).

The government has predicted that the reconstruction of just Malakand Division in NWFP will cost up to \$2.5 billion, for which it is relying on the support of the international community (FT, 14 June 2009). It plans to set up “financial empowerment programmes” across the conflict-affected areas (Dawn, Rs2.5bn released, 24 October 2009). The government has most recently pledged to improve infrastructure across FATA, including regenerating health and education systems, and to take rapid steps towards the development of Baluchistan).

Faced with scepticism over its military operation, the government is eager to appease a population which is increasingly starting to feel it is fighting a foreigner's war against its own people. Many feel that the Taliban is not a purely Pakistani problem, and resent the endless suffering of their own people, while being looked on as terrorists (Dawn, Refugees, 20 October 2009, 30 October 2009 and 12 September 2009). The foreign minister recognised the issue when he mentioned the link between poverty, lack of opportunity and “terrorism” in the “Talk to Jazeera,” 2 November 2009.

The international community's response

Access and security

Faced with a humanitarian crisis on such a scale, the humanitarian community has been overstretched by evolving and multiple needs. In addition, access issues have hindered needs assessments (OCHA, 4 September 2009), and made it more difficult for aid agencies to provide appropriate and timely assistance. By November 2009, in South Waziristan, security restrictions meant that only local NGOs have been granted non-objection certificates to provide humanitarian relief in DI Khan and Tank (OCHA, 19 October 2009). However, international aid agencies have provided services through local implementing partners, for example training partners on IDP protection, disease early warning systems and the identification of malnourished children.

ICRC does not have access to the conflict zone in South Waziristan, but sends supplies to eight hospitals on the ground (ICRC, ICRC supports medical facilities, 29 October 2009). Aid workers have expressed deep concern at the plight of civilians in the areas of combat, who may be prevented from escaping, whilst living without basic necessities (AFP, 3 November 2009).

Activities of the UN and other international agencies have also been limited by increasing security constraints outside conflict areas. Shortly after an attack on its headquarters in early October which led to the death of five of its personnel, the World Food Programme (WFP) briefly shut

down its 32 food hubs across NWFP (The News, UN World Food Program, 21 October 2009; OCHA, 23 October 2009). Days after a deadly attack on a market in Peshawar (AFP, 2 November), the UN declared a Stage 4 security phase in Pakistan, temporarily pulling out international staff from its Peshawar offices. Officials indicated that long-term development projects would be affected, as opposed to emergency relief operations which were due to continue across NWFP and FATA.

The UN has implemented the cluster approach to coordinate its overall response. The clusters were initially criticised for failing to assess the real needs of the affected population sufficiently quickly, and then failing to respond effectively (Oxfam, Missing Pieces, 1 October 2009, p.16). It has been suggested that although up to 90 per cent of all IDPs chose to live with host communities, it took the cluster system too long to shift its emphasis from camps to hosts. Furthermore, tensions reportedly arose between agencies, as some chose to work more closely with the government, perceived as a party to the conflict. Nonetheless, WFP's cooperation with the government (the agency reportedly relied on government IDP lists) had increased its capacity to deliver on a large scale, and assess and respond rapidly to evolving needs (Refugees International, Protect People First, 26 October 2009; Oxfam, Missing Pieces, 1 October 2009).

Funding

Unmet funding needs are still of major concern to some clusters. By mid-October, eight of the 11 Clusters were funded to less than 50 per cent of their requirements under the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan (PHRP). Despite the role they would play in rehabilitating IDPs and reducing their dependence on external aid, Early Recovery and Agriculture were only two per cent funded and 16 per cent funded respectively. The Conflict Early Recovery Initial Needs Assessment (CERINA), in which the NWFP provincial government and the clusters took part, made clear the major early recovery effort required. By late October, in spite of the seriousness of the situation, health cluster operations as provided for under the PHRP were still only funded at 44 per cent (WHO, 30 October 2009). At the same time, initial assessments in DI Khan and Tank highlighted the need for medical supplies, personnel, and food.

With insufficient funds to cover existing operations, agencies have been faced with the challenge of extending their services to all categories of conflict-affected civilians, including returnees, those who remained in conflict-affected areas and host families as well as IDPs.

When the UN launched the PHRP in May, it appealed to donors for \$542 million. The requested amount was revised upwards to \$680 million. Although donors have committed \$650 million, only 70 per cent of the total requested had been transferred as of November 2009, when some pledges were still to be translated into firm commitments (OCHA FTS website, accessed on the 8 November 2009).

The noticeable trend away from direct bilateral funding of frontline agencies towards donations through clusters meant it took more time for the money to reach implementing partners (Oxfam, Millions of displaced Pakistanis, 1 October 2009). The current access situation in South-Waziristan further illustrates the interest the international community may have in providing direct financial support to frontline agencies, and their implementing partners who are often best placed to carry out operations, on a more durable basis. In July 2009, an OCHA-led global inter-cluster mission concluded that clusters ought not to be used as disbursement mechanisms for donor funding (Oxfam, Missing Pieces, 1 October 2009, p.8).

As the focus was first placed on NWFP, in particular Swat, several NGOs called attention to the needs of people fleeing the offensive in FATA, including those already displaced from those areas for the past year (IRC, 13 October 2009). However, as media attention has switched to the operation in South Waziristan and the unpredictable attacks in urban areas apparently outside the

zones of conflict, aid workers have become concerned that the needs of over a million people still displaced across NWFP will be sidelined.

CAUSES AND BACKGROUND

Displacement in FATA

Bajaur and Mohmand (October 2009)

- Six months before the military offensive in the Swat Valley, a similar anti-Taliban military campaign in Bajaur and Mohmand has displaced over half a million people and has destroyed thousands of houses, as well as hospitals, clinics, schools and vital water supplies.
- The spotlight on events in the Swat Valley risks obscuring the needs of IDPs from Bajaur and Mohmand, who cannot return to their homes.

IRC, 13 October 2009:

"But the spotlight on events in the Swat Valley risks obscuring the desperate needs of displaced people from the tribal agencies of Bajaur and Mohmand who cannot return to their homes, says Mike Young, the IRC's country representative in Pakistan. Bajaur and Mohmand, along with five other "agencies," make up Pakistan's Federally Administered Tribal Areas, which by agreement with the government are ruled autonomously by local tribes.

"People are desperate to go home but simply can't," Young says. "These areas are home to some of the poorest people in the country and now their homes and crops have been destroyed."

Six months before a Pakistan military offensive against the anti-government Taliban sparked the crisis in the Swat Valley, a similar anti-Taliban military campaign in Bajaur and Mohmand agencies resulted in the displacement of over half a million people. A recent United Nations assessment of the military operation in the two agencies—which both share a border with Afghanistan—found that not only were hundreds of thousands of people forced to flee for their lives but that thousands of homes and hundreds of small businesses as well as hospitals, clinics, schools, and vital water supplies were destroyed. The UN estimates that at least three quarters of a million Bajauris and Mohmandis have been stuck in hot and dusty camps for over a year."

Khyber Agency (September 2009)

- As a result of military operations which began on 1 September 2009 in the Bara area of Khyber Agency, 56,000 to 84,000 people have been internally displaced.

OCHA, 17 September 2009:

"New Displacement in Khyber Agency: Between 8,000 and 12,000 families (56, 000 to 84,000 individuals) have been internally displaced as a result of military operations which began on 1 September in the Bara area of Khyber Agency, in the Federally Administered Tribal Area (FATA)."

Waziristan (November 2009)

- In September 2009, some 126,000 people fled from North and South Waziristan agencies for safety reasons.

- Most of the displaced fled in neighbouring areas of Dera Ismail Khan and Tank and have been living with host communities.
- Some 550 families fled to Bannu area through Miran Shah area in North Waziristan, others fled to Laccki Marwat, Karachi, NWFP, Punjab and other parts of the country.
- According to ICRC, a sizeable population has stayed behind in South Waziristan and is caught up in the fighting with very limited access to food, health care or clean water.

IRIN, 2 September 2009:

Displacement in North, South Waziristan

"At least 126,300 people have already fled from the adjoining North and South Waziristan agencies and have been registered, according to the UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA), in the Tank and Dera Ismail Khan Districts. It is not yet known how many more may join them, but people continue to leave the area each day.

"I am shifting my wife, my parents and my four children to Peshawar. I don't want to be caught in a situation where roads are closed due to fighting, or transport becomes impossible to find," Azim Wazir, 40, told IRIN from Wana, the principal city of South Waziristan."

Dawn, 28 September 2009:

DERA ISMAIL KHAN: "Hundreds of civilians were fleeing al-Qaeda and the Taliban's main stronghold in northwest Pakistan after the army and militants asked them to leave, a tribal elder and a witness said Monday, a sign the military could be poised to launch an offensive.

[...]

Residents said recent days have shown an increase in the number of people leaving the Makeen and Ladha areas of South Waziristan, though many have been fleeing to the relative safety of nearby towns for months.

'People are leaving the area for their safety,' tribal elder Maulana Hassamuddin told The Associated Press by phone. He said the military had urged people to leave in the past few days, so he did.

Resident Amirullah said the Taliban had also asked locals to flee. He said he and his friends rented a vehicle to take them to the town of Bannu for more than double the normal price."

Amnesty International, 16 October 2009:

"Most of the displaced have been living with host communities-often relatives or friends in neighbouring areas of Dera Ismail Khan and Tank. Local officials imposed a curfew in Tank on Wednesday and have limited movement between 6 pm and 6 am, and have restricted access on the road to Dera Ismail Khan, significantly hindering the ability of people from South Waziristan to seek shelter in safer parts of the country. "

The News, 21 October 2009:

"The migration of South Waziristan affectees to Bannu is underway and 550 families have been registered so far.

The affectees reaching Bannu through Miran Shah area of North Waziristan after covering distance of 70 kilometers. Police sources said registration of displace persons is underway at check post established in Do Sarak area and so far more then 500 families is being registered. Some of displace persons also going to Laccki Marwat, Karachi, NWFP, Punjab and other parts of the country."

ICRC, 29 October 2009:

"A sizeable population has stayed behind in South Waziristan, which is where the fighting is taking place. Exact numbers are impossible to come by; you can't exactly conduct a census right now! But what we're hearing from our contacts is that the people left behind are the poorest of the poor, those who couldn't afford the extortionate prices that transporters are demanding at the

moment. These people are caught up in the fighting, they are under constant curfew, and it's very difficult for them to get food, health care or clean water."

AFP, 3 November 2009:

"Normally about 300,000 people live in the part of South Waziristan which the military is seeking to clear of "terrorists".

[...]

Those escaping the fighting have migrated to the northwestern towns of Dera Ismail Khan and Tank where they are staying with relatives, friends, host families or in rented houses, Ahmad said."

Displacement in North West Frontier Province

Displacement in North West Frontier Province (July 2009)

- As of the end of May 2009, almost 2,4 million people have left the Swat Valley, fleeing the fighting between Pakistan's army and the Talibans.
- Before the beginning of the last military intervention, about 550,000 people were reported to have been displaced.
- A mere 10-20 per cent of the displaced have found shelter in camps and are living in extremely precarious conditions.
- The others have found refuge in schools and other public buildings, or are staying with friends or family, placing an increasing burden on them.
- The high number of IDPs makes it almost impossible to take into account the needs of those with disabilities and of the most vulnerable.
- Local NGOs have provided basic aid to the displaced; however the situation requires a rapid larger-scale operation.

Handicap International, 26 May 2009:

"Almost 2.4 million people have fled the fighting that for several weeks now has opposed Pakistan's army and the Taliban in the Swat valley in north-west Pakistan. This has made conditions for people with disabilities or in vulnerable situations even more precarious.

The displaced continue to flee the Swat valley where fighting between Pakistan's army and the Taliban continues. Over the last three weeks almost 2.4 million people have left the combat zone, heading towards Peshawar, abandoning their homes on the spot. Some of these displaced persons have found shelter in camps, whose population may reach up to 100,000 people, and are living in extremely precarious situations. Given the extent of the population movements it is difficult to account for the displaced in anything more than a perfunctory manner, and almost impossible to take into account the needs of those with disabilities and the most vulnerable. The tents previously used to shelter the victims of the 2005 earthquake have been pitched to house the influx of people, but as they are designed for use in the winter they have soon become hot houses with outside temperatures of 40°C in the shade.

A mere 10 - 20% of the displaced have been accommodated in the camps. The others find themselves lodging with family or friends or in schools and other public buildings. Whilst local NGOs have already begun to provide assistance to the displaced in the form of basic aid, the need for a larger-scale operation to be mounted rapidly is clear as the situation is a cause for grave concern."

IRIN, 5 July 2009:

"3 May 2009: Government offensive against militants begins in Swat, Buner and Dir districts in NWFP. About two million displaced so far, according to the UN Refugee Agency (UNHCR). About 555,000 IDPs were reported to have been displaced by conflict from tribal areas before this latest military surge began. Most IDPs are staying with [host families](#), placing an increasing burden on them. The NWFP government puts their number at over three million. The UK-based [Islamic Relief](#) puts the total number of IDPs in Pakistan at 3.7 million. While some IDPs have returned, most are still in over 20 camps or with relatives. "

Islamic Relief, 31 July 2009:

"On the roads we saw many people with their few possessions on foot or on the back of trucks making the arduous journey back to their villages. It seems like only yesterday that these people were fleeing in the other direction; I cannot believe that three months have passed so quickly."

Extremists seize control in Swat Valley in the North West Frontier Province (November 2007)

- A pro-Taliban cleric rose to power in the Swat Valley of the North West Frontier Province
- By 2007, the cleric had mobilized thousands of volunteers in an armed wing largely through sermons on radio stations
- The movement banned music, internet cafes, CD shops and closed schools, especially those for girls
- Initially the central government ignored the problem, by the time it tried to intervene an insurgency had spread in the Valley

The New York Times, October 2007:

"The sharp rise in violence in the area, Swat Valley, which is relatively isolated from the lawless tribal areas on the Afghan border, demonstrates the growing strength of Islamists. Leading the wave of militancy is the cleric, Maulana Fazlullah, who is also known as Maulana Radio for his illegal broadcasts calling for Taliban-like Islamic law, and who is thought to have some 4,500 followers. He is the son-in-law of Sufi Muhammad, the founder of Tehrik-e-Nifaz-e-Shariat-e-Mohammadi, the Movement for the Implementation of Muhammad's Law, who has been in prison since 2001 after sending Pakistanis into Afghanistan to support the Taliban in fighting American forces. "

Inter Press Service News, November 2007:

"Maulana Fazlullah, who preaches over his own FM radio station, has mobilised some 4,000 volunteers in an armed wing called Shaheen Force, and established courts. Three persons were lashed in public on Oct. 12 for their role in the abduction of a woman.

[...]

There is a complete ban on music, Internet cafes and CD shops in Swat. Maulana Fazlullah set 15 CD shops on fire before Ramazan after paying the owners, 2,000 dollars each. The radical cleric has even changed names of places that he has deemed un-Islamic. Schools in Swat, especially for girls, have been closed. In August, the principal of a paramedical institute was killed in a bomb attack on his vehicle for failing to stop teaching female students."

Time, November 2007:

"For too long, the central government ignored the problems festering in Swat, concerned that a crackdown on demands for Shari'a would alienate the country's Islam-based political parties. By the time the military tried to intervene, a homegrown insurgency was in full swing."

Armed conflict between extremists and the army displaces hundreds of thousands (December 2007)

- The army went into the Swat Valley in late October and carried out aerial attacks; a ground offensive was launched in November
- The offensive drove hundreds of thousands of people from their homes
- Many civilians fled in response to security forces ordering them to leave, others fled to escape artillery shelling

Institute of Peace and Conflict Studies, December 2007:

"Since the end of October an open war has ensued between the militants, led by a radical cleric Maulana Fazlullah, fighting for the enforcement of the Sharia law in the region and the security forces. The militants on a rampage since the beginning of this year unleashed havoc following the Lal Masjid operation with at least four suicide attacks against the security forces in July itself. The Pakistani army, at first, launched aerial attacks through helicopter gunships in late October to target militant hideouts and training camps; but, due to continuing unrest in the region and large-scale surrender of the paramilitary forces, the army stepped up its operations and launched an all-out ground offensive in end-November."

Integrated Regional Information Networks, November 2007:

"Thousands of people have begun fleeing Pakistan's troubled Swat Valley in North West Frontier Province (NWFP) following an announcement by security forces calling on residents to leave their homes.

[...]

Meanwhile, the past few days have seen increased artillery shelling in the area - further driving people's desire to leave the area. Over the weekend, helicopter gun-ships and artillery reportedly continued targeting Koza Banda and Bara Banda; areas known to be extending support to Fazlullah, while helicopters hovered over other areas of Swat and Shangla districts.

[...]

And while the army says this is targeted shelling, there are reports that a number of shells have gone astray."

Displacement in Waziristan

Renewed conflict in North Waziristan displaces tens of thousands (October 2008)

- A peace accord between the Taleban leaders in North Waziristan and the central government unraveled in July 2007

- Heavy fighting broke out in North Waziristan in October 2007 during which a number of civilians were caught in the crossfire
- The fighting also displaced 80,000 people from Mirali in North Waziristan where military operations were taking place

New York Times, July 2007:

"Taliban leaders in North Waziristan called off the peace deal over the weekend, after Pakistan's president, Gen. Pervez Musharraf, deployed troops to several checkpoints in the region. Under the truce, signed last September, the military had agreed to pull back to its barracks and take down checkpoints in exchange for a suspension of hostilities from the militants, who agreed to halt cross-border attacks on American and NATO troops in Afghanistan.

Government officials said they would allow tribal elders to enforce the peace deal in return for millions of dollars in financial aid. Critics said all the deal did was let the Taliban and Al Qaeda to regroup and plan attacks inside the country and across the border.

The September agreement was the latest in a series of sometimes contradictory steps taken by the Pakistani government to restore law and order in the Federally Administered Tribal Areas, where civilian administration has steadily eroded in recent years.

The Musharraf government has alternately tried to bludgeon, buy off and appease militants operating in the tribal areas, sometimes sacrificing Pakistani troops, and other times negotiating deals with some of the most feared militant commanders, who now appear to have rejected the agreement altogether.

A letter circulated Monday by the Taliban in North Waziristan said the peace pact had been scrapped "in the larger public interest." It warned the tribal police not to aid military and paramilitary troops, and urged tribal elders not to cooperate with the government.

[...]

Even before its failure, the peace accord had not brought the security the government intended. American and NATO commanders in Afghanistan say the Taliban continue to use Pakistan's tribal areas as a rear base. In early June, the United States National Security Council warned that the Taliban had regrouped and reorganized inside Pakistan. That same month, the Interior Ministry warned General Musharraf that the Taliban's influence was increasingly spreading outside the tribal areas to other parts of the country."

The Nation, October 2007:

"The battle to evict Taliban militants from North Waziristan has entered a decisive phase. It started on Saturday October 6, 2007, after months of inaction, during which war lord Baitullah Mahsud consolidated his hold over most of North Waziristan, while the Taliban kept harassing Pakistani citizens in many border towns and villages, including Bannu, Karak, Tank, Laki Marwat and Dera Ismail Khan.

After four days of fierce fighting which started on October 06, some 250 people including 205 militants and 45 Pakistan security personnel were killed. These were the deadliest clashes since Pakistan's involvement in the US led war on terror. Pakistan Army's artillery, gunship helicopters and Pakistan Air Force fighters bombed militant hideouts, including Ipi village bazar in North Waziristan on Tuesday last.

[...]

Fierce fighting in the areas of Baro Khail, Maski, Esau Khel, Khushhali and Hyder Khail continued on Sunday night, while militants attacked check posts of security forces and the city of Miranshah. After mortar shells started hitting village mud huts, hundreds of villagers fled to the surrounding

hills. Electricity and telecommunication systems in the Mir Ali area have been badly damaged. Miran Shah-Mir Ali-Bannu highway has been closed. In Khawaja Khel village, 18 militants and civilians died from the bombardment by gun ship helicopters and PAF fighters. Twelve people of Wazir tribe died and 18 were injured when stray mortar shells struck their houses. Another fourteen people were killed when a shell hit a house in Kazi village. Three people in Essu Khal, two in Khazmak and two in Mir Ali were killed by mortar shelling.”

Dawn, October 2007:

“Eyewitness reports said the fighting had displaced thousands of people, forcing many to seek refuge in the nearby Bannu and D.I. Khan districts. Some 80,000 people left Mirali, the second largest town in North Waziristan, where the military operation against militants was taking place. The dead and the wounded were being brought to hospitals in Bannu and Peshawar.”

Clashes between army and militants in South Waziristan displace thousands (March 2008)

- Heavy clashes began in South Waziristan in January 2008 when army tried to target a leader of Pakistani Taleban groups
- Both sides used heavy weaponry
- The fighting displaced hundreds of families who fled to the adjacent district and North Waziristan
- According to some estimates, tens of thousands of people were displaced from South Waziristan due to the military operations

Voice of America News, January 2008:

“The Pakistani military says it is sending reinforcements to the South Waziristan region on the Afghan border to target a Islamic rebel commander accused of involvement in the assassination of former Prime Minister Benazir Bhutto. Military spokesman General Athar Abbas says a recent escalation in militant attacks made it necessary to reinforce military posts in the tribal area. He said additional troops have been sent to the area, but did not specify how many. South Waziristan is a stronghold of Baitullah Mehsud, a leader of Pakistani Taliban groups who is also believed to have ties to al-Qaida. Mehsud has claimed credit for organizing a series of suicide attacks against Pakistani military targets in the last year, but he has denied government allegations that he masterminded the assassination of Ms. Bhutto.”

Dawn, January 2008:

“A large number of people moved out of the conflict-hit areas of South Waziristan as fierce clashes between security forces and militants continued ...information gathered from different sources indicated that hundreds of displaced families, mostly women, children and elders, were migrating to the adjacent Tank district and North Waziristan.

The army has set up a relief camp at Kari Wam in the Frontier Region of Tank for the displaced families. An official said that around 200 people had arrived in the centre and they were being provided food and medicines.

Over 100 displaced families have reached Miramshah in North Waziristan. Local elder Fazl Subhan, who is contesting the elections, has set up relief centres in Miramshah, Mirali and Esha.”

Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies, March 2008:

“A large number of families in Pakistani tribal areas have been displaced from their native lands to settled areas of Dera Ismail Khan, Tank, and Bannu while some have migrated to far-flung Karachi. During the process of this enforced displacement, stirred by the security operations in Waziristan, four infants and two pregnant women have lost their lives. Records of the Relief Camps suggest that the number of displaced people from South Waziristan has exceeded 60,000.

According to the district administration, about 1,500 to 2,000 families have arrived in the city of Dera Ismail Khan. Their total number is more than thirty thousand. But, nobody has their particulars. Initially, centers were established in Dera city’s Town Hall and Besakhi Ground for rehabilitation of the displaced people, but, when the locals protested, they were shifted near Gomal University.”

Hunt for pro-Taliban militants has displaced thousands (May 2006)

- The Pakistani army has based 80,000 troops in Waziristan to flush out foreign pro-Taleban militants hiding there
- Displacement has been reported since March 2004, when the army stepped up its operations in South Waziristan
- In 2005, the government launched operations also in North Waziristan
- Despite a peace agreement between the Pakistani Government and pro-Taleban tribal leaders in September 2006, fighting has continued

Reuters, May 2006

“Since the U.S.-led invasion of Afghanistan in 2001, the Pakistani army has launched a series of attacks in the semi-autonomous region of Waziristan, aimed at flushing out foreign pro-Taliban militants hiding there. This has led to displacement and alienation of the local population, provoking a rise in Islamic fundamentalism.

[...]

Pakistan’s semi-autonomous tribal belt has become a hideout for sympathisers of the militant al Qaeda network and members of the Taliban who fled Afghanistan after U.S.-led forces toppled the regime in 2001.

Al Qaeda leader Osama bin Laden, who is blamed for the Sept. 11 attacks on U.S. cities in 2001, is believed to have passed through North Waziristan during his escape from Afghanistan that year. He and his number two, Ayman al-Zawahri, may still be hiding in the region.

In 2005, the government switched its campaign to rid the tribal areas of foreign fighters from South Waziristan to North Waziristan. Pakistani intelligence officials estimate there are up to 1,000 militants in the area, who enjoy the support of its deeply religious and conservative tribes.

The government bombing of an alleged militant hideout in early March 2006 sparked violent clashes. Several hundred militants seized government buildings in the town of Miranshah, leading to confrontations in which more than 120 militants died, according to the military. Thousands of people fled as helicopter gunships pounded militant positions around the town.

These clashes coincided with a visit to Pakistan by U.S. President George Bush. The U.S. regards Pakistan as a key ally in its "war on terror", but Bush said more needed to be done to defeat al Qaeda and pro-Taliban militants on the Pakistan-Afghan border.

Relations over border issues are thorny. Afghan officials have complained that, since 2001, insurgents have used Pakistani soil to launch attacks inside Afghanistan. A major row blew up around the time of Bush's visit when Musharraf said intelligence on Taliban leaders handed over by Afghanistan was out of date.

Several weeks later, however, Pakistan beefed up troops deployed in the area, posting more forces opposite the eastern Afghan province of Kunar to stop militants fleeing a U.S.-led offensive. There are now around 80,000 Pakistani soldiers patrolling the border area.

The death toll from the violence has reached around 375 since the middle of last year, including 325 militants (75 foreign) and around 50 members of the security forces, according to government estimates. At least half the deaths have occurred since early March 2006."

RFE/RL, 24, March 2006

"The issue of a Pashtun national homeland along the Afghan-Pakistan border has been largely dormant for the last 40 years. Dormant -- but unresolved. And now, arguments from the century-old debate are surfacing again in a way that affects the international war against terrorism.

For many ethnic Pashtuns, "Pashtunistan" is an historic homeland that was divided in 1893 by the Durand Line -- a 2,450 kilometer demarcation line drawn by the British through Pashtun tribal lands to suit the defensive needs of British colonial India.

For Islamabad, the issue represents a territorial claim against Pakistan -- particularly parts of Pakistan's Baluchistan Province and the tribal regions where Pakistani security forces are battling pro-Taliban militants. The reason is that Pakistan inherited the Durand Line from British colonial India as its northwestern border with Afghanistan."

COE-DMHA, 5 September 2006

"The Pakistan government has reportedly signed a peace agreement with pro-Taliban militants in the country's semi-autonomous western Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA), which border Afghanistan.

[...]

Pro-Taliban militants in the area were reportedly consolidating their political power in the region, which led to a renewed military crackdown in March. According to officials in July, over 400 people have been killed in clashes this year, mostly in North Waziristan tribal agency. However since June, the government has been working with a council of tribal elders (jirga) to talk with militants to control the violence. The formation of the jirga is the first of its kind since Pakistan deployed about 80,000 troops to the region in 2003 to flush out al Qaeda and Taliban elements in the region. Under the agreement, the Pakistan military has pledged to end major operations in the area and withdraw most soldiers to military camps. According to reports today, hundreds of soldiers were withdrawn from several checkpoints in North Waziristan over the weekend. However, the military will continue to operate border checkpoints. Earlier, the military had released a number of tribesmen in what was seen as a goodwill gesture. In return, pro-Taliban militants have pledged not to shelter foreign militants, launch raids across the Afghan border or attack Pakistan government troops or infrastructure. All foreign militants would also have to

respect the peace deal, otherwise they would have to leave, and movement across the border will only continue for family or business matters. Observers say that these conditions would be difficult to enforce as the Taliban has support from the Pashtun ethnic group, which live on both sides of the porous border. Across the border in Afghanistan, a recent major offensive by NATO-led forces in the southern Afghan province of Kandahar has pushed Taliban fighters to the border. Afghanistan has complained that Pakistan is not doing enough to crack down on militants on its side of the border."

Displacement in Balochistan

Conflict ongoing in Balochistan though momentum declines (January 2008)

- Political unrest and armed conflict continued in Balochistan in 2007
- Security forces have detained thousands of Baloch nationalists
- Many young activists see armed resistance as only viable way to secure their rights
- The momentum of the armed conflict declined as some leaders fled or were neutralized by the state
- Acts of violence are occurring in all parts of the province, including the capital Quetta

Human Rights Watch, January 2008:

"Political unrest in the southwestern province of Balochistan continued in 2007. Though the dispute in Balochistan is essentially political, centered on issues of provincial autonomy and exploitation of mineral resources, the Pakistani military and Baloch tribal militants have increasingly sought a military solution to their disagreements. The Pakistani military has arbitrarily detained, tortured, and "disappeared" militants and political opponents; Baloch militants have continued to target civilians and use landmines in sporadic retaliatory attacks."

International Crisis Group, October 2007:

"Violence continues unabated in Pakistan's strategically important and resource-rich province of Balochistan, where the military government is fighting Baloch militants demanding political and economic autonomy. President Pervez Musharraf's government insists the insurgency is an attempt to seize power by a handful of tribal chiefs bent on resisting economic development. Baloch nationalists maintain it is fuelled by the military's attempts to subdue dissent by force and the alienation caused by the absence of real democracy. Whether or not free and fair national and provincial elections are held later this year or in early 2008 will determine whether the conflict worsens. Instead of redressing Baloch political and economic grievances, the military is determined to impose state control through force. The killing of the Baloch leader Nawab Akbar Khan Bugti by the army in August 2006 was followed by the incarceration of another, Sardar Akhtar Jan Mengal, who has been held on terrorism related charges without due process since December. Law enforcement agencies have detained thousands of Baloch nationalists or those believed to be sympathetic to the cause; many have simply disappeared. With the nationalist parties under siege, many young activists are losing faith in the political process and now see armed resistance as the only viable way to secure their rights."

South Asian Terrorism Portal, 2008:

"The Balochistan province – accounting for approximately 44 per cent of Pakistan's landmass – is now afflicted by an encompassing insurgency. Currently, all 30 Districts of Balochistan are affected either by a sub-nationalist tribal insurgency or, separately, by Islamist extremism. Most of the violence in Balochistan is, however, 'nationalist' and there is no co-operation between predominantly Pashtun Islamist militants in the North and the Baloch nationalist insurgents. Structural and constitutional biases prevailing against the provinces feed popular anger and the insurgencies, and militate against any possible solution to the Baloch problem, particularly given Islamabad's track record of intransigence.

On the face of it, it seems that the province has relatively calmed down after the assassination of Nawab Akbar Khan Bugti on August 26, 2006, by the military. The momentum of the Baloch insurgency declined relatively in 2007, as some leaders either fled Pakistan or were neutralized by the state. The operational capacity of the Balochistan Liberation Army (BLA), the most prominent insurgent group in Balochistan, was considerably reduced in 2007 and is expected to remain diminished in the immediate future. At least 450 persons, including 226 civilians, 82 soldiers and 142 insurgents, were killed in 772 incidents in 2006. Violence in 2007 was at relatively lower levels, with at least 245 persons, including 124 civilians, killed in the year. But, the insurgency continues to simmer, and there has been a steady stream of bomb and rocket attacks on gas pipelines, railway tracks, power transmission lines, bridges, and communications infrastructure, as well as on military establishments and Government facilities. The rebels are still capable of carrying out acts of sabotage on a daily basis across the province and a political solution to the insurgency is nowhere in sight. Acts of violence are, importantly, not restricted to a few Districts, but are occurring in practically all of them, including the provincial capital Quetta.

Still reeling under the loss caused by the assassination of Nawab Akbar Bugti in August 2006, the Baloch insurgents were dealt another significant blow when Nawabzada Balach Marri, purported chief of the Balochistan Liberation Army, was killed on November 21, 2007. Marri was reportedly killed along with his bodyguards in a clash somewhere inside Afghanistan, triggering widespread violence in Quetta and other parts of the province. Mystery shrouds Marri's killing, as some reports suggested he was killed in Afghanistan while others stated it was in Pakistan."

Background: the conflict between Baloch tribes and the government is deepening (September 2006)

- Balochistan has seen decades of struggle between separatists and the government
- In December 2005, the conflict flared up, and the army stepped up operations against separatist groups
- Thousands of civilians have been affected by the conflict
- The situation deteriorated further after one of the most influential local leaders was killed in August 2006

Reuters, May 2006

"In Baluchistan, the largest and poorest of Pakistan's four provinces, the conflict is an ethno-nationalist struggle between separatists and the government. Tribal militants have staged several insurgencies since the mid-20th century to fight for greater political autonomy and control over local mineral resources.

[...]

The decades-old conflict in Pakistan's southwestern Baluchistan province flared up again in December 2005, following a rocket attack during a visit by Musharraf to the town of Kohlu. This

spurred the Pakistani military to launch a major crackdown against nationalist groups in the region.

Since then, militants have regularly blown up gas pipelines, railway lines and electricity transmission lines, and launched rocket attacks on government buildings and army bases. It is unclear how many people have been killed in the renewed violence, but according to the Daily Times newspaper, in April 2006, the interior minister put the death toll since the start of the year at around 160, including some 50 civilians and 75 tribesmen. Landmines planted by both militants and the security forces are responsible for a growing proportion of deaths.

Much of the violence is thought to be carried out by a group known as the Baluch Liberation Army (BLA), which has been listed as a terrorist organisation by the government. Set up in the 1970s, the BLA is the first nationalist group to be banned by Pakistan in recent years.

In May 2006, the government banned Baluch nationalist leaders from travelling outside Pakistan, including three members of parliament. The state telecommunications agency also ordered the country's internet service providers to block access to four websites containing Baluch nationalist material.

According to analyst Bansal, the Baluch nationalists know they cannot win a direct battle with the Pakistani army.

Their tactics are therefore focused on attacking the military's lines of communication and trying to widen the scope of the conflict by drawing in other groups to support them against the Punjabi elite. The Pakistani authorities have made allegations that the militants are receiving external support.

Baluchistan was not incorporated into Pakistan until 1948, when Pakistani troops moved in, forcing the Khan of Kalat, the monarch who had ruled the area under the umbrella of the British Empire, to give up hopes of independence.

In the mid-1950s, the People's Party, a new nationalist party, was launched by the Prince of Kalat, and in 1972, it joined with the National Awami Party, based in North West Frontier Province, and the Islamist Jamaat-ul-Ulema-i-Islam in opposition to the centralising government of President Zulfikar Ali Bhutto.

Major conflict broke out in 1973 after the intelligence services intercepted a consignment of weapons headed for Baluchistan and Bhutto dismissed the regional government. Thousands of militants fought the national army, which targeted the Baluch tribes' livestock, their key economic asset. The insurgency dragged on until 1977, when Bhutto was overthrown and the military regime of General Zia ul-Haq arrived at a political settlement with some Baluch leaders. Some 9,000 people died in the violence.

[...]

Since then, resentment against the central government has continued to grow as infrastructure has been built to exploit the province's rich natural resources, especially gas. Development has fuelled local frustration for two key reasons.

Firstly, Baluchs feel their province is being increasingly monopolised by non-indigenous migrants attracted by its economic opportunities. Secondly, there is a widespread perception that the province does not receive a fair share of benefits from the exploitation of its natural resources.

One major infrastructure project regularly targeted by Baluch militants is the construction of a strategically important port at Gwadar. Work began on the deep-sea port and naval base in 2002, with the majority of funding coming from China.

Gwadar is on Pakistan's Arabian Sea coast near the mouth of the Persian Gulf, 400 km (250 miles) from the Strait of Hormuz and just 72 km from Iran. It is expected to become a key shipping hub at the mouth of a strategic waterway, and China's involvement in the project would help it protect its energy and security interests. This is a source of concern for the United States, India and Iran.

Although Baluchistan's citizens are not opposed to the project outright, as with other development initiatives, many believe its benefits will go largely to outsiders, and will not improve local living standards.

The port facilities and workers have been targeted in sporadic attacks since 2004 when bomb blasts and rocket attacks killed several Chinese engineers.

As well as calling for a larger dividend from local development projects and the exploitation of natural resources, Baluch militants are struggling for greater political control over their administrative affairs. In March 2006, the provincial assembly voted to form a bipartisan panel to try to make peace between the authorities and warring tribal leaders, but this has yet to yield significant results."

ICG, September 2006, pp.1-2

"Three decades after the 1973-1977 insurrection in Balochistan, a low-level insurgency again challenges central control over the province. After almost seven years of military rule, deprived of representative participatory institutions and with their natural resources exploited by Islamabad, Baloch alienation is at an all-time high. Although regional parties and leaders are still struggling to obtain political, economic and social rights within a democratic, federal, parliamentary framework, militants have picked up the gun.

Baloch political parties and militants have a common goal – to assert provincial control over Balochistan's natural resources and gain a voice in shaping its political, economic and social development. "We want to live as an equal partner in the federation, with our democratic rights respected, including the ownership of our resources, these resources belong to the people of Pakistan".

[...]

By refusing to negotiate Baloch demands for provincial autonomy and control over their resources and opting instead to forcibly subdue dissent – political or militant – the Musharraf government has upped the stakes. Islamabad might be able to retain central control through brute force but its policy directions will likely

undermine the remaining vestiges of state legitimacy in the troubled province.

That tensions between the centre and the Baloch have reached new heights under centralised authoritarian rule is not surprising. The military government's disregard for provincial autonomy has sparked the unrest.[...]

Baloch alienation is also rooted in Islamabad's longstanding neglect of the resource-rich province, which remains the poorest of Pakistan's four federal units.[...] Popular support for Baloch nationalist parties and sardars (tribal chiefs) who articulate Baloch political aspirations and social and economic demands is widespread. Musharraf's decision to sideline this regional leadership and attempt instead to consolidate central control through military force has left little space for a negotiated settlement.

[...]

In 2006, this gap has increased dangerously, particularly after the military killed Nawab Akbar Khan

Bugti, one of the most influential Baloch political leaders, on 26 August 2006. Bugti had taken to the mountains in early 2006 after his hometown of Dera Bugti was attacked and besieged by the military. He was killed in his remote mountain base in a military operation that involved the use of helicopter gunships and ground troops.[...] Yet, Islamabad denies it is conducting a military operation, insisting instead that a few tribal chiefs, threatened by its development schemes which would undermine their hold over local power, are responsible for an insurgency limited to their tribal fiefdoms.[...] But the military government is neither the harbinger of modernisation and development, nor is Baloch resistance limited to a handful of tribal chiefs.

On the contrary, Baloch dissent has become a broad movement for political, economic and social empowerment.

[...]

Balochistan is the largest of Pakistan's four provinces. Some 347,190 square kilometres in size, it covers 43 per cent of its land area but has only around 6 per cent of its population.[...]

The ethnic make-up, according to last official estimates, is 54.7 per cent Baloch, 29.0 per cent Pashtun.⁹

It is the least developed province but rich in energy and mineral resources,[...] meeting more than 40 per cent of Pakistan's energy needs through its gas and coal reserves and accounting for 36 per cent of its total gas production. Large energy reserves remain untapped.[...] However, 46.6 per cent of households have no electricity.[...] Consistent degradation of the water supply and absence of storage systems, such as small dams, have turned much of Balochistan, with its predominantly rural population, into an arid wasteland.[...] According to the Karachi-based Social Policy and Development Centre, poverty levels are twice that of Punjab, Pakistan's largest and most prosperous province; urban unemployment is 12.5 per cent, compared to the countrywide average of 9.7 per cent; and half the population lives below the poverty line.[...]

Balochistan is strategically located. Bordering on Afghanistan and Iran,[...] it lies astride the communication routes of South, South West and Central Asia.[...] With a 760-km coastline, Balochistan links Pakistan with the oil-rich Gulf States and the sea lanes of the Arabian Sea, close to the Strait of Hormuz through which oil tankers bound for the West and Japan must pass. This coast is particularly important to the Pakistan military. Three of its four naval bases are located there."

Fighting between separatist groups and the army has displaced tens of thousands (July 2006)

- Fighting was reported to displace tens of thousands from December onwards
- Displacement started in the town of Dera Bugti, but as fighting spread to a wider area, whole districts have been affected

IRIN, 2 February 2006

"Fact-finding missions, sent by the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP) to the Kohlu area and to Sui and Dera Bugti in December 2005 and January 2006, under the leadership of HRCP's chairperson Asma Jahangir, have found a troubling picture. The fighting has caused widespread damage to buildings, and 85 percent of the 25,000 or so people of Dera Bugti have been forced to flee the town, the commission maintains.

In the Dera Bugti area, schools have been closed for the last month. HRCP says children have not been attending them since March 2005, due to armed skirmishes between tribal militias and paramilitary troops in the area.

[...]

The HRCP team, on its visit, found what looked like a ghost town at Dera Bugti. Almost the entire population, their belongings tied atop trucks, vans, lorries or donkey carts, had left the town and shops had been closed for over a month. On the roads leading out of Dera Bugti, caravans of people could be spotted leaving, watched by security forces manning road blocks.

[...]

Meanwhile, the town of Kohlu remains under a state of siege. Entry to the area is barred, and the 12,000 or so people of the town have remained virtually cut off from the outside world since the middle of December. There have been complaints of food shortages, acute problems in taking the sick or injured to hospitals and normal life has come to a standstill. From towns near Kohlu, such as Kahan, hundreds have fled. The fact that much of the population of the area is nomadic makes it difficult to ascertain the precise number of displaced people."

Raman, 21 January 2006

"[...]. Addressing a press conference at Quetta on January 14, 2006, Malik Zahoor Shahwani, the Vice-Chairman of the Balochistan Chapter of the Pakistan Human Rights Commission, said:
[...]

· Information collected by the team revealed that 53 civilians have been killed and 132 injured during an outbreak of hostilities in the remote area from the last week of December till January 8.

· "No law permits custodial killing and no law-enforcement agency is above the law and entitled to award death sentence to citizens who are in their custody. The Government should act according to constitutional requirements and uphold rule of law to ensure protection of fundamental rights of the people. If those arrested in Dera Bugti were involved in illegal activities, they should be presented before courts for trial."

· A war like situation existed in Dera Bugti "where Government offices are empty, the district coordination officer has shifted his office to Sui, schools are not functioning and vehicles not plying and the bazaar has been closed."

· "A majority of the residents of Dera Bugti town have migrated. Only two persons out of the 250 members of the local Hindu community are still living in the town."

Eighty to eighty-five per cent of the dead and injured victims of the military operation were women and children, and a majority of them non-combatants."

AHRC, 21 July 2006

"Due to the military operations and aerial bombardments the local population have been forced to migrate to safer parts of Balochistan as well as to the nearby borders of Sindh and Punjab provinces. The military have cordoned off Hernai area for the past several days making it impossible for people to come and go. As a result the people are without food, medicines and drinking water. The area where people have taken leave from are predominantly Mach, Kohlo, Usta Mohamad, Sibi, Dera Bugti and some parts of Hanai. The two district provinces of Sibi and Bolan are the worst affected areas of military operations as well as the aerial bombardment. These two districts cover more than 500 kilometres. The displaced are now settled in other areas such as Dera Murad, Jamali, Quetta, Khuzdar, Hub in Balochistan and Kashmore, Jakob Abad and the border areas of Larkana district in Sindh Province. In Punjab Province they have taken shelter in Dera Ghazi Khan district near Usta Mohammad village of Balochistan. According to newspaper reports the displaced are living in terrible conditions with no safe drinking water. According to a report published in the daily Dawn "It is unclear how many Bugti displaced people (DPs) actually poured into neighbouring cities and towns following the outbreak of hostilities between the warring tribesmen and the law-enforcement agencies in the early summer of last year. The Dera Bugti Nazim, Kazim Bugti, puts the number of DPs at over a hundred thousand. His assertions about the involvement of army helicopters in Dera Bugti military operations lend credence to the claims of the DPs. The accusation is stoutly denied by the government, however".

Inter-tribal feuding fuels more conflict in the region (June 2006)

- The government has encouraged the return of the Kalpars which is in conflict with the Bugti tribes
- This has been seen as a deliberate effort on the part of the government to destabilise the Bugti domination in the conflict affected area
- Fighting between the two tribes has been reported on several occasions

IPCS, 28 June 2006

"The Bugti-Kalpar feud has intensified since 1992. While such intra-tribal clashes are part of Baloch tribal history, the two tribes had co-existed in the past; two killings in 1992 changed that situation forever. Amir Hamza, son of Kalpar leader Khan Mohammad Kalpar, was allegedly killed by Akbar Bugti in May 1992 in Dera Bugti during a local bodies' election. Accepted as their leader by all Bugti tribes, Akbar Bugti does not brook any opposition and runs the political and tribal affairs of the region like a monarch complete with imprisonments and punishments. Even today there are some Kalpars 'imprisoned' by Bugti. Prior his killing Amir Hamza was attempting to forge an alliance between the Kalpars and Masuris (another Bugti sub tribe), of which Akbar Bugti did not approve. The Kalpars retaliated in June 1992 by killing Salal Bugti, Akbar Bugti's son.

Ever since, Akbar Bugti's primary goal has been to remove the Kalpars and Masuris from the region or physically eliminate them. Besides these personal and political factors, the Kalpars claim that the Sui gas fields are located in their area, hence they should be the primary beneficiaries of its royalties, which has further infuriated Akbar Bugti.

The federal government has exploited these divisions, depending on the equations between Akbar Bugti and Islamabad. Since January 2006, the federal government has rehabilitated the Kalpars in the Dera Bugti and Sui areas to minimize Akbar Bugti's influence. Besides, there is an effort to project that the situation in Dera Bugti is returning to normalcy with the displaced willing to return. The resettled Kalpars had recently led a procession in Sui supporting Musharraf's policies.

The Bugtis are against the Kalpars' return and have been attacking them ever since the first convoy brought them back. The Bugtis are also instigating those Kalpars who support Akbar Bugti against the returnees.

[...]

Besides the intra-tribal feud, the returnees face problems over issues of settlement and security. Most of Kalpar land has been occupied by the Bugtis and reclaiming it will not be easy."

Nagesh, 8 March 2006

"As part of its strategy to establish its writ and wrest control of areas from tribal chiefs, the government last month relocated members of the Kalpari Badlani sub tribe in Sui. According to reports from Sui, residents started leaving the town soon after the government resettled the Kalpar Badlani sub tribe. Locals said that the resettled tribals were forcing them to leave. Many have left for Dera Murad Jamali, Kandhkot and Shikarpur.

On Feb 14, Another Massuri tribesmen also returned to their homes in the Bekar region of Dera Bugti district, according to APP. A total of 67 families, comprised of 334 people made their way back to their hometown. On their arrival in Bekar, the displaced tribesmen thanked the present government as well as President Pervez Musharraf for their help and support.

Kalpar Bugtis staged a demonstration in favour of development projects in Balochistan, including the building of military cantonments, Kalpar elder Sardar Ahmudan Bugti said to media.

[...]

The protestors denounced Bugti tribe chief Nawab Akbar Bugti and accused him of detaining and torturing Kalpars in private prisons. They also accused the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP) and the Alliance for the Restoration of Democracy (ARD) of being partial to the Bugtis and for ignoring the Kalpars' rights. They demanded the HRCP and ARD to visit the area and observe the Kalpars' situation, who they said were subjected to atrocities. The speakers termed the Sui cantonment a "great gift" for the people of the area. They expressed full support for the policies of President Pervez Musharraf.

[...]

Another batch of some 300 Kalpars recently left for Sui under the supervision of the Frontier Corps. "We now feel safe (in Sui) and normalcy is returning to the area after a long time," said Sardar Ahmadian Bugti. He said that over 4,000 Kalpars had now resettled in Sui and 3,000 still remained in Punjab and Sindh, adding that two to five Kalpar families were returning to the town every day.

The mainstream Bugti tribe, whose tribal elders are already facing a government crackdown, accused the government of sponsoring the return of Kalpar and Masuri clans, warning that it could create a serious law and order problem in their area where Pakistan's biggest Sui Gas Field is located.

[...]

But the move is seen as fuelling more tensions and a law and order problem in the area where tribesmen are already mounting hit-and-run attacks on the security forces and government installations."

Displacement of Hindus

Hindus in Balochistan targeted and displaced (January 2006)

- Anti-Hindu violence in Balochistan has displaced thousands in previous years
- Most of the Hindus left for the province of Sindh to join the Hindu community there
- The military operations in Balochistan during 2005 displaced the remaining Hindus living in Dera Bugti

Khaled Ahmed, 20 May 2004

"Anti-Hindu violence in Balochistan: The Friday Times reported in its issue of March 23-29, 2001, as follows: 'Hundreds of Hindus have been forced to flee their homes and cross over into Sindh. Three Hindus were reported to have been killed in the town of Chaman after clashes between Hindus attempting to protect their homes and Muslim mobs in October. Temples and homes were set ablaze and property, including Hindu shops, destroyed as the growing social intolerance assumed alarming new proportions in Balochistan. In all cases, local extremist groups played a role in triggering the attacks.

'Though the precise number of families which fled was unknown, reports suggested almost half the community of 10,000 Hindus in Lasbela had been forced to leave their homes over the year. In almost all cases, the increased activism by militant religious groups imposed new strains on relations between the majority Muslim and the Hindu communities, who had lived peacefully alongside each other for many decades. The efforts to forcibly convert the Hindus, especially female school students, had a direct role to play in violence against Hindu settlements.

[...]

Plight of Hindus of Sindh: Newline(Dec 2000), pages 77-79, stated that 'the status of the 2.7 million Hindus in Pakistan, who are largely concentrated in Sindh, does not make for a very encouraging picture. Despite the fact that the Hindus in Pakistan have generally maintained a low profile, the general attitude towards them is one of suspicion.

[...]

'Hindus in Pakistan have faced the greatest trials when there has been tension between India and Pakistan. Says an analyst, "From the first Indo-Pak war to the demolition of the Babri mosque in

Ayodhya, Hindus in Pakistan have been perceived as enemies and persecuted." Kidnapping, extortion, and even killing are, meanwhile, common crimes perpetrated against Hindus in Sindh today.

'In Pakistan, the Dalits face different issues. Since they are part of a tiny minority that is 5 per cent of country's total population, and due to also lack of education and literacy, they continue to stick to different forms of Hinduism whatever their half-literate Gurus impart them. Caste Hindus continue their domination only in southern part of Pakistan, especially former Mirpurkhas division, where more than one million Dalits dwell as landless peasants and labourers. The Caste Hindus, though small in numbers, dominate the minority politics through support of their convert relatives and government functionaries. The incidents of atrocities and caste-based discriminations on Dalits are increasing day by day in Tharparkar - a district where 35 per cent people belong to different Dalit communities among a million people - because of growing awareness and assertiveness of the Dalits. Several hundred Dalit employees of Dalit communities were transferred to far-flung areas under different obnoxious pretexts. Cases were initiated against the Dalit political activists. Their rural folks were threatened and even disallowed to graze their livestock on government lands called Gauchar.

'Dalits also suffer in many instances from de facto disenfranchisement. During elections 2002, those unpersuaded by typical electioneering were routinely threatened and beaten by a pro-government political party strongmen in order to compel them to vote for certain candidates. Already under the thumb of local landlords and police officials, Dalit villagers who do not comply had been victimized, beaten, and harassed. In Tharparkar, violence against Dalits is normally treated as a very minor and marginal issue, even by the law-enforcement machinery, whether be it police, the prosecution, or the medico-legal fraternity or often even the judiciary. Non-registration of crimes against Dalits is one of the main problem in Tharparkar. Political influence over the police, and caste, class, religion and gender biases are rampant. It is extremely difficult for helpless Dalits to file complaints, particularly against the powerful individuals and or perpetrators. The theft of livestock of Dalits in Tharparkar is rampant as police never registers any such case. These are very few examples as to how Dalits are dealt with if they display an act to show equality. Hundreds of the incidents of caste discrimination go unreported.'"

The military operations in Balochistan during 2005 displaced the remaining Hindus living there:

Raman, 21 January 2006

"Musharraf has extended his military operation to intimidate the Hindu Balochs also. The Pakistan Army, which looks upon Balochistan as a sensitive area of strategic importance because of its location, natural resources and the location of its nuclear-testing and missile-targeting grounds in the province, has been over the years forcing the Hindus either to leave for India or to shift to Sindh. After the post-Partition anti-Hindu massacres which resulted in the large-scale exodus of Hindus from the then Western Pakistan to India, Balochistan and Sindh were the only provinces still having a Hindu population of a little over a million. The Sindhi and Baloch nationalists looked upon them as their ethnic brothers and sisters and protected them.

[...]

[...] In the early 1970s, the late Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, who looked upon these Hindus as security threats, started forcing them to leave Balochistan. This policy continued under the Governments that followed. After inviting the Chinese to construct the Gwadar port and the Mekran Coastal Highway, Musharraf started forcing the remaining Hindus, whose numbers had considerably dwindled, to shift to Sindh.

[...] The Baloch Sardars took under their protection those Hindus, who resisted Musharraf's attempts to re-settle them outside Balochistan. Nearly 250 Balochs were thus enjoying the protection of the Bugtis in their area. Similarly, there were small clusters of Hindus, who were

living under the protection of the Marris and the Mengals. All these Hindu Balochs are now being forced to leave Balochistan since Musharraf launched the present phase of the military operation on December 18, 2005. According to the Balochistan Chapter of the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, the number of Hindu Balochs living in the Bugti area has come down from 250 to two."

Secondary displacement

Secondary displacement (October 2009)

- In Swat, people have faced secondary displacement after having returned to their homes because of renewed fighting and because of the lack of livelihoods opportunities and humanitarian assistance.
- Secondary displacement goes largely unnoticed because of the lack of assessments.

ICRC, 6 October 2009:

"Is fighting still forcing people to move? In isolated cases, yes. The situation varies from one region to another, and can change rapidly. In Swat, for instance, people who had fled several months ago and then returned have had to abandon their homes once again because of fighting. And certain regions, such as the Federally Administered Tribal Areas, are experiencing hostilities for the first time. Just recently, thousands of people had to take to the roads in Khyber Agency, near Peshawar."

Refugees International, 26 October 2009:

"Return monitoring is taking place in few communities, while secondary displacement goes largely unnoticed because of the lack of assessments. With winter coming, many returnees will need assistance. Livelihoods have been severely affected by the military offensive which destroyed crops before the harvest. Refugees International visited IDP families from Swat who went home, only to be displaced again. "We were receiving no assistance, were under curfew and have no jobs. We simply couldn't stay," a mother of six told Refugees International."

Sectarian violence

Sectarian violence is on the increase, minorities are vulnerable (April 2006)

- Hundreds of people have died in attacks carried out by different Muslim sects or groups on each other
- Religious minorities in Pakistan, including Ahmadis, Christians and Hindus continue to be victims of religiously motivated violence
- The perpetrators of violence against minorities act largely with impunity
- Sectarian violence is on the increase

AI, 13 April 2006

"Over recent years, hundreds of people have died in attacks carried out by different Muslim sects or groups on each other, and by the Muslim majority against members of religious minorities. The organization notes that the Government of Pakistan has consistently failed to prevent sectarian violence, despite repeated verbal undertakings to the international community and minority groups in the country that it would ensure that measures would be taken to end religious discrimination and religiously motivated violence. The government has also failed to ensure that perpetrators of such crimes are brought to justice.

The Government of Pakistan has in the past on several occasions announced steps towards ending religious discrimination and sectarian violence, but has on most occasions gone back on these after protests by religious groups. For example, the use of loudspeakers at mosques to incite violence against other religious groups or individuals of other faiths has been banned but the ban has not been enforced, thereby permitting violence to continue. In addition, several religious groups which are known to have participated in violence against those belonging to other groups, and to have incited others to commit such violent acts were banned by the government in 2002, but this ban has not been enforced.

[...]

Religious minorities in Pakistan, including Ahmadis, Christians and Hindus, also continue to be victims of religiously motivated violence. The discriminatory blasphemy laws, which criminalize the preaching and religious practice by Ahmadis, have further contributed to the atmosphere of intolerance. When the government revoked an earlier undertaking to amend these laws, many people believed that this was an indication that the government did not take the protection of religious minorities seriously. A government undertaking to remove details of religious affiliation in passports and other official documents was annulled in March 2005."

Mir, Amir, 6 June 2005

"The sectarian war between Pakistan's Shias and Sunnis is bloody and deadly. Available figures indicate that, between January 1989 and May 31, 2005 a total of 1,784 Pakistanis were killed, and another 4,279 injured in 1,866 incidents of sectarian violence and terror across the country. This averages out to over 100 persons per year over the past 17 years, with no end in sight. And there are some indications that the trends may worsen. Thus, 187 persons were killed and another 619 were injured in 19 incidents of sectarian violence in 2004. Within the first five months of 2005, 120 Pakistanis have already lost their lives, and 286 have been injured in 30 incidents of sectarian violence.

[...]

Sectarian conflict and violence are an unpleasant reality in Pakistan today, and are becoming more and more intense. Administrative measures taken by the Musharraf-led Government have failed to produce results so far. Analysts believe that the sectarian problem cannot be overcome by such administrative measures alone, while the state itself remains in alliance with extremist elements. The problem for General Musharraf is that it is difficult to promote the so-called *jihad* in J&K without inadvertently promoting many of the Pakistani sectarian outfits. In the process, state authority stands eroded in one way or the other. The increasing militarisation and brutalisation of the conflict shows that there are virtually no sanctuaries left - neither home, nor mosque nor hospital. Not even a jail is safe. And being innocent is not the issue. Just 'being' is enough - being Shia or Sunni, *Barelvi* or *Deobandi*. In a situation where different sectarian groups are vying to prove themselves the standard bearers of Islam, one strategy to secure prominence as a representative of 'true Islam' is obviously by displaying extreme hostility and intolerance to those designated as being 'un-Islamic' by virtue of belonging to religious minorities and minority sects."

POPULATION FIGURES AND PROFILE

Global Figures

Global Figures (2009)

- In North West Frontier Province, 2.7 to 3 million people were displaced after the wave of displacement which began in February 2009.
- As of July 2009, around 50 per cent of the people had returned . Approximately 1.3 million remained displaced.
- According to the Government of Pakistan, as of September 2009, 1.6 millions had returned to their places of origin and 1.1 million remained displaced. However, according to the SSG, 1.85 million had returned and 850,000 remained displaced.
- The continuous movement of IDPs to and from camps as well and back and forth to the areas of origin makes it difficult to assess fixed population.
- In November 2009, the Government of Pakistan, together with UNHCR, has started a re-screening of IDPs in the seven humanitarian hubs in Lower and Upper Dir, Mardan, Nowshera and Swabi District.
- Since May 2009 to mid-October 2009, 100,000 people have fled South Waziristan and have been registered in Tank and D.I. Khan districts.
- From October 2009 to November 2009 up to 350,000 civilians fled a second government offensive in South Waziristan.
- As of the end of November, the total number of IDPs from South Waziristan was standing at 428,000.
- Ongoing military operations are triggering new displacements, especially in the FATA.

Provincial Disaster Management Authority, Government of NWFP, 27 October 2009:

Total number of verified IDP families: 416,481

PRCS, 16 September 2009:

"According to Govt. reports total of 383,190 families were displaced due to the Swat conflict situation. This makes a total of 2.7 million displaced individuals."

Islamic Relief, 31 July 2009:

"We estimate that around 50 per cent of the people fled Lower Swat have now returned to their homes. The rest are likely to come back before the start of the Muslim holy month of Ramadan that begins in late August.

The people that have gone back to Lower Swat are very worried about their situation. They are wary that the conflict may erupt once again and are waiting for the help they need to rebuild their lives."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"The constant movement of IDPs to and from camps as well as back and forth to the areas of origin makes it difficult to assess fixed populations and provide needed assistance and services."

AFP, 3 November 2009:

"Up to 250,000 people have fled the military's major offensive, now into a third week in South Waziristan on the Afghan border, said Lieutenant General Nadeem Ahmad, chief of the state-run agency handling the displaced.

But no one knows the exact number of displaced people or those left in the conflict zone because foreign aid workers have not been able to enter the areas, the humanitarian workers say.

[...]

Normally about 300,000 people live in the part of South Waziristan which the military is seeking to clear of "terrorists". "

UNICEF, 10 August 2009:

"Several hundred thousand people have returned home to Swat and Buner Districts since 13 July. By 7 August, more than 760,000 people had returned to Swat and Bruner. Approximately 1.3 million remain displaced."

OCHA, 11 September 2009:

"NADRA has confirmed newly verified registration numbers for IDPs from Waziristan. Of a total of 17,375 registered families (128,262 individuals), 11,080 families (80,507 individuals) have been verified: 8,281 families (57,967 people) in D.I. Khan District, 2,756 families (19,292 individuals) in Tank District, and 43 families whose place of origin could not be confirmed. Local stakeholders are concerned about the remaining, non-verified registrants."

IRIN, 22 September 2009:

"Just over one million people from northwestern Pakistan are still displaced, according to the National Database and Registration Authority."

Logistics Cluster, 29 September 2009:

"The most recent data from GoP, which is made available on the PaRRSA website has remained unchanged since 17th of September with a total figure of nearly 2.7 million IDPs, out of which 1.6 million have reportedly returned to their place of origin and 1.1 million are still displaced. However, data from SSG was updated more recently, as of 28 September and their data suggest the total number of IDPs is 2.7 million out of which 1.85 million are returns and 850,000 are still displaced."

Oxfam, 1 October 2009:

"In May 2009, Pakistan's North-West Frontier Province became the site of the world's biggest and fastest human displacement in over a decade— and the largest internal displacement ever witnessed in Pakistan's history. Within the space of only a few weeks, an estimated three million Pakistanis fled their homes to escape their army's military offensive against armed insurgents."

OCHA, 12 October 2009:

"Of the 2.7 million people displaced since the start of the conflict in August 2008, 1.02 million are still living with either host families or in the 19 camps supported by the humanitarian community. About 1.65 million people have returned to their homes since July 2009, but ongoing military operations are still triggering new displacements, especially in the Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA). "

Reuters Alertnet, 16 October 2009:

"He also estimated that there were up to another 350,000 civilians still inside South Waziristan. Militants have launched a string of attacks across Pakistan over the last few days killing about 150 people.

[...]

The U.N.'s refugee agency (UNHCR) said 80,000 people from South Waziristan had registered with authorities in the Tank and Dera Ismail Khan districts in North-West Frontier Province by the start of September. "

UNHCR, 16 October 2009:

"More than 20,000 people have fled their homes in northern Pakistan in recent days to escape an anticipated military push against insurgents in the rugged and volatile border region of South Waziristan. Since early this week, an estimated 24,000 people from South Waziristan, comprising about 3,300 families, have arrived in neighbouring Dera Ismail Khan and Tank. Local officials have registered more than 1,600 of these families over the past four days. This brings the number of people who have fled to the two districts from South Waziristan since May to more than 100,000."

Amnesty International, 16 October 2009:

"Amnesty International research teams in the area report that between 90,000 and 150,000 residents of South Waziristan have fled the area since July, when the Pakistani military began a long-range artillery and aerial bombardment in the region."

OCHA, 5 November 2009:

"As of 4 November, 46,039 families (approx. 336,000 individuals) were registered in D.I. Khan and Tank Districts, including 11,080 families (approx. 80,050 individuals) who were displaced before August. Since 13 October, 34,959 families (approx. 255,200 individuals) have been registered in D.I.

Khan and Tank Districts. As the newly displaced are currently being verified by NADRA, the numbers are likely to come down, once this process is complete. So far, 22,600 families (approx. 165,000 individuals) have been verified as internally displaced persons (IDPs)."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"The rate of IDPs returning home from camps and host communities has slowed significantly in the past weeks. [...]As of 1 September, over 234,500 families (1.64 million individuals) have returned to their homes. On 2 September, the Commissionerate of Afghan Refugees reported that almost 24,900 families (140,530 individuals) continued to reside in 21 camps. "

IFRC, 8 October 2009:

"To date, approximately 1.65 million displaced people have returned to their native districts. However, more than 24,000 families are still in the IDP camps."

The Frontier Post, 6 November 2009:

"Dominique Frankefort, deputy director World Food Programme WFP, briefed the participants that more than 2,37,180 families, which is around 1.66 million have repatriated to their homes since September 2008. Adding more he was of the view that two third of total 2.7 million internally displaced persons comprising 3,82,950 families from Swat and Malakand have returned to their homes."

OCHA, 27 November 2009:

South Waziristan: Even though the influx of civilians fleeing the military operations in South Waziristan has slowed down over the past few weeks, between 20 and 22 November 1,622 families (approx. 11,800 individuals) were newly registered in the two hosting districts of D.I. Khan

and Tank. This brings the total number of registered families in the two districts to almost 58,700 (approx. 428,000 individuals).

[...]

Re-screening: The desk review exercise for the re-screening of the displaced population from

Malakand Division has been completed. The data is currently reviewed in the seven humanitarian hubs in Lower and Upper Dir, Mardan, Nowshera and Swabi Districts. The Social Welfare department, with support from UNHCR, has started conducting surveys at the humanitarian hubs to collect more information from IDPs about their plans, including whether they are intending to return to their areas of origin, or not.

Tens of thousands have fled conflict, but no estimate available on total number of IDPs in the country (April 2008)

- According to the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, a total of 1.5 million people were displaced in the country in 2007 due to natural disasters, development projects and military operations in Balochistan, North West Frontier Province and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas.
- It is unknown how many from this 1.5 million are conflict-induced IDPs due to restricted access to conflict areas
- Also unknown is the total number of people in the country displaced prior to 2007 who have not found durable solutions to end their displacement

Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, April 2008:

“Natural disasters including a cyclone, floods induced by torrential rains and sea intrusion, as well as development projects and military operations in Balochistan, NWFP and Pakistan’s tribal areas bordering Afghanistan caused displacement of over 1.5 million people during 2007. This figure does not include those displaced by the October 2005 earthquake, who were yet to return home. Official statistics for internal displacement were largely unavailable. Army operations targeting alleged insurgent groups in parts of Balochistan, Waziristan in the tribal areas and the Swat Valley in the NWFP were the main causes of conflict-induced displacement in 2007.

Statistics regarding such displacement were either unavailable or highly inconsistent. Despite evidence to the contrary, the official remarks on internally displaced persons (IDPs) numbers largely consisted of denial of the displacement figures reported by the media. The government agencies not only failed to prevent displacement caused by non-state actors but their own operations against alleged insurgents in areas populated by civilians displaced hundreds of thousands.”

Information on approximate conflict-induced displacement figures in Balochistan, North West Frontier Province and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas is in the geographical distribution envelopes.

Geographical distribution

Hundreds of thousands estimated to be short-term IDPs in North West Frontier Province (February 2008)

- Hundreds of thousands of people were displaced in the Swat Valley due to fighting between army and extremist forces in October and November 2007

- Some estimates place the number of IDPs in the Valley at 400,000, others at 500,000 and still others at 900,000 or 60 per cent of the Valley's 1.5 million population
- Once the army had seized control of most of the Valley in early December large numbers of displaced returned

Media News Line Agency, February 2008:

"In the clash that followed the security forces suffered massive casualties and more than 13 Pakistani security personnel were beheaded by armed men in the Matta and Charbagh areas of the district. Of the valley's 1.5 million population some 400,000 were displaced by the fighting."

Kashmir Herald, December 2007:

"With little evidence of state capacities to control or protect, the common people of Swat have been extraordinarily vulnerable. Indeed, thousands fled their villages in the Kabal sub-division and other areas of Swat after announcements were made by SFs asking them to leave the area, as the Army was set to launch a massive operation against what it called terrorists hiding there. Safdar Sial and Aqeel Yusafzai reported that about 60 per cent of the 1.5 million inhabitants have left the area. Unnamed officials confirmed, on November 19, that at least 500,000 people had fled the region.

[...]

On their part, the militants are said to have made announcements asking people not to leave their homes as they had arranged for suicide bombers to attack the SFs, if the latter came out of their bases to attack the militants."

Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies, November 2007:

"The idyllic valley of Swat, one of Pakistan's main tourist attractions, has over the last six months turned into a theatre of insurgency by religious extremists. Led by Maulana Fazlullah, a village cleric and a leader of the 'banned' Tehreek-e-Nifaz-e-Shariat-e-Muhammadi (TNSM), armed militants demanding enforcement of Sharia laws are taking on Pakistan's paramilitary and regular army troops. There have been at least 63 terrorist attacks in Swat region since July this year, including six suicide bombings and numerous public beheadings. Most of these attacks—39 till November 15, to be precise—were targeted at the security forces, killing 97 security personnel and injuring another 127. The number of militants and other civilians killed in the fighting runs into hundreds as the Pakistan Army has moved in to quell the pro-Taliban movement, which has taken control of six sub-divisions in the district of Swat.

In addition, the violence has forced thousands of people to flee their homes. PIPS sources say that about 60 per cent of the 1.5 million Swat valley inhabitants have left the area. Hounded, on the one hand, by the Taliban and vulnerable to military strikes on the other, they have either taken refuge with their relatives or moved to other cities like Mardan, Buner, Peshawar, Rawalpindi and Karachi."

Dawn, December 2007:

"Swat valley is slowly returning to normality with large numbers of displaced people coming back to areas now under the control of security forces.

[...]

Scores of families have returned to secured areas, including Shakardara, Koza Banda, Bara Banda, Ningolai, Khwazakhela and Kot.

Public transport carrying people and their luggage could be seen throughout the day on roads. The displaced people had been taking shelter mostly with their relatives in Mingora and other towns. Some had shifted to other cities such as Mardan, Nowshera and Peshawar."

Tens of thousands displaced in North and South Waziristan from October 2007 to January 2008 (February 2008)

- Civilians in North Waziristan were caught in the crossfire between the army and militants in October 2007
- 80,000 fled from Mirali in North Waziristan to nearby districts
- In January 2008, conflict in South Waziristan forced thousands of tribal families to flee
- Roughly 150,000 people left their homes in the Mehsud areas and moved to other areas
- Despite a temporary truce between the army and militants, people continued to flee to adjoining districts of South Waziristan

Dawn, October 2007:

"The Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP) on Friday called upon the government and militants to immediately end hostilities in North Waziristan and halt attacks on innocent civilians. "Civilians in North Waziristan are getting caught in the crossfire between the military and the militants," Kamran Arif, HRCP NWFP chapter vice-chairperson, said in a press release issued here on Friday. "We seek an immediate end to hostilities, bombing of villages and use of heavy weapons that endanger the lives of civilian population," he said. Over 250 people were killed when heavy fighting broke out in the area between the military and militants on October 7. While the army claimed that the casualties included only soldiers and militants, local people reported civilian deaths and massive displacement of population. Mr Arif said that on October 10, tribesmen in Ipi Faqir, a village close to Mirali, buried 50 people killed in air strikes, which also destroyed houses and shops. "When the militants seek refuge in villages, the military follows them with gunship helicopters and fighter jets, bombing houses and markets," a resident of Ipi Faqir told HRCP at a hospital in Peshawar where his brother was receiving treatment for multiple injuries suffered in a rocket attack. "We are here in this hospital in Peshawar. I invite the authorities to come and prove if we are militants or their supporters." Eyewitness reports said the fighting had displaced thousands of people, forcing many to seek refuge in the nearby Bannu and D.I. Khan districts. Some 80,000 people left Mirali, the second largest town in North Waziristan, where the military operation against militants was taking place. The dead and the wounded were being brought to hospitals in Bannu and Peshawar."

Dawn, February 2008:

"Despite reports of a temporary truce between militants and security forces, exodus continued from South Waziristan to adjoining districts of Dera Ismail Khan, Tank and Bannu. To cope with the situation, local administrations of Dera Ismail Khan and other districts are considering establishing relief camps for the displaced families. Sources told Dawn that setting up of two refugee camps in Dera Ismail Khan was on the cards, where they would also be provided with food, medical facilities and other essentials of daily life. The migrated tribesmen said the military operation and influence of militant groups in the troubled region had virtually paralysed life in the Mehsud tribe areas, including Spinkai Raghznai and Kotkai, and surrounding areas of the Frontier Region of Jandola. They said the affected areas were presenting a deserted look after evacuation of local people.

[...]

Over 1,000 displaced families (about 10 thousand people) have come to Dera Ismail Khan alone.

[...]

A meeting of local officials was held here to decide a site for establishing a relief camp. Speaking at a press conference in Dera Ismail Khan, a 15-member committee of tribal elders said war was not a solution and the matter could only be resolved through dialogue (tribal jirga). The elders included Mir Zaman Mehsud, Wasim Khan Mehsud, Junabat Khan Mehsud, Khan Wali Khan Mehsud and Salauddin Mehsud. The tribal leaders demanded immediate end to the military operation and called for political solution to the dispute. They said the fighting between security forces and militants had turned the whole region into a battlefield where the life of an ordinary man was unsafe. They said thousands of tribesmen had vacated their homes and were forced to live like nomads. They said the affected people had no links with militants, rather they were the sufferers of a war imposed on their soil by some people for their vested interests."

Dawn, February 2008:

"An unofficial ceasefire agreed between security forces and militants has been holding ground in the troubled South Waziristan tribal region since Saturday, according to a tribal parliamentarian.

[...]

He said that back-door talks were under way to bring the two sides to the negotiation table. Locals said that the guns had been silent over the past two days. Troops, backed by tanks and helicopters, had launched an operation against the militants in several areas of the Mehsud tribe last month, killing scores of militants. Many soldiers also lost their lives. Hundreds of local people were displaced by the conflict.

[...]

Roughly 150,000 people had left their homes in the Mehsud areas and moved to other areas. He said that people in Tiarza tehsil, Berwand, Sararogha, and Kaniguram had left their homes for safer places because of relentless shelling. A large number of people have migrated to Karachi and Hyderabad."

Thousands reported displaced due to fighting in North Waziristan (March 2006)

- Thousands reported displaced, but displacement and return movements have not been monitored

COE-DMHA, 9 March 2006:

"Although thousands of civilians have been reportedly displaced, exact numbers are difficult to procure because both foreign and local journalists are barred from the region, however, local reports say that at least 1,000 families have fled fighting in Miran Shah."

HRW, 8 March 2006:

"Thousands of civilians have fled their homes since the Pakistani army, backed by helicopter gunships, began operations to put down a rebellion in the town of Miran Shah, the capital of North Waziristan Agency, on March 3.

[...]

On March 16, 2004, army and paramilitary troops reportedly evicted between 25,000 and 35,000 civilians from the area in and around the village of Kalusha in just a few hours. They remained without shelter for the two-week-long operation and returned to find that the army had destroyed scores of homes, cattle, and crops."

BBC, 7 March 2006:

"Several hundred militants seized government buildings in Miran Shah on Saturday. It followed the bombing of an alleged militant hideout by security forces last week that killed dozens of people.

The main bazaar in the town is without electricity, and the only telephones that are working are those used by the local administration, our correspondent says.

[...]

Thousands of people have already fled Miran Shah, while many more continue to leave to escape the clashes, witnesses said.

"We were waiting for the day. It was fighting all night and we feared that we might be hit by fire from a helicopter," Mohammad Anwar, a resident who was fleeing with his family, told the Associated Press."

Differing estimates of displacement due to conflict in Balochistan (April 2008)

- By early 2008, estimates of the displaced in Balochistan ranged from 25,000 IDPs from Dera Bugti to more than 200,000 in Kohlu district alone
- The Human Rights Commission of Pakistan noted that IDPs in Balochistan remain invisible because of ongoing military operations and a media ban
- It is unknown how many of the displaced have returned home

International Crisis Group, October 2007:

"In May 2007, addressing a public meeting in Sui subdistrict of Dera Bugti, President Musharraf claimed that 65,000 of a total of 90,000 IDPs from Dera Bugti had returned home. A regional human rights organisation, however, believes some 200,000 persons are still displaced. Local estimates are even higher. Abdul Wahab Baloch, head of the Baloch Rights Council, an NGO, insists that more than 200,000 have been displaced from Kohlu district alone, and government neglect has resulted in many deaths. The media is denied access to the IDPs and their homes in the conflict zones, so it is impossible to verify the conflicting claims."

Pakistan Human Rights Commission, April 2008:

"IDPs in Balochistan largely remained invisible because of the continuing military operation and restrictions on media access to them. A report said in December 2006 that 84,000 people displaced by the conflict in Balochistan were in need of immediate food aid. The government continued to dispute the figures in 2007 and claimed that thousands of displaced families had returned home. The opposition parties insisted that over 100,000 were still homeless."

Asian Human Rights Commission, July 2006:

"Due to the military operations and aerial bombardments the local population have been forced to migrate to safer parts of Balochistan as well as to the nearby borders of Sindh and Punjab provinces. The military have cordoned off Hernai area for the past several days making it impossible for people to come and go. As a result the people are without food, medicines and drinking water. The area where people have taken leave from are predominantly Mach, Kohlo, Usta Mohamad, Sibi, Dera Bugti and some parts of Hanai. The two district provinces of Sibi and Bolan are the worst affected areas of military operations as well as the aerial bombardment. These two districts cover more than 500 kilometres. The displaced are now settled in other areas such as Dera Murad, Jamali, Quetta, Khuzdar, Hub in Balochistan and Kashmore, Jakob Abad and the border areas of Larkana district in Sindh Province. In Punjab Province they have taken shelter in Dera Ghazi Khan district near Usta Mohammad village of Balochistan. According to newspaper reports the displaced are living in terrible conditions with no safe drinking water. According to a report published in the daily Dawn "It is unclear how many Bugti displaced people (DPs) actually poured into neighbouring cities and towns following the outbreak of hostilities between the warring tribesmen and the law-enforcement agencies in the early summer of last

year. The Dera Bugti Nazim, Kazim Bugti, puts the number of DPs at over a hundred thousand. His assertions about the involvement of army helicopters in Dera Bugti military operations lend credence to the claims of the DPs. The accusation is stoutly denied by the government, however".

Integrated Regional Information Networks, August 2006:

"HRCP estimates that in all, 100,000 people were displaced in the Dera Bugti and Kohlu districts alone. Abdul Samad Lasi, Dera Bugti's district coordination officer, says law and order have since been restored, with thousands of people returning.

However, several thousand people, like Zubaida, continue to live in temporary settlements with no provisions for water, sanitation, food, schooling or health care."

Dawn, July 2006:

"It is unclear how many Bugti displaced people (DPs) actually poured into neighbouring cities and towns following the outbreak of hostilities between the warring tribesmen and the law-enforcement agencies in the early summer of last year [spring 2005].

The Dera Bugti Nazim, Kazim Bugti, puts the number of DPs at over a hundred thousand. His assertions about the involvement of army helicopters in Dera Bugti military operations lend credence to the claims of the DPs. The accusation is stoutly denied by the government, however."

Dawn, July 2006:

"According to the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, in the current situation in Dera Bugti almost 50,000 people have fled their villages and settlements. Opposition leaders say they are living in deplorable conditions and have no access to potable water, food and other basic necessities. However, official sources assert that the government has set up camps for these DPs (displaced persons). They also state that financial help is not needed since the people who have fled Dera Bugti are very well off. While the government and some of tribal leaders remain firmly cemented in their positions, what is clear is that there is no sign of any imminent relief to a people who can at best be described as dispossessed."

After fighting starting late December 2005 reportedly displaced 90 per cent of the population in the Dera Bugti and Kohlu districts

Displacement of Hindus in Pakistan (May 2004)

Khaled Ahmed, 21 May 2004:

"Anti-Hindu violence in Balochistan: The Friday Times reported in its issue of March 23-29, 2001, as follows: 'Hundreds of Hindus have been forced to flee their homes and cross over into Sindh. Three Hindus were reported to have been killed in the town of Chaman after clashes between Hindus attempting to protect their homes and Muslim mobs in October. Temples and homes were set ablaze and property, including Hindu shops, destroyed as the growing social intolerance assumed alarming new proportions in Balochistan. In all cases, local extremist groups played a role in triggering the attacks.

'Though the precise number of families which fled was unknown, reports suggested almost half the community of 10,000 Hindus in Lasbela had been forced to leave their homes over the year.'

PATTERNS OF DISPLACEMENT

General

Displacement in NWFP, Malakand Division (2009)

- The security operation in District Dir Lower, Bunair and Swat resulted in the large displacement of the population to Dir Upper, Malakand Agency, Swabi, Mardan and HariPur.
- More than 1.7 million people have fled the fighting in the Swat, Malakand and other restive areas of the NWFP.
- Around 0.3 million people are still on the move in troubled areas, such as Swat, Dir Lower and Dir Upper and face difficulties in travelling to safer places due to curfew and heavy fighting.

Swat Youth Front, May 2009:

"The latest security operation in District Dir Lower, Bunair and Swat resulted in the large displacement of the population of that area migrated to nearby safe places of Dir Upper, Malakand Agency, Swabi, Mardan and HariPur. United Nations sources has declared IDPs situation in Pakistan as the worst human displacement of the world in last fifteen years. They have also claimed that this is more critical than the displacement of Rwanda in 1994. More than 1.7 million Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) forced to flee fighting in the Swat, Malakand and other restive areas and the influx of IDPs is increasing day by day. Situation in the troubled areas of NWFP has become volatile as hundreds of thousands of more people are displaced from Swat and Dir Upper.

Around 0.3 million are still on the move in different troubled areas especially in Swat, Dir lower and Dir upper. They are facing serious difficulties in traveling to safer places due to logistic problems, continuous curfew and heavy fighting."

Khyber Agency IDPs (September 2009)

- In September 2009, between 56,000 and 100,000 people have fled the Khyber Agency in the Federally Administrated Tribal Areas.
- Over 100,000 people have arrived in Peshawar.

IRIN, 16 September 2009:

"Between 56,000 and 100,000 people have fled the Khyber Agency in the Federally Administered Tribal Areas since 1 September, the provincial government of Pakistan's North West Frontier Province (NWFP) has said.

(...)

"Over 100,000 people have arrived in Peshawar since the military mounted an offensive," NWFP information minister Mian Iftikhar Hussain told the media. "We have asked the federal government to provide us assistance to cope with the situation and we intend to set up a camp for them," he said."

Bajaur and Mohmand IDPs to Nowshera (November 2009)

- Almost 1 million people from previous waves of displacement out of Bajaur, Mohmand and Swat remain displaced and in need of assistance.
- Out of these, 88,000 are living in 10 camps in NWFP.
- Jozlai camp, in Nowshera hosts the larger number of people (61,000), including some 27,000 people from Bajaur and Bara.

UNHCR, 6 November 2009:

"[A]n estimated one million people from previous waves of displacement out of Bajaur, Mohmand, Swat, remain displaced and in need of ongoing humanitarian assistance. This includes some 88,000 people in 10 camps in NWFP, for whom UNHCR is currently preparing a package of extra relief supplies for winter. Also, existing tents will be replaced with all-weather tents to provide extra insulation. Jalozi camp, in Nowshera, hosts the largest number of people (61,000) including some 27,000 people from Bajaur and Bara (Khyber agency) who have been registered in the camp since last month. The group includes a mix of people who recently fled renewed fighting in Bajaur and Bara, alongside those who had fled earlier and stayed with host families. This latter group had recently sought refuge in the camp as their resources became depleted."

Waziri IDPs to DI Khan, Tank, Zhob, Bannu, and Karachi (November 2009)

- Most of people from South Waziristan fled to D.I Khan and Tank Districts.
- Some IDPs also arrived in Zhob District in Balochistan and Bannu District in NWFP.
- Other moved to Majeed Colony in the city of Karachi.

OCHA, 5 November 2009:

According to government sources, civilians from South Waziristan are also arriving in Zhob District in Balochistan and Bannu District in North West Frontier Province (NWFP). However, most of these IDPs are in transit and eventually move on to D.I. Khan and Tank Districts.

IRIN, 17 November 2009:

As temperatures get closer to freezing in Pakistan's South Waziristan tribal agency near the border with Afghanistan, some people affected by fighting between government troops and militants have begun to move further from the conflict zone.

Some 30-35 families of internally displaced persons (IDPs) from South Waziristan had recently arrived in Majeed Colony in the port city of Karachi where many people originally from North West Frontier Province (NWFP) live, said local residents. Most had moved in with relatives or rented accommodation.

North West Frontier Province/Swat Valley: Civilians flee to other parts of Swat and NWFP (April 2008)

- Thousands fled their villages in Mingora and Matta after army warnings that it was about to launch a massive operation against militants
- Many IDPs moved to calmer areas of Swat and nearby towns like Mardan
- Some IDPs rented houses in safer towns, but many more had to find shelter in government schools in the towns or go to remote villages in the mountains
- Others took refuge in Peshawar or other parts of North West Frontier Province

- Some IDPs went further to Rawalpindi and Karachi

Kashmir Herald, December 2007:

"With little evidence of state capacities to control or protect, the common people of Swat have been extraordinarily vulnerable. Indeed, thousands fled their villages in the Kabal sub-division and other areas of Swat after announcements were made by SFs asking them to leave the area, as the Army was set to launch a massive operation against what it called terrorists hiding there. Safdar Sial and Aqeel Yusafzai reported that about 60 per cent of the 1.5 million inhabitants have left the area. Unnamed officials confirmed, on November 19, that at least 500,000 people had fled the region. A majority of them had reportedly shifted to the Malakand Agency, Mardan, Charsadda, Nowshera, Peshawar and Islamabad. A majority of villagers in areas like Sangota, Faza Gat, Hayatabad, Koza and Bara Bandai, Nangolai, Kanju, Shakar Dara, Sher Palam, Behrain, Mianadam, Oshu, Gabral, Shawar and Chakrial have also reportedly abandoned their homes."

Buneri, November 2007:

"Locals say that about 60% of the 1.5 million population in Swat valley have left their houses and take refuge either with their relatives or rented houses in Mardan, Buner, Peshawar, Rawalpindi and Karachi."

Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, April 2008:

"The valley is home to around 1.5 million people. Estimates varied as to the extent of displacement, but at the height of the conflict, some reports suggested that up to 60% of people in the valley had fled, mainly to the homes of friends and relatives. Others rented houses in safer nearby towns, but many more had no option but to find shelter in government schools in towns nearby or head to remote villages in the mountains. In Mingora, Swat's second-largest town, rents rose sharply due to the large number of families seeking sanctuary there, with many residents complaining of a housing shortage."

Reuters, October 2007:

"Clashes have also taken place in and around the congested city of Mingora, adjacent to Swat's administrative headquarters at Saidu Sharif, and in villages of the Matta administrative unit.

At least 60 militants have been killed in three days of clashes, while dozens more have been injured, including civilians, and hundreds, if not thousands, have reportedly fled, Pakistani media said on 30 October. Some are taking refuge with relatives in Peshawar or other parts of NWFP, while others have simply moved to calmer areas of Swat itself. "Most people are moving to nearby towns in the area like Mardan," said Imran Khan, coordinator in Peshawar for the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan."

Waziristan: IDPs flee air strikes and artillery shelling (February 2008)

- In October 2007 villagers in North Waziristan fled their homes after air strikes and artillery shelling
- Many moved to Bannu and Peshawar, leaving behind a family member to watch over possessions
- After clashes in South Waziristan in January 2008, hundreds of displaced families- made up mostly of women, children and elderly- migrated to Tank district and North Waziristan

- Roughly 150,000 people had to leave their homes in the Mehsud tribal area of South Waziristan because of shelling and have migrated as far away as Karachi and Hyderabad.

Dawn, October 2007:

"Eyewitnesses said that people of several villages had left their homes after the air strikes and artillery shelling. They said that a large number of families were heading towards Bannu district.

[...]

Residents said that 50 bodies had been laid to rest in Ipi, 20 in Haiderkhel and three in Zairaki villages which were bombed on Tuesday. They said the intense air strikes and artillery fire had turned most of the Ipi village into rubbles. Fighter jets had bombed Ipi and adjoining areas, with 12 bombs dropped on a village market. Locals claimed that innocent people had been killed in the attack.

[...]

The witnesses said that a large number of families were streaming out of Ipi, Haiderkhel, Mosaki, Hurmaz, Hasukhel, Barokhel, Milagan, Zairaki and Esori villages of Mirali and moving to Bannu and other settled districts.

[...]

Unconfirmed reports said that thousands of people had left their homes in Mirali. They are facing shortage of food."

Integrated Regional Information Networks, October 2007:

"HRCP said in a 12 October statement that most of the 80,000 people displaced by the fighting had gone to neighbouring Bannu. Others had headed for Peshawar, some 190km to the north, and a number headed straight for hospitals seeking treatment for wounded family members. "In most cases, as the fighting intensified, families fled, just heading out along the road to Bannu or elsewhere in lorries, trucks, vans or on foot – even though many had nowhere to go," Aurangzeb Ali told IRIN. He said almost all women and children left, with Mirali, having a previous population of 50,000, becoming a "virtual ghost town". Many families left just a single male member behind to watch over houses and possessions abandoned as they fled."

The News, October 2007:

"Such was the severity of the fighting that whole villages were emptied of their population and no Eidul Fitr prayers could be offered. Village and tribal elders claimed that more than 80,000 people were displaced and 90 per cent population of Mir Ali town, populated by 50,000, abandoned their homes due to fear of bombing by the Pakistan Air Force. Most walked to safer destinations, spending cold nights in the open and cursing all those who made them suffer in the holy month of Ramazan. Civilian casualties were high, up to 60 according to some estimates, and the injured included men, women and children aged two years to 70.

Some of the wounded were brought with great difficulty and at a huge cost to Bannu and Peshawar, and that is how the media and the world got to hear heart-rending stories of human suffering resulting from military operations and militants' attacks. The military's reluctance to admit civilian deaths as a result of the bombing by its warplanes and its insistence that those killed were all militants and terrorists inflamed passions and deprived it of whatever little support it still had in North Waziristan. This was skillfully exploited by the militants, who accused the government of resorting to indiscriminate aerial bombing and artillery shelling densely populated villages."

Dawn, January 2008:

"A large number of people moved out of the conflict-hit areas of South Waziristan as fierce clashes between security forces and militants continued on Sunday night and Monday, officials and local people said.

[...]

Information gathered from different sources indicated that hundreds of displaced families, mostly women, children and elders, were migrating to the adjacent Tank district and North Waziristan.

"We fear a major humanitarian crisis if the conflict continues on the same scale in the region," said Gul Rehman, a Tank-based social activist who visited the troubled areas. He said that a large number of families belonging to the Mahsud tribe had been living in open areas and parks in Tank.

"The displaced people had to walk for almost two days to reach Jandola and Tank," Mr Rehman said.

He said that the terrain was very rough and people had faced numerous problems on their way, including non-availability of food and water.

[...]

There are unconfirmed reports about some children dying due to severe cold. "I have seen a man carrying body of his seven-year-old son who died due to freezing weather," a resident of Tank City said. He said that witnesses had told him that about 30 children had died over the past week. Over 100 displaced families have reached Miramshah in North Waziristan. Local elder Fazl Subhan, who is contesting the elections, has set up relief centres in Miramshah, Mirali and Esha. Witnesses said that transporters were charging high fares from the displaced people. "From Omer Adda to Tank City, hardly a distance of 5km, the transporters are charging Rs1,000," said a resident.

The displaced families are also looking for houses on rent and a committee of Mahsud tribesmen is helping them.

The sources said that heavy clashes which had started on Sunday night in Nawaz Kot, Kotkai and Berwand areas of South Waziristan continued on Monday. Security forces and helicopter gunships bombed suspected militant locations. Troops fired heavy artillery from their bases in Jandola, Manzai and Tank."

Dawn, February 2008:

"An unofficial ceasefire agreed between security forces and militants has been holding ground in the troubled South Waziristan tribal region since Saturday, according to a tribal parliamentarian.

[...]

He said that back-door talks were under way to bring the two sides to the negotiation table. Locals said that the guns had been silent over the past two days. Troops, backed by tanks and helicopters, had launched an operation against the militants in several areas of the Mehsud tribe last month, killing scores of militants. Many soldiers also lost their lives. Hundreds of local people were displaced by the conflict.

[...]

Roughly 150,000 people had left their homes in the Mehsud areas and moved to other areas. He said that people in Tiarza tehsil, Berwand, Sararogha, and Kaniguram had left their homes for safer places because of relentless shelling. A large number of people have migrated to Karachi and Hyderabad."

Balochistan: Tens of thousands remain displaced (June 2007)

- IDPs in Balochistan are continuing to stay in towns and urban centers

- Small groups of IDPs are encamped over vast and isolated area
- More than two years since the insurgency, most of the IDPs from Dera Bugti and Sui have not returned

Newsline, June 2007:

"The situation in Balochistan is, indeed, bleak. Thousands remain displaced and are living in miserable conditions. Many have poured into neighbouring towns and those with better resources have made it to the urban centres. The low income peasants have fared the worst. Small groups of displaced peasant families remain encamped over a vast and isolated area that is becoming increasingly insecure as the fighting spreads. [...]

On the outskirts of towns like Dera Murad Jamali and Jhapat, some native landowners have allowed several families to stay on as labourers. But the locals are often hostile. Old tribal enmities and newer political alliances further complicate the situation. Fear of reprisal by security agencies also prevents locals from aiding refugees.

[...]

Almost two years on since the insurgency began, and several months after the government announced that peace had returned to the area, most of the population of Dera Bugti and Sui has not returned. "

Balochistan: civilians fled to secure areas of balochistan as well as to the Sindh and Punjab provinces

AHRC, 21 July 2006:

"Due to the military operations and aerial bombardments the local population have been forced to migrate to safer parts of Balochistan as well as to the nearby borders of Sindh and Punjab provinces. The military have cordoned off Hernai area for the past several days making it impossible for people to come and go. As a result the people are without food, medicines and drinking water. The area where people have taken leave from are predominantly Mach, Kohlo, Usta Mohamad, Sibi, Dera Bugti and some parts of Hanai. The two district provinces of Sibi and Bolan are the worst affected areas of military operations as well as the aerial bombardment. These two districts cover more than 500 kilometres. The displaced are now settled in other areas such as Dera Murad, Jamali, Quetta, Khuzdar, Hub in Balochistan and Kashmore, Jackob Abad and the border areas of Larkana district in Sindh Province. In Punjab Province they have taken shelter in Dera Ghazi Khan district near Usta Mohammad village of Balochistan. According to newspaper reports the displaced are living in terrible conditions with no safe drinking water. According to a report published in the daily Dawn "It is unclear how many Bugti displaced people (DPs) actually poured into neighbouring cities and towns following the outbreak of hostilities between the warring tribesmen and the law-enforcement agencies in the early summer of last year. The Dera Bugti Nazim, Kazim Bugti, puts the number of DPs at over a hundred thousand. His assertions about the involvement of army helicopters in Dera Bugti military operations lend credence to the claims of the DPs. The accusation is stoutly denied by the government, however". The displaced have to carry water from at least one to three kilometers away. No medical help is being provided to them. They are mostly children and women suffering from diarrhea, dehydration, malaria and high fevers. Some cases of deaths have been reported but not confirmed by any hospitals."

PHYSICAL SECURITY & FREEDOM OF MOVEMENT

General

General (November 2009)

- No figures about civilian casualties are available due to the fragile security situation and the limited access to fighting areas.
- MSF is working in the hospital of Timurgara in Lower Dir and in June 2009 it has had some 700 patients every week, presenting wounds caused by bullets or explosions.
- Security concerns prevent many Cluster members from accessing return areas of Swat, Buner, Shangla and Dir District.
- Very few international aid groups are able to operate in South Waziristan due to insecurity.
- IDPs trying to flee South Waziristan report hardships on their way out of the conflict area. Some families have been killed after being hit by a bomb while trying to flee. Some civilians are still trapped in the areas where fighting takes place.
- IDPs from Bajaur agency in FATA, who have been told to return to their homes, went back to an insecure environment, where military operations were still taking place. Some had to go back into displacement.
- In Malakand Division but also in Swat, Lower Dir and Buner, IDPs who have returned are still unsafe due to the continuous fighting.
- In the FATA and NWFP, unexploded weapons and mines continue to threaten civilians' lives. ICRC carries out mine-risk education sessions for IDPs before their repatriation.
- In October 2009, the EU expressed concern about the security situation and the hundreds of civilians victims of indiscriminate attacks in Pakistan and urged the Government of Pakistan to meet its obligations to protect the civilian population.
- In October 2009, the Special Rapporteur on extrajudicial, summary or arbitrary executions reported that the US military had used unmanned drones to carry out the targeted executions of Taliban members and other militants operating in Pakistan and Afghanistan.

Médecins sans Frontières, 29 Juin 2009:

" « La semaine dernière lorsque j'étais à Timurgara, 10 patients blessés par les combats sont arrivés le même jour dans le service des urgences. Parmi eux, il y avait quatre enfants », raconte Stefan Van Der Mussele, superviseur médical pour MSF dans le Lower Dir.

« Les blessures avaient été causées par des balles ou des explosions. Deux frères âgés de cinq et six ans figuraient parmi les blessés. L'un d'eux était inconscient et souffrait de blessures au cou et à la tête. Ils sont arrivés accompagnés de trois femmes, blessées elles aussi. En salle de réanimation, un homme n'a pas survécu : souffrant d'une large blessure à la tête, son cerveau avait été touché. Dans la même pièce, on a soigné un enfant de 8 ans accompagné de son père recouvert de sang, qui faisait de son mieux pour rester calme et soutenir son fils. »

Depuis le mois de juin, l'équipe médicale de MSF de l'hôpital de Timurgara a soigné 700 personnes en moyenne chaque semaine dans le service d'urgence. Depuis le 26 avril, MSF a également pris en charge 159 blessés de guerre. Les patients qui nécessitent une intervention chirurgicale sont d'abord stabilisés avant d'être transférés vers le département chirurgical où travaillent les chirurgiens du ministère de la Santé.

L'assouplissement des couvre-feux permet à davantage de patients de se rendre à Timurgara. « Avant, les blessés de guerre qui arrivaient de Swat à Timurgara devaient traverser les collines pour éviter les grands axes routiers aux heures de couvre-feu. L'un des patients est arrivé avec les intestins à l'air. Il avait été amené dans cet état par sa famille, et a survécu malgré tout », raconte encore Stefan. « Les patients arrivent maintenant en empruntant les routes principales, parfois même par ambulance. » "

Swat Youth Front, 2009:

"Although no confirm figures about civilian casualties are available due to the fragile situation in the affected areas, but a number of eyewitnesses from different areas has confirmed that scores of dead bodies of civilians are lying in Swat. People of the affected areas are passing from trauma and painful conditions."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"The District Coordination and District Revenue Officers in the return areas of Swat, Buner, Shangla and Dir Districts requested that the Cluster carry out damage needs assessments in the areas of return as they do not have the capacity to do so. However, security concerns prevent many Cluster members from accessing these areas."

Amnesty International, 16 October 2009:

"Due to insecurity in the area, only one local nongovernment organization, FIDA, has been given the task of assisting the displaced.

"Conditions around South Waziristan are even worse than in Swat, because few international aid groups, whether international or local, are able to operate in this highly insecure area. Add to that the impending cold weather and the potential for a real calamity is quite high," said Sam Zarifi. "

IRIN, 22 October 2009:

"Many internally displaced persons (IDPs) who have fled South Waziristan tell harrowing tales of rockets hitting roads or houses as they tried to leave areas where Taliban militants are fighting government forces.

"I watched my cousin's home burst into flames after being hit by a bomb. Fortunately he had taken his family away last week," said Miran Gul, an IDP from a village near Makine in South Waziristan.

Miran Gul said he had to "walk for over 12 hours" to reach the town of Razmak in North Waziristan, from where he got transport to Peshawar.

The UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) in its latest situation [report](#) said: "The IDPs report hardships on their way out of the conflict area as all main roads are blocked and tightly controlled... there is a curfew imposed in all conflict-affected parts of South Waziristan."

[Dawn newspaper reported](#) that 12 members of a family were killed after being hit by a bomb while trying to flee South Waziristan.

[...]

The fighting is reported by people who have come out of the area as being "fierce", and people are concerned about relatives still trapped there.

"My brother is still based near Wana [principal town of Waziristan] with our parents, who refused to leave the family home. Contact is difficult, because telephone services are bad, and I worry constantly about them," said Azam Khan, now in Peshawar. "

Council of the European Union, 27 October 2009:

"The Council acknowledges the ongoing efforts of the government of Pakistan to reestablish full control over South Waziristan, as an important step in countering instability, terrorism and cross-border insurgency. The EU urges Pakistan to meet its obligations to protect the civilian population. The EU stands ready to assist all civilians affected by fighting in accordance with

basic humanitarian principles and provided proper access can be granted and needs assessed. The EU is concerned about the security situation in Pakistan and regrets that hundreds of innocent civilians have become victims of indiscriminate attacks aimed at destabilising the Pakistani state. The EU is firm in its support of the government of Pakistan and encourages it to adopt a comprehensive strategy to fight terrorism and address its root causes.

[...]

The EU and its Member States will identify resources which can in the longer term be used to fully implement the plan. At the same time, the EU will continue to respond to the humanitarian crisis in Pakistan which is likely to continue well into 2010. The EU stresses the importance of respect for humanitarian space and full access to all those affected by the conflict.

[...]

The EU will put continued emphasis on strengthening and improving the public education system whilst at the same time exploring means to prevent the use of schools as incubators for extremism. Activities of important partners in this field is given due regard."

UN News, 28 October 2009:

"The US military has used unmanned drones and so-called "predators" to carry out the targeted executions of Taliban members and other militants operating in neighbouring Pakistan and Afghanistan, he noted to journalists after presenting the report.

"While there may be circumstances in which the use of such techniques is consistent with applicable international law, this can only be determined in light of information about the legal basis on which particular individuals have been targeted, the measures taken to ensure conformity with the international humanitarian law principles of discrimination, proportionality, necessity and precaution, and the steps taken retrospectively to assess compliance in practice," Mr. Alston told the committee.

Responding later to questions from journalists, the Special Rapporteur said the US position that the General Assembly and Human Rights Council – to which he reports – have no role in relation to killings that occur in the context of an armed conflict was a "simply untenable" response.

"That would remove the great majority of issues that come before these bodies right now," he said, calling on US authorities to be more "upfront" about aspects of its programme.

"Otherwise you have the really problematic bottom line, which is that the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) is running a programme that is killing a significant number of people, and there is absolutely no accountability in terms of the relevant international law." "

AFP, 3 November 2009:

" "How much civilians are affected, we don't know, and for that we need access," said Billi Bierling, spokeswoman for the UN's Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs in Pakistan.

Up to 250,000 people have fled the military's major offensive, now into a third week in South Waziristan on the Afghan border, said Lieutenant General Nadeem Ahmad, chief of the state-run agency handling the displaced.

But no one knows the exact number of displaced people or those left in the conflict zone because foreign aid workers have not been able to enter the areas, the humanitarian workers say.

"We... know that there are still civilians trapped in the areas where fighting's taking place," said Sebastien Brack, spokesman for the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) in Pakistan."

ICRC, 18 May 2009:

"Alina is one of the around 50 patients currently being treated in the ICRC tented hospital in Peshawar. All are the victims of bomb blasts, bullet wounds, landmines and explosives - caused by the conflict taking place in FATA (Federally Controlled Tribal Areas) and NWFP (North-West Frontier Province).

The hospital was set up in February to treat weapon-wounded patients and, with the recent upsurge in fighting between government forces and armed groups in north-west Pakistan, it has

expanded capacity to be able to care for up to a hundred casualties. As Dr Adnan, one of the Pakistani doctors working in the hospital, explained to me, 'We treat everyone, rich or poor, fighter or civilian, Muslim or Christian.' Like Alina, many of the casualties are civilians. Most have no other chance of getting treatment. The clinics and health posts in the conflict affected areas do not have the expertise needed to treat the complex wounds caused by bombs and bullets.

After two operations to remove the shrapnel, Alina is getting better. She is having physiotherapy and is gradually regaining the strength in her legs to walk again. As she sits outside the tented ward, she plays with nurse Linda Jury, who left her full time job in a Melbourne hospital to come and work in Peshawar. 'It is sad seeing children in pain' she says, 'but it is great to see her playing again. Alina is getting better and she is one of our success stories'.

Alina's blue cotton pyjamas swamp her small frame. She is looking forward to going home soon. When I ask her what she wants to do when she grows up, she grins shyly, 'a school teacher.' But when I ask if she will be glad to get back to school again, her face changes. No, she says, she won't be going back to school, and neither will any of the other girls in her town in the foreseeable future - her school has been destroyed by the bombing."

Refugees International, 24 June 2009:

"Displaced people from Bajaur agency in FATA, who had been told late last year to return to their home districts, went back to an insecure environment where military operations were still taking place. Refugees International interviewed one family which had fled to a camp, was encouraged to return home, and had to go back to the camp because their village was still in a conflict zone."

ICRC, 30 July 2009:

"Most internally displaced people (IDPs) have returned home in recent weeks, but the future of many remains uncertain because of continuing fighting.

"Fighting is still taking place in parts of Malakand Division," said Benno Kocher, head of the ICRC sub-delegation in Peshawar.

"Despite substantial progress in some districts over the past few weeks, there remain areas where the population may not be safe and may not be able to obtain food, clean water and medical services." The ICRC is seeking greater access to areas still affected by fighting, notably in Dir, to distribute emergency food rations and evacuate the wounded.

"We hope to assist over 150,000 returnees in coming weeks, but our ability to do so will depend on the security on the ground and on access," said Mr Kocher.

[...]

ICRC discussing access to Buner district

According to government sources, approximately 80% of those who fled Buner district have now returned. However, the security situation and economic environment in northern parts of the district remain problematic. The ICRC has not been able to go to the district for the past three weeks."

Médecins sans Frontières, 27 August 2009:

"Près de trois mois après, le mouvement de population s'est timidement inversé. Des camps ont été fermés et un tiers des déplacés sont rentrés, recevant un soutien matériel et financier de la part du HCR et des autorités, et soulageant un peu du poids de leur présence les habitants du district.

Pour autant, la situation des populations sur le retour nourrit de sérieuses inquiétudes. Si les conditions de sécurité se sont améliorées dans les centres urbains de la vallée de Swat, du Lower Dir et de Buner, les informations recueillies par MSF témoignent d'une insécurité persistante dans les endroits les plus isolés, au risque d'exposer à nouveau les habitants à la violence, et de les voir rebrousser chemin."

The News, 18 September 2009:

"The International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) has expressed concern over the unexploded weapons and mines in the war-affected Federally Administered Tribal Areas (Fata) and NWFP.

Sebastian Barack, in-charge of the ICRC in Pakistan, and the organisation's weapon contamination expert Zamanuddin Noori said that unexploded weapons and mines were becoming serious threat to civilian lives in the war-affected zones in Fata and NWFP.

Speaking at a seminar on 'Landmine and Its Hazard' at the Press Club (PPC) here Thursday, Zamanuddin Noori said mostly children and women were the victims of the mines and bombs and media must come forward to educate and sensitise the population at risk. He said the organisation had arranged several sessions for the internally displaced persons (IDPs) before their repatriation to educate them about the presence of unexploded weapons in their areas.

In his presentation on 'ICRC Weapon Contamination Programme', Noori said the organisation had expanded its relief activities in May 2009 assisting about 600,000 affected people from NWFP. Showing the slides of people hit by landmines in the war-affected areas, he said the pieces of small and heavy weapons, including hand-grenades, artillery shells and bombs, were risk for humans creating serious problems for the people of the affected areas after war.

Stressing the need for collection of data on the victims of landmines and other explosives, he said the tally would be helpful for humanitarian organisations for devising an appropriate strategy to prevent civilian casualties and fatalities. He said the field workers of the ICRC had taken part in relief activities in the war zones, including Swat, Buner and Dir.

Noori said all donor and aid agencies had accepted the ICRC as independent, impartial and neutral humanitarian organisation in the country.

ICRC NWFP In-charge Beeno Kocher said the humanitarian organisation had assisted over 600,000 victims of the recent fighting in Swat, Dir and Buner. The ICRC-trained teams of volunteers had also sensitised over 2,000 people from Benazir Camp in Charsadda, Jalozaï camp in Nowshera, Rangmala camp (Malakand), Jalala (Mardan) and Katcha Garhi camp in Peshawar to train them on how to identify unexploded weapons."

ICRC, 22 September 2009:

"While the government partially lifted its curfew in Swat, access to some areas remained restricted owing to security concerns. With ICRC support, the Pakistan Red Crescent has expanded its operations in Swat over the last two weeks. Joint teams distributed food and soap to almost 35,000 residents of Kabbal. ICRC delegates, who had been unable to work in Swat since 4 August, returned to the district on 10 September.[...]

ICRC staff visited the Jalozaï, Jalala, Palosa, Khungi Shah and Technical College camps in Nowshera, Mardan and Dir districts, where they held 44 mine-risk education sessions attended by over 1,800 people, including women and children, in a bid to reduce the number of mine victims."

ICRC, 6 October 2009:

"Fighting in the two provinces has driven over two million people from their homes in recent months. Most have returned, but many are still displaced and destitute. The situation remains unstable in parts of Buner, Swat and Dir. People from these areas are still staying with host families outside the zones affected by violence.

The lack of security, shelter and medical care are the biggest worries for people in areas where fighting continues. These people are unable to support themselves as they normally would. They're surviving, thanks to typical Pakistani solidarity – but only just. Where violence is continuing, it's impossible for economic life to resume."

Dawn, 29 October 2009:

"PESHAWAR, Oct 28 : At least 101 people, mostly women and children, were killed and over 150 injured when a huge car bomb ripped through a crowded market here on Wednesday."

IFRC, 4 November 2009:

"Pakistan is in a grip of violence. Last Monday, at least 30 people lost their lives while another 45 sustained injuries in a suicide bomb explosion in Rawalpindi, a major city south of Islamabad. The Pakistan Red Crescent Society (PRCS) immediately deployed four ambulances to provide basic first aid and response services to the injured people.

When we reached the explosion site we saw dead bodies and blood there. It was shocking, says 19 year-old volunteer Muhammad Aqeel, who was on ambulance duty as a part of an emergency response team.

Muhammad Aqeel and 15 colleagues looked for wounded people, provided them with basic first aid and transported them to nearby hospitals. The team a group of PRCS doctors and first aid staff and volunteers - also took dead bodies to the morgue."

Balochistan: landmine accidents on the increase in violence affected areas

- A growing number of landmine accidents have been reported from Balochistan, especially from the Dera Bugti and Kohlu areas

IRIN, 14 September 2006

"[there is] a growing number of victims of landmine blasts in the troubled province of Balochistan. The mines have been indiscriminately planted by rebel groups in many areas of the Dera Bugti and Kohlu districts, to the southeast of Quetta. The area is at the epicentre of a conflict between government forces and militias led by tribal chieftans, mainly over the province's lucrative natural resources.

[...]

According to a January 2006 statement by Pakistani Senator Sanaullah Baloch, at least 180 people have died in bombings, 122 children have been killed by paramilitary troops and hundreds of people have been arrested since the beginning of the campaign in early 2005. On 8 December 2005, the federal interior minister stated that some 4,000 people had been arrested in Balochistan since the beginning of 2005.

According to figures compiled by the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP), which has been monitoring human rights violations in Balochistan, there have been 121 landmine blast incidents in 2006 alone. At least 78 civilians and 28 security personnel have been killed, with well over 150 people injured.

"All these incidents have taken place in the Kohlu and Dera Bugti areas," explained Farid Ahmed, provincial coordinator for HRCP in Balochistan.

[...]

There is official concern at the growing casualties from landmines in the province. Razik Bugti, a spokesman for the Balochistan provincial government, has said that: "The landmines placed by 'miscreants' endangered the lives of ordinary people who did not support militancy."

Currently, security forces deployed in the Dera Bugti area are engaged in demining major roads. However, as the conflict continues, with troop movements reported by the national press in the Kohlu district, more mines continue to be laid by rebel groups opposing the military - each one of them presenting an additional threat to the people who live in these areas of Balochistan.

The toll of dead and injured from landmine explosions is just one example of the way in which the Balochistan conflict has affected hundreds of ordinary people. In 2006 alone, according to records maintained by HRCP, there have been 190 bomb blasts in the unstable province, killing more than 60 people.

An estimated 2,114 rockets were fired in the province between January and June 2006, killing 44 security personnel and 32 civilians."

SUBSISTENCE NEEDS

General

Food (October 2009)

- More than 90 per cent of the population of Lower Swat fled their homes and very few were able to return to harvest their crops. They were also unable to plant rice for the coming seasons and were told by the Government not to plant maize as it grows high and can be used to hide militants. This has affected people's ability to feed themselves and will have a long term impact on their livelihoods.
- The Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) among IDPs is at 21 per cent, when 15 per cent is the usual trigger for humanitarian interventions.
- In March 2009, the UN "prioritisation statement" put food assistance as a top priority.
- In October 2009, FAO, in collaboration with WFP and the EUFF, provided agricultural inputs distribution targeting the rural population in 17 districts across the country.

Islamic Relief, 31 July 2009:

"More than 90 per cent of the population of Lower Swat fled their homes during the fighting. Few were able to return to harvest their crops which they have now been lost for this season. As we drove through Lower Swat we passed the orchards from which many people in the region make their living. There were fields of peach and plum trees whose fruit has gone to waste because farmers were unable to come back and pick them.

The farmers were also unable to plant rice for the coming season, which means that the next harvest is also likely to be severely reduced. People have been told by the government not to plant maize which is one of the staple crops of this region as it grows high and can be used to hide militants. This has affected people's ability to feed themselves as well as having a long term impact on their livelihoods."

ECHO, September 2009:

"Of particular note is the Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) amongst the IDPs at 21% (15% being the usual trigger for humanitarian interventions)¹⁴. In the "Prioritisation Statement" issued by the UN in March 2009, food assistance was put as a top priority and remains a very acute need of the whole affected population."

Dawn, 7 October 2009:

"ISLAMABAD: About 86,000 vulnerable and food insecure households in 17 districts across the country would benefit from the agriculture inputs distribution for Rabi season. The project launched by the UN Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) has the support of EU Food Facility (EUFF) programme.

The quantity of 1,710 tons each of wheat seeds and fertiliser (both urea and DAP) has been procured for the agriculture input distribution in the Rabi 2009. The FAO is implementing EU Food Facility project in Pakistan with joint collaboration of WFP, which is providing the 'Food for Work' assistance to these households.

A spokesperson for the project when contacted told Dawn that despite the temporary closure of UN offices in Pakistan in view of security situation following the Monday's suicide bombing of WFP office in Islamabad, the agricultural inputs distribution activity in the provinces would not suffer and would continue as per schedule.

[...]

The agriculture inputs distribution commencing on Oct 1 will last till Oct 10, targeting the rural population of Chakwal, Sahiwal, Dera Ghazi Khan and Multan districts in Punjab; Swabi, Battagram, Buner, Lower Dir and Shangla districts in NWFP; Sukkur, Nawabshah, Jamshoro and Khairpur districts in Sindh; and Jaffarabad, Pishin, Sibi and Qila Saifullah districts in Balochistan."

Shelter (November 2009)

- In Pakistan, only around 10 per cent of the displaced live in camps, while the vast majority of IDPs are seeking shelter in host communities, which are carrying the most significant burden of the IDP crisis response.
- In terms of humanitarian assistance, IDPs living in host communities are more difficult to reach than IDPs living in camps.
- Assistance provided by other actors than host communities can mainly be seen as complementing local action.
- UNHCR is providing tents to families staying in host communities in DI Khan and Tank districts in order to alleviate overcrowding in host households.
- UNHCR and ICRC also provide tents for IDPs from Bajaur accommodated in the vacated camp of Wali Kadow Camp in Lower Dir district.

UNICEF, 3 July 2009:

"In Pakistan we face a unique humanitarian challenge, since the vast majority of the displaced are seeking shelter in host communities which are far more difficult to reach with basic services than in the camps," said UNICEF's Director of Emergency Programmes, Louis-Georges Arsenault."

UNICEF, 8 July 2009:

"These people arrived in a terrible state with absolutely nothing. I emptied my sugar mill for them as there were no rooms left in my house," says the owner.

'We are poor people'

Like many others in the North West Frontier Province of Pakistan, Mr. Lajwar has welcomed several families from Swat into his home. The extra burden is a struggle, but it is customary here to welcome guests, even strangers, especially in times of great need.

"We are poor people and do not have enough resources," he says. "We are sharing whatever food and clothes we have with them. These people urgently need assistance like health facilities, education, food, clothes."

[...]

Host communities have borne most of the burden. Only around 10 per cent of the displaced live in camps where they can be easily reached with humanitarian relief. Some 150,000 live in 4,000 school buildings converted into shelters by the government, and the rest are living 'invisibly' within communities.

Like Ajmal and his family, many of the displaced are struggling to get by in cramped, often unsanitary conditions with poor amenities, dependant on the hospitality of their hosts for food, clothing and other basic needs."

Handicap International, 24 August 2009:

" "Pakistan has a long tradition of hospitality. The vast majority (85%) of displaced persons therefore have found refuge with relatives or with host families", explains Thomas Calvot, who took part in the assessment mission launched by Handicap International between 21 May and 10 June 2009. "However, it's important to understand the full extent of the situation, with two million people forced to leave their homes in just a matter of weeks". Official camps provided shelter for between 10% and 15% of the displaced persons, while others were housed in public buildings

and schools. The latter did not benefit from basic sanitary facilities. Local NGOs and associations have acted to try to respond to this sudden surge in numbers, followed by international NGOs. Some families have started to head back to their homes, although there are no signs of a large-scale movement, since the situation remains highly unstable."

ECHO, September 2009:

"The issue of women's access to assistance remains to be fully addressed not only in camps but also outside as the Protection Cluster indicates that only one out of four protection activity is taking place in host communities. In camps, Emergency Shelter Cluster partners continued building culturally-necessary *purdah* or privacy walls for female IDPs. The issue of sanitation for women has to be urgently tackled as the situation is so dire that women are digging their own latrine areas close to, and even inside tents, which has resulted in an increase in reported cases of health problems. It is critical to ensure that all future assessment teams include a gender analyst and that their findings are incorporated into response plans."

IRIN, 22 September 2009:

"Between 56,000 and 84,000 people have been displaced by fighting between government troops and militants which broke out in the first week of September in the Khyber Agency in northwestern Pakistan, according to a 17 September report by UN OCHA.

UNHCR estimates that 87 percent of them have moved in with relatives and 13 percent are renting.

"I left our home in the Bara Tehsil [in Khyber Agency] two weeks ago. We took nothing but the clothes we wore. My cousin, with whom we are living in Lahore is a poor man himself, and I asked him not to buy us anything for Eid," said Kamran Khan, 35, a father of four. "

Oxfam, 1 October 2009:

"The unprecedented scale at which internal population displacement occurred in Pakistan in April and May 2009 meant that meeting the emergency needs of affected families in any meaningful way was always going to be an enormous challenge. Despite the daunting task at hand, a range of actors undertook immediate actions to mobilize resources, provide emergency services and organise aid distributions. Chief among these actors, however, were not professional aid workers or even government officials. Instead, it must be acknowledged that the bulk of emergency assistance was provided by local families who spontaneously offered shelter, food, and other means of support to internally displaced persons (IDPs) fleeing the conflict areas. With host families picking up the most significant burden of the Pakistan IDP crisis response, assistance provided by other actors can mainly be seen as complementing local action, and therefore focused on filling specific gaps, including rapid assistance to the most vulnerable groups within the affected population."

OCHA, 16 October 2009:

"Displacement in Bajaur: Recent military operations in the Bajaur Agency (around Mohmund and Salarzai) have caused new displacements into Lower Dir District. At this stage, the total number of Internally Displaced People (IDPs) is not yet known but the Provincial Disaster Management Authority (PDMA) estimates it to be around 80 to 100 families (560 to 700 people). The initial plans were to accommodate the newly displaced at Jalozei Camp in Nowshera District, however those displaced from Bajaur Agency preferred to stay in the region. They are now being housed in the recently vacated Wali Kandow Camp in Lower Dir District.

The Commissionerate of Afghan Refugees (CAR) will soon start registering those displaced from Bajaur Agency. Meanwhile, UN agencies and implementing partners are in the process of restarting Wali Kandow Camp. UNHCR and ICRC are providing tents and food respectively and WHO has already sent two mini emergency health kits to the District Officer in Lower Dir District to treat up to 12,000 people for one month. UNHCR and PDMA will continue to monitor the situation. The option to accommodate more IDPs from Bajaur Agency at Jalozei Camp remains."

UNHCR, 6 November 2009:

"UNHCR is stepping up assistance to people displaced by military operations in South Waziristan, Pakistan, and will shortly distribute tents to families staying with host communities in Dera Ismail Khan and Tank districts of the North West Frontier Province (NWFP). We will distribute some 35,000 tents (worth US\$6 million) pending the final number of confirmed registered families. The aid will allow the displaced people to pitch tents in the grounds of households which are hosting them, and alleviate overcrowding. Tents are on their way from our local stockpiles to Dera Ismail Khan, and distribution will begin in the coming days."

ICRC, 12 November 2009:

"By preferring to stay among family or friends in nearby communities, many IDPs go unnoticed by international or government aid agencies. It is harder to reach IDPs in places where they find refuge than to set up shelters which may be more convenient or easier for us. However if we really want to meet the needs of displaced people we must make it a priority to reach out to them in the communities that offer them shelter."

Health (October 2009)

- In the IDP camps health and hygiene conditions are poor and diseases are on the rise.
- In the thousands of schools buildings that have been converted into IDP shelters, IDPs face difficult hygiene conditions with limited access to safe drinking water and sanitation.
- At equal risk are host communities who are shouldering the burden with limited resources and fragile infrastructure.
- According to WHO, there is a need to address the psycho-social and mental health needs for the traumatized population. According to Islamic Relief, 70 per cent of children are showing signs of trauma as a result of the conflict and are in urgent need of psychological support.
- Health services for returnees are a source of concern since all facilities are reported short of medical equipment, medicines, supplies and human resources. In addition, security conditions are a challenge for providing health care services.
- In Swat District, 17 out of the 75 health facilities are non-functional.
- The Health Cluster does not have sufficient funding to sustain its activities and cope with the situation.
- There is a general lack of funds and of human resources, especially of women doctors, which affects the possibility for women to be treated, since Pashtun women cannot accept being treated by men.

Islamic Relief, 2009:

"The camps are becoming increasingly overcrowded and there are shortages of tents, as well as food, water and healthcare facilities. Health and hygiene conditions in the camps are poor and diseases such as diarrhoea, malaria and scabies are on the rise. This situation is likely to deteriorate further as more people arrive in the camps and as the monsoon season approaches."

WHO, 9 July 2009:**Dr Said Gufhran:**

" "They are coming with the complaint of gastroenteritis, diarrhoea, dysentery and the other problems, psychic problems (like) anxiety, depression, pyrexia, malaria. And the other things are acute LRTI; children are coming with ARI - acute respiratory infections."

Dr Khalif Bile:

"We need to address the psycho-social and mental health needs of this traumatized population." "

Islamic Relief, 23 June 2009:

"There are 452 displaced people living in classrooms of the Boys High School in Char Gulli. All are facing enormous problems because there is no working latrine at the school. Diseases such as scabies and diarrhea are spreading rapidly as hygiene conditions continue to deteriorate.

Azeemat's story

Azeemat Khan from Kal Pari, Buner has been living in this school with his wife, four sons and six daughters for over a month. He explains how the lack of sanitation facilities has affected the health of his family. "When we first came to Mardan we stayed with relatives," he said, "but it was very difficult because there was not enough space or resources for all of us. It has been nearly a month and half now since we have moved to this school. "

No latrines

Azeemat said, "When we arrived here the latrines were in a terrible condition and could not be used so some of us worked together to repair two of the latrines for the women and children. The rest of us men had no access to proper sanitation facilities but there was nothing else we could do. "Now even those two latrines have broken and we have nothing once again," he said.

Diseases spreading

Azeemat said that many children living in the school were suffering from diarrhoea and skin diseases such as scabies because the hygiene conditions are so poor and there is no proper place to wash.

"My brothers are also staying at the same school and two of my nephews are sick because of the poor hygiene conditions and because there is no sanitation facilities," he said.

Diarrhoea in young children can be very dangerous, especially for children who are undernourished. Azeemat said that one of his nieces, 18 month old Tahira, has severe diarrhoea and is very weak and in need urgent medical care. He said "if there was a proper sanitation system in place I believe that a lot of these diseases would not be a problem here." "

UNICEF, 3 July 2009:

"While basic needs are being met in camps, the situation is critical for the vast majority of IDPs living in host communities. In the thousands of school buildings that have been converted into IDP shelters and other spontaneous camps that have sprung up throughout parts of NWFP to cope with the influx of people from conflict-affected areas, children and families are living in cramped conditions with limited to negligible access to safe drinking water and sanitation - and are difficult to reach with basic hygiene materials and education to decrease the likelihood of water borne diseases. At equal risk are host communities who are shouldering the burden with limited resources and fragile infrastructure in the aftermath of food prices spikes that took root in 2007."

Médecins sans Frontières, 27 August 2009:

"Au-delà de ces craintes et en dépit du retour partiel des populations déplacées par la guerre, la situation qui prévaut dans le complexe médical de Mardan ne connaît pas d'amélioration, au contraire. Le nombre de patients déplacés n'a pas faibli dans la structure de santé où travaille MSF, et les habitants de la région sont de plus en plus nombreux à venir s'y faire soigner. Ces trois dernières semaines, nos équipes ont par ailleurs constaté une forte augmentation des cas de diarrhées aiguës sévères, dans cette région où le choléra est endémique. "

ECHO, September 2009:

"The risk of communicable diseases outbreaks is of high concern due to overcrowding, contaminated water, poor sanitation and hygienic conditions, low vaccination coverage, poor nutrition status and inadequate provision of health care.¹² Meeting the urgent needs and gaps in health services for the returnees is a new concern as all facilities are reported short of medical equipment, medicines, supplies and human resources, notably female medical staff. The majority of buildings have been damaged to various degrees by the fighting. Health facilities require reinforcement, for example with mobile teams, and increased surgical capacity. There is an urgent need to establish diarrhea treatment centres, cholera kits and referral centres and there is a lack of warehouse capacity for medicines. Equipment and

supplies for laboratory, ambulances for referral services blood bank and operating theatres at secondary care hospitals continue to be lacking to cover the vast needs.

The main health concerns are acute respiratory infections (a leading cause of death) and acute diarrhoea for children under five. Further needs are arising in connection to those displaced from Waziristan."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"There is a lack of female health care providers in returnee districts. Security conditions are a challenge for providing health care services. The Health Cluster is under-funded to sustain the current momentum as the health relief services are expanding to new districts, such as D.I. Khan, Tank, Bhakkar, Swat, Buner and Lower/Upper Dir."

OCHA, 17 September 2009:

"According to the Department of Health in Swat District, 17 out of the 75 health facilities are non-functional. Thirteen of those are basic health units, three are civil dispensaries and one is a rural health centre. Five health facilities are completely damaged, 21 are partially damaged and 32 are fully intact. [...] Health Cluster members have started working in 58 health outlets of Swat District to provide primary health care, mother and child health care, reproductive health and family planning, outpatient consultations, referrals. [...] Health Cluster Partners have also established a tuberculosis control unit with a laboratory and staff in Nowshera District. [...] The Health Cluster environment health team responded to separate outbreaks of acute watery diarrhea triggered by unclean and unprotected water sources in Swat and Buner Districts. Over 2,000 aqua tabs for household water treatment and 500 leaflets on clean drinking water were distributed in Swat District while the Basic health Unit in Cheena in Buner District received 1, 400 aqua tabs to distribute in affected communities. [...] The much needed Health Cluster assessment in Tank District is still pending due to the area's high-security alert status maintained by the government and security forces. The Health Cluster does not have sufficient funds to sustain the current momentum and cope with health expansion to new districts in D.I. Khan, Tank, Bhakkar, Swat, Buner, and Lower and Upper Dir."

IFRC, 8 October 2009:

"More than 16,000 patients have received health and care services with 7,800 IDPs receiving health education. Up to 30 volunteers (15 women and 15 men) have received community based health and first aid (CBHFA) training. Psychosocial support has been provided to more than 5,400 IDPs in Mansehra and Haripur.

[...]

The Danish Red Cross is interested supporting the national society in psychosocial (PSP) interventions. The PRCS has identified areas for PSP interventions west of Indus. An agreement has been signed between PRCS and Danish Red Cross for the integrated approach on PSP activities in the area. The proposal for the programme has been sent to the government authorities. Danish Red Cross will provide financial and technical support to PRCS for the PSP programmes."

UNICEF, 29 October 2009:

"Pakistan is one of four remaining countries in the world where polio remains endemic. UNICEF and the World Health Organization are working with the government to rid the country of the disease. In recent years, cases have been concentrated in the north-west and Karachi.

A particular challenge has been the arrival in recent months of thousands of families displaced due to the ongoing conflict in north-west Pakistan.

One of the most recent polio cases was a 17-month-old child who had recently arrived with his family from the tribal area of South Waziristan, near the Afghan border. The child had never received the polio vaccine in his hometown, and the four doses he was administered in Karachi were insufficient to prevent the onset of the disease.

Another problem is that frequent bouts of diarrhoea can affect the absorption of the oral polio vaccine. In areas where there is poor water, hygiene and sanitation, children need more than 10 doses to develop immunity."

IRIN, 7 July 2009:

"The health problems faced by internally displaced persons (IDPs) in the over 20 camps in Pakistan's North West Frontier Province (NWFP) are being made worse by a combination of lack of funds, a lack of women doctors and cultural constraints which dictate that it is not appropriate for male doctors to tend to women or girls. [...]

"I have heard women inside rooms in the homes of hosts or in tents moan in pain, but they won't let a male doctor near them," said Umar Usman, a medical doctor, who has visited IDPs in NWFP's Mardan and Swabi districts.

"The situation is in fact quite similar to that which arose after the earthquake of 2005. These people are from some of the same areas and the women cannot accept being treated by men," Usman said.

Eric Laroche, the World Health Organization's assistant director-general for humanitarian crises, who recently visited IDP camps, said the lack of female doctors was a problem.

"That is really a problem because, as you know, with Pashtuns [the largest ethnic group in NWFP] you need to be gender sensitive, and Pashtun women will not be treated by men, and there we have a major problem," he told the media in Islamabad. "

WHO, 9 July 2009:

"Dr Amna Balouch, doctor with the International Medical Corps in Yar Hussain Camp in Swabi district, explains why having women doctors is so important:

The women over here, our tradition doesn't allow them to talk to males and discuss their personal issues with them and the medical problems, or stuff like that. They want a female doctor so that they can correlate to them and discuss their problems, their medical issues, their social issues, economic issues, all of those sort of things. The woman-to-woman talk, they want that. Because of that they are reluctant to see a male doctor. "

Islamic Relief, 2009:

"Around 80 per cent of those living in the camps are children. Some are on their own after being separated from their families as people fled the fighting. Many women have also travelled on their own as their husbands remained behind with their land and property.

According to government statistics around 70 per cent of children are showing signs of trauma brought on as a result of the conflict. They require urgent psychosocial support and counselling."

UNICEF, 1 June 2009:

" "Muzammil misses our mother and he wants to go back to our home in Mingora," says Anas, age 10. He and his brother lost their father in a bomb blast last year and their mother could no longer afford to take care of them. Young Muzammil stays as close as he can to his big brother and refuses to participate in conversation.

Anas and Muzammil arrived at the Akhpal Kor Model School and Orphanage for boys in Swat shortly before conflict in the region intensified and the population of the city was forced to flee. They are now among seventy five orphaned children living in this temporary shelter supported by UNICEF, at a government school in the city of Peshawar.

[...]

When the fighting intensified, many of the boys managed to escape, but 25 were trapped in the middle of the fighting. With a few basic provisions in their rucksacks, the boys and their teacher fled the orphanage.

"The government forces lifted the curfew for five hours and everyone fled," Imran said. "But there were so many people we couldn't get any transport. So we walked for forty kilometres. It was very difficult for the younger boys but we had no choice, there was no other way out."

After a long and harrowing journey, Imran and the boys finally reached the city of Peshawar. With the help of UNICEF and local partners they were given a place to stay and provided with food and other necessities.

However, as they had fled Mingora, one of the older boys, Obaid Ullah, 16, was separated from the group. When they were unable to find him they had no choice but to continue their journey.

[...]

When Obaid became separated from the group, with nowhere else to go, he decided to try to get back to the orphanage in Mingora. However, as soon as he entered the city he was apprehended and interrogated overnight. Eventually, he made his way back to the orphanage alone.

Obaid stayed in the orphanage for five days. Imran finally managed to get in touch with them and arrange for Obaid's safe travel to join his brother and the rest of the boys in the shelter in Peshawar.

Obaid Ullah is happy that he, his friends and the staff of the orphanage are all safe but he misses his life in Swat.

[...]

With UNICEF support, the children's accommodation and schooling has been arranged in a local school where they have food, clothes, shoes, bedding and other basic supplies. They are also receiving essential medical care, including psychosocial support to help them deal with the shock of what they have experienced. UNICEF is also ensuring that their schooling continue, providing them with school bags, text books and other classroom supplies."

Refugees International, 24 June 2009:

[...] "as well as trauma-related services which aid agencies report is a severe need especially amongst children."

UNICEF, 8 July 2009:

" "Aeroplanes would come and drop bombs," recalls Ajmal, 8. "There were mortar shells hitting our house. We children would cry. On the way it was very difficult and we could not walk – especially the little children, and we had to carry them on our backs."

Ajmal's family was forced to flee from their village, Choprial, when fighting between government forces and militants engulfed the upper reaches of Pakistan's Swat Valley in mid-June.

The young boy travelled with 24 women and children from his extended family, including a severely disabled uncle and a little girl who had to be carried. The two-day journey took them across mountains, down goat tracks and on the long road to Takhtbai in nearby Mardan District.

This is the first stop out of the conflict zone for thousands uprooted by the fighting in north-west Pakistan.

A frightening experience

The small group made it through, even as several of the village's adult men remained behind to protect their small farm holdings. The only other man with the group besides Ajmal's disabled uncle was separated from them along the way.

In this traditional society, men are responsible for all public dealings, so to travel unescorted through a conflict zone was a frightening, unfamiliar experience for the family."

UNICEF, 10 August 2009:

"Ghafoorzada recalls her mother-in-law Musakhel's accounts of the fear they endured, lying awake night after night, too scared to sleep because of the roar of the shelling.

The mental and physical health of those who remained behind was affected. Health services were non-existent and 11 per cent of schools were damaged or destroyed, including a quarter of girls' primary schools.

"There was such intense shelling over our village that I was sure that we would be killed. I still cannot believe that we have survived all this," says Musakhel."

Dawn, 30 September 2009:

"The children of Swat still live in an environment of fear and uncertainty. 'They fear both the army and the militants', says a teacher at Ghazala school. [...] A. Hussain, the principal of a local boys' school in Balogram, says: 'Before the military offensive bullet-riddled and blood-stained bodies were a common sight' [...] 'Many children are afraid to venture out of their homes and consequently not many students turn up for school'."

WHO, 9 July 2009:

"Dr Eric Laroche: In early May, renewed conflict in the Swat Valley forced thousands of families to flee their homes. This has put incredible strain on the people themselves, the communities they have escaped to, the health sector that supports them and the humanitarian community trying to fill the gaps. There is a lack of health workers and, importantly, a lack of funding.

Dr Khalif Bile: When these communities go back to their own areas of origin, the health infrastructure, the human resource availability will pose serious challenge to the delivery of essential life-saving care. The government of Pakistan and the international community will, therefore, require to put their acts together and build up a health system rehabilitation process that will not be limited only on the delivery of imminent care but also on the medium-term and long-term rehabilitation of the facilities and the human resource development, especially with regard to female workers."

Access to Education (October 2009)

- The education sector has been particularly affected by the conflict.
- In Lower Swat virtually all the Government schools have been completely destroyed affecting the possibility for children to attend the new school year.
- In Malakand, more than 600,000 children have missed up to one school year and 550 primary and secondary schools have been destroyed.
- In the same district, Unicef works to provide temporary learning spaces, educational supplies and teacher training for children affected by the conflict.

Pashtun Post, 18 May 2009:

"Like hundreds of other students uprooted from Swat, Buner and Dir Lower districts, the anti-Taliban military operation shattered the dreams of Omer Rahman, who wants to become an engineer and serve his beloved country.

Instead of holding books in his hands, studying at the lush green fields of Buner or attending classes at the Daggar Degree College, Rahman was standing in a queue with hundreds of his

village and town people at a governmental office in Karnal Sher Khan Kelly of Swabi district to register his name and those of his family members in the list of internally displaced persons (IDPs).

Wearing black color shabby shalwar-qamees with his black shoes covered with dust, Rahman said his family arrived in Swabi a day earlier after covering miles of distance on foot to avoid being killed by the helicopter gunships or a stray artillery bullet, which have become a symbol of dread for Buneris.

"I missed to appear in a test for admission in NUST (National University of Science and Technology) because of the operation," said the teenager with tears rolling down his cheeks."

Dawn, 30 July 2009:

"[...]UN officials said that 1,167 schools out of 4,739 sheltering the displaced had already been vacated, and that the government hopes to clear out the rest within two weeks.

More than 600,000 children enrolled in schools in Malakand, where the fighting has been concentrated in three districts, have missed up to one school year due to conflict, the UN said.[...]"

Islamic Relief, 31 July 2009:

"All the villages we visited bore the scars of the conflict. Some houses had been reduced to rubble while others were seriously damaged. But the biggest affect has been on the education sector. In Lower Swat virtually all the government schools have been completely destroyed and when the new school year starts in September thousands of children will find they have nowhere to study. There is an urgent need for emergency shelters that can be used as classrooms as well as educational materials."

Dawn, 11 September 2009:

"A senior official from UN children's agency Unicef said 550 primary and secondary schools were destroyed or partially damaged during the conflict in Malakand.

Of the 550 schools, 147 were for girls, Luc Chauvin said.

He said Unicef was working on an initiative to benefit 532,000 children and provide temporary learning spaces, educational supplies and teacher training for the children affected by the conflict."

OCHA, 16 October 2009:

"There is also a need for tents and transitional shelters to be used as classrooms for damaged schools in conflict-affected districts, along with a need for office supplies for District Education Offices.

Vulnerability criteria for families needing temporary shelter in areas of return also need to be developed."

North West Frontier Province/Swat Valley: IDPs unable to access relief camp (April 2008)

- IDPs in the Swat Valley needed shelter, food and medicine
- A camp with food and tents was inaccessible for the IDPs due to threats from the militants

International Development and Relief Foundation, 2008:

"Shelter, food and medicine have been identified as important activities that need to be addressed in the area. SRSP is focussing on food supplies while other organizations are dealing with shelter and medicine."

Integrated Regional Information Networks, November 2007:

"Efforts to establish a displaced persons camp in Pakistan's Swat Valley are under threat from militants fighting the government, according to aid officials.

"At present, there is no shortage of food or tents, but without any security, people don't want to come," Mohammad Munir, district manager of Pakistan's Red Crescent Society in Swat, told IRIN on 6 November from the town of Kanju, near the district capital Saidu Sharif.

On the evening of 2 November, one family arrived at the camp recently set up in the town of Barikot, 20km outside the capital, only to leave the following morning out of fear.

"The local Taliban do not want to see this camp running," Munir said. But "there are people who are suffering and they [the Taliban] should understand our need to help them", he added.

[...]

According to Munir, despite ongoing threats, district authorities and Red Crescent workers managed to erect 100 tents, as well as a dispensary and reception area at the camp, which could be expanded to accommodate 5,000 families if necessary.

"There is no shortage of tents – we have another 1,000 from the provincial relief authorities," Munir said, adding that ample stocks of food and medicines were also available.

But without sufficient security arrangements, it looks unlikely that any of the displaced will come, he said, particularly as the militants had already threatened to burn the camp if work continued."

Waziristan: need for shelter, food, medicine (March 2008)

- The displaced from South Waziristan were in need of food, medicine, shelter and quilts
- Relief camps were set up for them, but according to some reports the camps lacked adequate number of tents and had no food, medicines and quilts

Dawn, February 2008:

"Sources told Dawn that setting up of two refugee camps in Dera Ismail Khan was on the cards, where they would also be provided with food, medical facilities and other essentials of daily life.

The migrated tribesmen said the military operation and influence of militant groups in the troubled region had virtually paralysed life in the Mehsud tribe areas, including Spinkai Raghznai and Kotkai, and surrounding areas of the Frontier Region of Jandola.

They said the affected areas were presenting a deserted look after evacuation of local people.

[...]

Over 1,000 displaced families (about 10 thousand people) have come to Dera Ismail Khan alone.

Waseem Khan Mehsud, a political activist, said food, quilts, blankets and other utensils had been distributed among 2,000 registered tribal people at the temporary Mehsuds' relief camp. DCO Khudadad Khan said the Crisis Management Cell had started supply of relief goods and about six trucks loaded with 10,000 tents and 20,000 plastic sheets had arrived in the district. Another consignment of food items for 30,000 people would arrive soon, he said."

Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies, March 2008:

“State authorities established a relief camp near Kot Azam but it failed to provide any visible relief to the displaced people. Meanwhile ministry of defense announced an aid package of Rs 20 million for rehabilitation of the affected people. But the camps, so erected, lack relief facilities.

The camp administrators had demanded 5,000 tents but they got only 250. Food, medicines and quilts were not available in the camps at all. It means no appropriate measures were taken for provision of the basic needs and protection from the cold winter. In addition, gangs of militants had an open access to the camps, which prevented the people from receiving aid. No photographers were allowed to go inside and take the photographs of the inmates. State authorities and Taliban militants equally wanted that the miseries and sufferings of the people remain covered.”

Balochistan: displaced reported to be living under extremely difficult conditions (June 2007)

- According to UN estimates, at the end of 2006 there were 84,000 IDPs in Balochistan
- Many have poured into neighboring towns and some have moved to urban centres to earn a living
- The IDPs are often living in deplorable conditions in makeshift camps with no access to water, food and medical facilities
- There had been reports of severe malnutrition crisis among the IDPs with children particularly affected
- No assistance is being permitted to reach the displaced in Balochistan

Newsline, June 2007:

“The situation in Balochistan is, indeed, bleak. Thousands remain displaced and are living in miserable conditions. Many have poured into neighbouring towns and those with better resources have made it to the urban centres. The low income peasants have fared the worst. Small groups of displaced peasant families remain encamped over a vast and isolated area that is becoming increasingly insecure as the fighting spreads.

[...]

On the outskirts of towns like Dera Murad Jamali and Jhapat, some native landowners have allowed several families to stay on as labourers. But the locals are often hostile. Old tribal enmities and newer political alliances further complicate the situation. Fear of reprisal by security agencies also prevents locals from aiding refugees.”

Asian Indigenous and Tribal People Network, January 2007:

“According to United Nations estimates, there were 84,000 Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) in Balochistan of which 26,000 were women and 33,000 were children as of December 2006. As per the statistics of the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, about 50,000 people have fled their villages and settlements from Dera Bugti as of July 2006. The officials have not provided relief as it claimed that the people who have fled Dera Bugti were very well off. Due to total blockade of Marri and Bugti areas by the Pakistani army, about 8000 to 10,000 allegedly died due to exodus, malnourishment, lack of shelter and disease. They had been reportedly living in deplorable conditions in the makeshift camps with no access to potable water, food, and other basic necessities. No products, medicine and medical facility, doctor and electricity or even fuel to run water pumps were not provided to these areas. The government was reportedly offering 10 goats to those who have returned to their homes in order to make their ends meet.

Unfortunately the plight of the displaced has been overshadowed by the conflict in the region, which has been aggravated by the killing of Baloch chief Akbar Bugti. The government of Pakistan had failed to hear the cries for help of the displaced due to its occupation with the operation against the tribal militias. The government has deliberately created the humanitarian crisis by not even recognizing the presence of IDPs in the province. Although the government had sought the intervention of the United Nations to avert the humanitarian crisis on 21 December 2006, it was too late. Besides, the situation further aggravated as the government prevented journalists and aid groups to reach the affected areas. Even the assistance sought from the UN was alleged to be conditional as only three districts of Naseerabad, Jaffarabad and Quetta, which housed majority of the IDPs were given permission. The other districts Sibi and Bolan were not considered. Besides, the UN was asked to carry out its relief operation through health facilities in the districts and under the supervision of local authorities. The aid workers who had earlier visited the area alleged that military trucks rounded up displaced people and hid them ahead of their visits.

There had been reports of severe malnutritional crisis among the IDPs. The UN in its internal assessment report on nutritional status of women and children among the IDPs revealed that 28 per cent children under the age of five were 'acutely undernourished', out of them, six per cent were in the state of 'severely acute malnutrition' and 80 per cent of the deaths among the IDPs were children under the age of five. Six percent of the children were so underfed that they would die without immediate medical attention."

Asian Human Rights Commission, July 2006:

"The displaced have to carry water from at least one to three kilometers away. No medical help is being provided to them. The are mostly children and women suffering from diarrhea, dehydration, malaria and high fevers. Some cases of deaths have been reported but not confirmed by any hospitals.

The local people in these areas where displaced persons are settled, are not allowed by the intelligence agencies of Pakistan Army to help refugees. Edhi center, a local charitable organisation, has been stopped by the Pakistan Military from providing medical assistance to the affected people and from making medical camps in refugee settled areas. The main persons from Edhi center were summoned to Pakistan's capital, Islam Abad by the Military intelligence and were ordered to stop medical assistance to the victims. According to the daily Dawn the displaced are lying in the open skies in summer where temperature remains at 38 to 44 degrees centigrade. The conditions of the displaced are deteriorating day by day and urgent help is needed through from international organisations working for the rehabilitation of refugees and displaced persons."

The displaced were also reported to be living under extremely difficult conditions after the violence in April 2006:

Integrated Regional Information Networks, April 2006:

"With violence in parts of Pakistan's southern province of Balochistan showing no signs of abating, provincial opposition leaders have appealed to humanitarian organisations to help those displaced by the conflict.

"Since the violence has escalated, thousands of poor people have migrated from the scene of clashes between [Baloch] tribesmen and security forces in the district of Dera Bugti to neighbouring areas of Jafarabad and Naseerabad. They are living in the open in baking hot weather without food and other facilities," Kachkol Ali, leader of the opposition in the provincial assembly, said in the southern port city of Karachi.

Ali, who is also head of a regional fact-finding committee on the Baloch conflict, has asked leading national charity the Karachi-based Edhi Foundation for help to assist displaced people including children, women and the elderly.

In response the foundation has sent an assessment team into the areas of Jafarabad and Naseerabad.

"We've sent our survey team to assess the number of people affected by the conflict in terms of food, shelter, drinking water and health assistance," Faisal Edhi, a spokesman for the charity, told IRIN from Karachi. "Once the survey teams get back in a day or so, we'll be able to say something about the situation on the ground," Edhi added.

Balochistan is home to 8 million people and is the largest but least developed of Pakistan's four provinces. Endemic violence in the province has increased over the past year as tribal groups have protested against a government they say ignores their needs while extracting energy and minerals from the resource-rich province."

PATTERNS OF RETURN AND RESETTLEMENT

General

General (July 2009)

- In the Lower Swat region, which has been declared "clear", a curfew is still in operation and shops that were damaged are still closed, which creates problem of food shortage and leave IDPs who have returned in very difficult living conditions.

Islamic Relief, 31 July 2009:

"Although the majority of Lower Swat has been declared 'clear,' a curfew is still in operation so all the shops that weren't damaged or destroyed are still closed, which is exacerbating the problem of food shortages. Men who owned businesses, who were shopkeepers or labourers spoke with frustration of not being able to work and earn a living because of the curfew. While they are relieved to finally have returned home, they feel they are in limbo and that there is little they can do improve their present condition."

North West Frontier Province/Swat Valley: many displaced return soon after end to armed conflict (December 2007)

- By early December 2007 the Swat Valley was slowly returning to normalcy and large numbers of IDPs were coming back
- The returnees arrived to find hundreds of homes damaged or destroyed largely by the use of helicopter gunships during the conflict

Dawn, December 2007:

"Swat valley is slowly returning to normality with large numbers of displaced people coming back to areas now under the control of security forces. With the forces preparing for a major assault on the last strongholds of the militants in Matta tehsil, Maulana Fazlullah managed to air his address on the radio after a gap of six days on Saturday and announced: "My Shaheen commando force is fully prepared to face the forces."

Scores of families have returned to secured areas, including Shakardara, Koza Banda, Bara Banda, Ningolai, Khwazakhela and Kot.

Public transport carrying people and their luggage could be seen throughout the day on roads. The displaced people had been taking shelter mostly with their relatives in Mingora and other towns. Some had shifted to other cities such as Mardan, Nowshera and Peshawar."

Integrated Regional Information Networks, December 2007:

"Over the past two weeks fighting has died down, with many of the militants' strongholds taken over, but residents of Swat Valley, home to around 1.5 million people, have paid a heavy price,

residents and non-governmental organisations say. "According to what preliminary data we have, over 1,000 houses have been damaged or destroyed and there have been at least 400 civilian casualties," Shaukat Saleem, core group coordinator of the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP), told IRIN from Swat. This belies an official death toll of 230 civilians and 90 military personnel killed.

Much of the destruction was caused by heavy use of helicopter gunships against villages believed by the Pakistan military to harbour militants. However, Sher Muhammad Khan, a Swat-based activist, described the bombing as "indiscriminate", particularly in hilly areas where villages were bombed and houses destroyed. He said a curfew in the area made it difficult to assess the full scale of the damage.

[...]

Meanwhile, fighting and curfews have badly disrupted life, particularly education, with over 2,000 schools reportedly closing down for varying periods.

"The school term has been shattered for children here," said Amjad Abbas, a high-school teacher speaking from the city of Mingora. He said that "most likely" future holidays for affected schools would be cut short to make up for lost time.

Curfews continue and there are still outbursts of fighting between troops and fighters in a few villages. But overall, a process of recovery is now under way. There is also a lingering sense of trauma. "The children in particular have been deeply affected. They feel unsafe," said Abbas."

Waziristan: roads being opened clear way for return of displaced (April 2008)

- Roads were opened in Waziristan in April 2008, allowing thousands of IDPs to return
- Many returnees had set up a second home in a safer location
- The South Waziristan government initiated a ration card scheme to enable over 10,000 families to receive relief goods

Integrated Regional Information Networks, April 2008:

"With the opening of some roads into conflict-ravaged South Waziristan this month, thousands of people displaced by fighting in Pakistan's tribal areas, which lie along the country's western border with Afghanistan, have begun returning to their homes. Displacements from the North and South Waziristan agencies, over 150km south of Peshawar, began in 2004, as government forces began battling pro-Taliban militants in the area. Hundreds of homes have been destroyed, with scores of civilians among those reportedly killed. The Pakistan military has said several hundred personnel and many more militants have died, but the number of civilian casualties remains unknown.

"People in the area are very badly affected. Waziristan has always produced fruit and now that source of income has been wiped out for people. Education is also very badly affected," Kamran Arif, a Peshawar-based human rights activist, told IRIN. The precise number of people displaced from the North and South Waziristan agencies has not been determined. However, in October

2007, according to the Human Rights Commission of Pakistan (HRCP), some 80,000 fled the town of Mirali, the headquarters of North Waziristan. Many have since returned, while other families have opted to stay away. "Quite a few people, even if they have gone back to Waziristan have also set up a second home elsewhere - in Peshawar or towns near the tribal areas like Dera Ismail Khan, simply to make sure they have a safe place to live in," said Arif, who said a movement back into Waziristan had begun.

[...]

The opening up of a key road that leads into Wana, the principal town in South Waziristan Agency, from the small town of Jandola on the agency's western border, is intended as a goodwill gesture. A ration card scheme for over 10,000 internally displaced families has also been initiated as part of the same policy by the South Waziristan political administration. The cards will enable families, many of them members of the Mehsud tribe, to receive relief goods, including food items.

Many families have been living with relatives outside Waziristan after Mehsud-tribe dominated areas of the region were sealed by the military in January. People who fled fighting were denied permission to re-enter to retrieve household items.

[...]

The re-opening of closed roads, early in April, signals a relaxation in these measures. Other roads, however, remain closed. Some families from Waziristan and other conflict-areas have chosen to leave permanently. Even as people return, the fear of further fighting still looms, and new government policies on the issue of militancy are yet to be elaborated."

Balochistan: conflicting information on number of returns (October 2007)

- There are conflicting reports on the number of IDPs who have been able to return
- According to government estimates 65,000 IDPs from a total of 90,000 have returned from Dera Bugti
- According to other sources, most of the population of Dera Bugti and Sui has not returned

International Crisis Group, October 2007:

"Since December 2005 when military operations began, at least 84,000 people have been displaced by the conflict in Dera Bugti and Kohlu districts alone. According to a UN internal assessment in July-August 2006 that was leaked to the press, the displaced persons, mostly women (26,000) and children (33,000), were living in makeshift camps without adequate shelter in Jafarabad, Naseerabad, Quetta, Sibi and Bolan districts. 28 per cent of five-year-old children were acutely malnourished, and more than 6 per cent were in a state of "severe acute malnourishment", with their survival dependent on receiving immediate medical attention. Over 80 per cent of deaths among those surveyed were among children under five.

The government initially dismissed the UN assessment as exaggerated, claiming that almost all the internally displaced (IDPs) had gone home. However, it denied aid agencies and media access to the areas to which they had supposedly returned. In December 2006, in the first official acknowledgement of the gravity of the humanitarian crisis, the government gave UN agencies permission to conduct relief efforts, albeit with preconditions, including that aid would have to be disbursed under the supervision of local authorities. UN officials were also reportedly told not to speak to the media. Soon after, the government reportedly backtracked and blocked access to the UN and other aid agencies. Local non-governmental organisations' (NGOs) efforts, including that of the Edhi Foundation, were also halted.

In May 2007, addressing a public meeting in Sui subdistrict of Dera Bugti, President Musharraf claimed that 65,000 of a total of 90,000 IDPs from Dera Bugti had returned home. A regional human rights organisation, however, believes some 200,000 persons are still displaced. Local estimates are even higher. Abdul Wahab Baloch, head of the Baloch Rights Council, an NGO, insists that more than 200,000 have been displaced from Kohlu district alone, and government neglect has resulted in many deaths."

Newsline, June 2007:

"Almost two years on since the insurgency began, and several months after the government announced that peace had returned to the area, most of the population of Dera Bugti and Sui has not returned. "Why should I go back and live under the rule of those traitors who bombed our women and children," says Murad Baksh Bugti. "I know I have nothing and can't fight for my rights, but I would rather my children die of starvation here than go back there in shame." This sentiment echoes throughout the community of IDPs, who mostly comprise members of the Marri and Bugti tribes. Here, the government and its security agencies are viewed as the enemy who drove them from their homes and killed the man they called their leader, Nawab Akbar Bugti. "We will only go back when someone from our leader's family is reinstated as the rightful sardar," is the almost unanimous consensus here."

Access to basic necessities in areas of return

Food (October 2009)

- People returning to Swat are facing serious shortage of food due to the damages to the agricultural sector and the continuing curfew in the region.
- Most returnees in Pakistan have lost their crops and livestock during the conflict and have no livelihoods opportunities.
- Upon return, many IDPs are going back to their place of displacement to pick up their food rations.
- As of September 2009, the UN had received only three per cent of the funding needed to institute early recovery projects.
- Small scale farmers who have returned need assistance with livestock support, horticulture, seeds and fertiliser to revive their livelihoods and reduce their dependency on external food aid.

Islamic Relief, 22 July 2009:

"Islamic Relief aid workers are warning that people returning home to Swat in North West Pakistan are facing serious shortages of food.

After three months of living with host families or in camps, some of the three million displaced people have started to return to their homes. Many have found that their houses and livelihoods have been destroyed and the infrastructure of the region devastated. The damage to the agricultural sector and the continuing curfew in the region means they will struggle to feed their families this Ramadan. [...]

Islamic Relief aid worker Sultan Mahmood said, "I have just visited Swat and I believe that progress there has gone back ten years. Swat was once a progressive and bustling economic centre. Many people would make their living from the abundant orchards in the region, but the last harvest has all been lost and people are unsure how they will support their families over the coming months."

According to Islamic Relief Pakistan, around 90 percent of the population of Swat left their homes due to the fighting and the majority travelled to Mardan District where they found refuge with local families or in schools and hospitals. Around 50 per cent of the displaced people in Lower Swat have now returned to their homes and many more will return in the coming weeks as the start of the holy month of Ramadan draws near.

"People in Swat are still very scared that the fighting might start again but came back because they desperately missed their homes and their relatives," said Sultan Mahmood. "They have returned to find the curfew still in place and the agriculture sector devastated. This means they are approaching Ramadan with the very real threat of food shortages hanging over them." "

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"Despite the fact that a significant number of people have returned to their areas of origin, many IDPs were going back to their former hosting areas to pick up their food rations. This back and forth movement will cease as soon as more humanitarian hubs are established in return areas to provide food and non-food items (NFIs)."

Dawn, 12 September 2009:

"An estimated two-thirds of the 2.7 million people displaced internally by the conflict between the army and the Taliban have returned to their hometowns. However, they are finding the odds still stacked against them. They have lost crops and livestock that constituted primary sources of income, while the conflict has also taken a heavy toll on roads, schools and hospitals. The plight of the returnees is underscored by the UN's statement that it has so far received a mere three per cent of the \$58m it needs to institute 'early recovery projects' in the region, such as food aid and the restoration of educational, healthcare and water-supply networks.

The global credit crunch is being blamed for the reluctance of donors to part with the urgently needed funds. No doubt, the worldwide recession has been severe. Nevertheless, donors must understand that the situation is grim: a survey in some militancy-hit areas reveals that 80 per cent believe they will not be able to survive for more than a fortnight without assistance."

OCHA, 16 October 2009:

"Small farmers who have returned to their areas of origin and those who stayed behind in conflict affected areas need assistance with livestock support, horticulture, seeds and fertiliser to revive their livelihoods and reduce dependence on external food aid."

Infrastructure (October 2009)

- IDPs who had left Maidan, in Lower Dir, have returned but their houses have been destroyed, electricity and water networks have been damaged, and access to electricity and fuel remains problematic
- In Bajaur, in the FATA, about 30 per cent of IDPs are unable to return because of large-scale destruction. Eight villages have been completely destroyed and others were severely damaged. 21 per cent of the water and sanitation infrastructure has been damaged.
- In Swat district 20 health facilities were found partially damaged and six health facilities were severely damaged and not functional.

ICRC and Pakistan Red Crescent assist displaced and returnees, ICRC, 22 September 2009:

"Most people who had left Maidan, in Lower Dir, to escape the fighting of previous months have now returned to their homes. The ICRC team assessing the local infrastructure and economy found damaged houses and abandoned fields. Electricity and water networks are in disrepair. Unexploded munitions remain a significant threat.

Access to electricity and fuel remains problematic, especially for medical facilities. During the first week of September, the ICRC provided 1,200 litres of diesel to the District Headquarters Hospital in Daggar, which allowed it to run its generator during power cuts. The hospital serves a population of 30,000. The ICRC also donated clinical delivery sets and kits to the hospital's maternity department".

Situation Report #19, OCHA, 1 October 2009:

"Bajaur Agency Needs Assessment: An OCHA-led multi-cluster mission took place to Bajaur Agency, an area strategically linking Afghanistan, western FATA and Malakand Division. Government officials informed mission participants that about 70 percent of the IDPs had returned and had received food assistance but that more humanitarian aid is needed. There was, however, no food assistance provided to people who stayed behind. According to local authorities, this is a source of jealousy and social tension.

About 30 percent of IDPs are unable to return because of large-scale destruction in their areas of origin.

Eight villages were completely destroyed and others were severely damaged. Population figures provided by the Political Agent of Bajaur Agency indicated that 81 percent of the displaced are women and children, and that therefore, that the population in areas of return is currently predominantly male.

[...]

According to civil administration officials in Bajaur Agency, there is damage to 21 percent of the existing water and sanitation infrastructure in the area. A total of 40 of 189 drinking water supply systems are damaged (37 partially and 3 completely)."

WHO, Health Cluster Pakistan, Weekly Bulletin No 16, 30 October 2009:

"Swat health facilities assessment"

The DoH of NWFP, with technical support from WHO, conducted an assessment of 57 (75%) public health facilities in Swat district. The assessment was carried out by the health personnel (medical doctors and paramedics) of EDO (H) Swat and health cluster partners such as Merlin, International Medical Corps, Save the Children and ARC.

The assessment included two of the three maternal and child health (MCH) centres, four of the 17 civil dispensaries (CDs), 38 of the 41 Basic Health Units (BHUs), all three Rural Health Centres (RHUs), five of the six civil hospitals, and the lone tehsil headquarters (THQ) hospital. According to the assessment results, 20 health facilities (1 CD, 14 BHUs, 2 RHCs, 2 civil hospitals and the THQ hospital) are partially damaged, and six health facilities (1 CD and 5 BHUs) are severely damaged and are not functional. Details of the assessment results will be shared separately."

HUMANITARIAN ACCESS

Humanitarian access to conflict affected areas

Humanitarian Access (November 2009)

- Humanitarian access to Waziristan remains extremely difficult, due to the restrictions imposed by Pakistani military and the dangers of working in the region. No aid workers are present on the ground which makes it difficult to assess needs, and provide and monitor relief assistance.
- Insecurity and unmet funding needs are concerns shared by all UN Clusters, which can either not expand their programmes or find it hard to sustain their current activities.
- In October 2009, in Northwest Pakistan, WFP closed its distribution centres, which were serving more than two million people, for security concerns.
- In October 2009, ICRC called the Government of Pakistan to allow access to the conflict zones as per the Geneva Conventions, but as of November 2009 no access had been given.
- In November 2009, the UN began to withdrawn the international staff from north-western Pakistan due to security reasons.

ICRC, 6 October 2009:

"And then there's Waziristan. It's hard to know what's happening because there are no aid workers on the ground there, but we estimate the number of displaced people in Waziristan at 80,000. In the absence of security guarantees for our personnel, access to this region remains extremely difficult. However, the ICRC has opened an office in Bakkhar, to support its operations in North-West Frontier Province and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas. "

Reuters alertnet, 16 October 2009:

"Essential aid is struggling to reach around 90,000 people who have fled a Pakistani military offensive against Taliban positions in a region near Afghanistan, aid agencies said.

Without fresh water and medicine there is a strong chance that disease will spread amongst people who fled the region of South Waziristan -- focus of a bombardment by Pakistan's air force -- for two neighbouring areas.

"This is a very poor area and the people here had very little beforehand and are likely to have a lot of trouble now," said one aid worker based in Islamabad.

"The risk of things going bad are quite high."

[...]

But the aid worker in Islamabad told AlertNet that tight restrictions imposed by the Pakistani military and the dangers of working in the region made it harder to get aid to people who had fled the bombing this week in South Waziristan.

[...]

"The key challenge is security and humanitarian access to people," UNHCR said.

"The deteriorating security situation in Pakistan continues to hinder our humanitarian operations in the country, including our ability to assess needs, and provide and monitor relief assistance." "

Pakistan Humanitarian Update, Issue 1, OCHA, 16 October 2009:

"Insecurity and unmet funding needs are concerns shared by all Clusters. Security has restricted the mobility and field presence of humanitarian agencies. Additionally, eight of the 11 Clusters are funded at less than 50 percent of their requirements in the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan

(PHRP). Early Recovery is the least funded Cluster at only three percent followed by Agriculture at 16 percent. Some Clusters are finding it hard to sustain the momentum of their current activities while others cannot expand their programmes to assist people in areas of return."

The News, 21 October 2009:

"The UN's World Food Programme on Wednesday closed distribution centres serving more than two million people in northwest Pakistan over security fears, a spokesman for the agency said.

The move affecting the Swat Valley region comes after a suicide bomber attacked a WFP compound in the capital Islamabad, killing five aid workers this month.

"We have closed all our food distribution centres in Swabi, Charsadda, Mardan, Swat, Buner, Dir and Bajaur which are the humanitarian hubs for internally displaced people in the region," said Amjad Jamal, a spokesman for WFP in Islamabad.

"We are facing problems regarding security, so it was decided last night to close these centres," Jamal told media. "

Dawn, 25 October 2009:

"ONE hopes that the appeal of the International Committee of the Red Cross to the Pakistan government to allow it access to the conflict zone will not fall on deaf ears.

Although one understands the gravity of the situation in an area where a war is being fought and its implications for the security of the local population and aid workers, it must be remembered that Pakistan is a signatory to the Geneva Conventions that constitute what is called humanitarian law. The government is obliged to observe some basic principles, such as proportionality in the means and methods of warfare while exercising discrimination between non-combatants and combatants. If this is done it will, according to the ICRC, minimise the impact of the war on civilians who are innocent victims caught in the crossfire. Doubts have been expressed on this score. As a result the number of detainees and injured and displaced people has been increasing phenomenally. They need humanitarian assistance. Unfortunately, they are not receiving it. Hence the ICRC's appeal."

AFP, 2 November 2009:

"The United Nations said Monday it was withdrawing its international staff from northwestern Pakistan because of the security situation there.

"They will be relocated. Immediately," Ishrat Rizvi, a UN spokeswoman, told AFP.

UN Secretary General Ban Ki-moon had declared a security condition known as Phase IV in the Northwest Frontier Province and Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA), a UN statement said.

"The decision has been taken bearing in mind the intense security situation in the region," the statement said.

Phase IV is the UN's second-highest security category."

Merlin, 30 October 2009:

"Almost one in seven displaced people are suffering from global acute malnutrition, according to a recent UN survey.

The first international NGO granted access to the area, Merlin is already on the ground with three mobile nutrition teams who are providing vital emergency health care and distributing nutritional supplements to these vulnerable communities in DI Khan.

The latest report from the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs highlights support for food and health facilities as the most urgent needs for South Waziristan's displaced.

The next phase of our response

Alongside two local partner organisations, in the next week our work will include widely distributing nutritional and therapeutic supplements to treat those most affected by malnutrition. The worst cases of malnutrition with medical complications will be referred to health facilities for

further treatment. We will also support up to 26 of these health facilities to provide essential services, including general consultations and mother and child health care."

AFP, 3 November 2009:

"How much civilians are affected, we don't know, and for that we need access," said Billi Bierling, spokeswoman for the UN's Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs in Pakistan.

Up to 250,000 people have fled the military's major offensive, now into a third week in South Waziristan on the Afghan border, said Lieutenant General Nadeem Ahmad, chief of the state-run agency handling the displaced.

But no one knows the exact number of displaced people or those left in the conflict zone because foreign aid workers have not been able to enter the areas, the humanitarian workers say.

[...]

Brack said the ICRC had tried unsuccessfully to gain access to South Waziristan to assist victims of fighting and to visit detainees, in accordance with its mandate.

[...]

Although ICRC has no staff in the area, it has for months been sending medical supplies to assist eight clinics in Waziristan, Brack said."

Humanitarian access limited by government and due to insecurity (April 2008)

- Threats from the Taleban prevented displaced from accessing aid in the Swat Valley
- Owing to the unstable security situation in Waziristan, international agencies such as the ICRC could not access areas affected by armed conflict
- The government has prevented local and international efforts to assist displaced persons in Balochistan

Buneri, November 2007:

"Some times back the provincial government established a tented village in Barikot for the displaced people but due to the security reasons no one opted for it. " First the camp established for displaced people is far away from the affected area—about 40 kilometer, second we fear lest Taliban attack it as the government has not provided any security it", Sher Ali, head of displaced family explained why the people were not going to live in the camp."

International Committee of the Red Cross, April 2008:

"The agreement signed in late 2006 between the Pakistani government and militants in North Waziristan kept large-scale armed violence at bay for the first half of 2007. However, in July 2007 the truce broke down and there were suicide bombings targeting military convoys and checkpoints. The violence spilled over to other parts of the Federally Administered Tribal Area (FATA) and several districts of the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP). Peshawar and the surrounding area were struck by a sequence of bomb attacks.

Owing to the unstable security situation, ICRC staff are not able to travel to areas most directly affected by the armed violence. The ICRC does help some weapon-wounded able to reach more accessible areas. It continues to carry out assessments wherever possible and will pursue its support for medical facilities serving those affected by the fighting."

Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, April 2008:

"IDPs in Balochistan largely remained invisible because of the continuing military operation and restrictions on media access to them. There were reports in June of the displaced inhabitants of Balochistan's Kohlu and Dera Bugti districts still waiting to return home. These IDPs were largely dependant upon locals' generosity and were often harassed by security agencies on suspicion of siding with insurgents. Fear of reprisal by security agencies also prevented locals from helping the displaced. There were reports of enforced disappearances at the hands of government agencies in these areas including instances of government agencies taking away family members of suspected militants to compel them to surrender.

Other reports revealed an apparently systematic blocking of aid agencies' access to the displaced. A media report recounted how permission given to the UN on December 21, 2006 following foreign pressure to provide aid to IDPs in Balochistan, was abruptly withdrawn a few days later after an aid agency official said that an earlier permission could have saved hundreds of children's lives. According to the same report, the same week Edhi Foundation was explicitly asked not to deliver any more aid to affected Balochis as the situation was highly "sensitive".

Balochistan: humanitarian access to conflict affected populations denied (July 2006)

- There are several reports of authorities hindering access to the conflict affected populations
- Journalists have also been barred from entering to report from the camps

AHRC, 21 December 2006, p.21:

Since the latest killings, Balochistan has been cut off from the world. In response to the violent reaction of thousands of alienated and frustrated youths, more than 1000 people were reported to have been arrested in the last few days of August 2006, with about a dozen persons having been killed. Four cities - including Quetta, the provincial capital - have been placed under indefinite curfew after the killing of the Baloch leader. The provincial government has all but ceased operations. Law enforcement is in the hands of the military. Soldiers are also reported to have been stationed at hospitals. The federal government has suspended train services to the province. The highways were initially closed by the government, and have now been blockaded by angered local people. Balochistan is in serious danger. Curfews, check points and blockades are all obstacles to the movement of much-needed foods and medicines. The consequent suffering to the entire population is only further exacerbating anti-government sentiments. And under the cover of darkness and with transport links cut, the security forces are free to do as they please without fear of immediate consequences.

AHRC, 21 July 2006:

"The local people in these areas where displaced persons are settled, are not allowed by the intelligence agencies of Pakistan Army to help refugees. Edhi center, a local charitable organisation, has been stopped by the Pakistan Military from providing medical assistance to the affected people and from making medical camps in refugee settled areas. The main persons from Edhi center were summoned to Pakistan's capital, Islam Abad by the Military intelligence and were ordered to stop medical assistance to the victims. According to the daily Dawn the displaced are lying in the open skies in summer where temperature remains at 38 to 44 degrees centigrade. The conditions of the displaced are deteriorating day by day and urgent help is needed through from international organisations working for the rehabilitation of refugees and displaced persons."

Dawn, 13 July 2006:

"The vice-president of the Jamhuri Watan Party, Rafiq Ahmed Khoso, says that not only were sophisticated weapons used against largely unprotected civilian settlements but relief workers

were also turned away. "I visited many camps of DPs in Nasirabad, Jafarabad, Kashmore and other neighbouring towns. And I was told that Edhi relief volunteers were asked either to leave or operate among DPs without government security."

However, a spokesman for the Edhi Foundation says that a four-member team visited camps of DPs in Jafarabad, Nasirabad and Dera Murad Jamali about two months back and returned only when Dera Bugti's top bureaucracy chief, Abdul Samad Lasi, told them that they would be called when needed. "Mr Lasi assured us that the government would do all it could to help the DPs," says the spokesman."

Waziristan: no humanitarian access to the civilian population after army operations (September 2004)

IRIN, 8 September 2004:

"Residents of Pakistan's northwestern conflict-hit tribal belt of Wana have complained that no relief or human rights agency have acted to stem the deteriorating humanitarian situation following a military operation in the area designed to root out militants and those supporting them.

"Humanitarian organisations should have dispatched their teams and representatives to assess the loss of civilian lives, the demolition of houses, the disruption of livelihoods and the destruction of agriculture in the area," Wali Muhammad, a resident of the conflict-hit area of Shakai, told IRIN in the second largest city of North Western Frontier Province (NWFP), Dera Ismail Khan (DIK).

"We regret that no organisation has visited the area so far. They [military] bombarded our houses. Innocent children and women lost their lives but no one bothers," Muhammad said, adding, "We will show them the orchards and fields destroyed by the bombardment by the military. Only then can one have a balanced view. Otherwise there is no option except to believe the official statements.""

NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL RESPONSES

National

National Response (November 2009)

- IDPs registration process by the Government's National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA) is taking place. However, there is still a need to strengthen the process in order to ensure equal access to registration by all IDPs.
- Some IDPs have complained that their registration had not been computerized and that they had not received cash and ration cards. Others have reported that they were not being provided with food packages. In South Waziristan several IDPs reported that local government officials had refused to register them.
- In September 2009, OCHA reported that registration remained a concern as it had been suspended for new IDPs in all areas, including D.I. Khan and Tank District.
- Much of the humanitarian assistance provided to IDPs continues to be linked to governmental registration, however, many IDPs are still unregistered. An area of origin not listed by the Government as being conflict-affected may also prevent families from being registered.
- In Jazolai Camp, the re-screening process carried out by the Government and UNHCR revealed that many registration related problems were caused by incorrectly written Identity Card numbers on the original registration forms and by registration records that had not been included in the NADRA database. The re-screening process for IDPs in camps and in host communities continues as of October 2009.
- In October 2009, the Government decided to re-open registration of newly displaced people and to de link registration from cash grants. New IDPs will be eligible only for humanitarian aid, but not for the government cash grant.
- In September 2009, the NWFP government decided to further activate the Health and Nutrition Program.

The Nation, 16 July 2009:

"The government has so far issued 155,348 cash disbursement cards among IDPs, out of which 145,407 have been already activated. An amount of Rs.3.63 billion has been disbursed among IDP families, of which Rs. 2.407 billion cash have already been drawn by them so far using these cards, said Deputy Chairman, National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA), Tariq Malik. Giving information about issuance of cash cards to IDPs here Wednesday, he said process of registration and verification of the IDPs was made transparent which helped in efficient relief, rehabilitation and reconstruction efforts of the government along with its allied partners. He said before NADRA, variant versions of data were being used by various agencies but after NADRA's validation and verification, one single unified list was made available which resulted in consensus building across the federal and provincial governments. Tariq Malik said NADRA has so far received data of 664,818 IDPs families after registration by various agencies out of which only 289,251 were found to be eligible based on eligibility criteria agreed upon by Provincial, Federal Government and Special Support Group as well."

ECHO, September 2009:

"Even though it has to be acknowledged that registration is taking place, there is still a need to strengthen the process in order to ensure equal access to registration by all IDPs and notably for the most vulnerable, amongst them separated children and female-headed households and

women without ID cards."

Dawn, 7 September 2009:

"TIMERGARA: The returning internally displaced persons (IDPs) of Lower Dir have complained that they were not being treated fairly.

Talking to the media, they sought help from the government, saying that they should be treated like the IDPs of Swat. One Zahir Shah, resident of Maidan, said his family had been registered in the Lond Khwar Mardan about four months ago but they had not received cash and ration card.

'I am always being told that my registration has not been computerised and I can't get ration,' Shah said, adding that his family left Mardan but had been living in Talash area as the situation in Maidan was not favourable for them to return.

Shahid Khan, a government employee, said that despite being homeless for the last four months, his family had not been registered so far to get any relief package.

Imdadullah, resident Tazagram, said most of the Adenzai IDPs had been returned to their homes but they were not being provided with food packages.

He said some of the IDPs had got cash cards however most of them were still waiting for the facility.

'The government has set up distribution points in Swat and provides relief packages to the returning IDPs but such distribution points had not been set up in Lower Dir,' Mohammad Israr complained.

He said the people of Adenzai had suffered losses, their cash crops were destroyed and ban was imposed on maize cultivation this year but the IDPs, who had returned back to their homes, had still been waiting for relief package. The returning displaced persons demanded of the government relief package immediately."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"Registration remains a concern as it has been suspended for new IDPs in all areas, including in D.I. Khan and Tank Districts. Jalozai camp is the only camp where registration is still taking place. There is also a need for faster verification of registered IDPs by the National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA). [...] Protection Cluster consultations continue to develop IDP vulnerability criteria to provide assistance based on vulnerability/needs criteria rather than on registration. "

OCHA, 11 September 2009:

"Even though much of the humanitarian assistance provided to IDPs continues to be linked to governmental registration, many IDPs are still unregistered. Concerns remain about families not verified due to lost data or inaccurate data entry. A stated area of origin not listed by the Government as being conflict-affected may also prevent families from being registered."

OCHA, 17 September 2009:

"Re-Screening: The NWFP Government and SSG announced last week the re-screening of IDPs living inside camps and in host communities. Rescreening will help clarify the discrepancies found in the original registration exercise conducted by the government and provide accurate date to help humanitarian agencies target remaining beneficiaries. Both the government and UNHCR are developing methodologies on how and when this exercise will be conducted. A final government decision is expected after Eid. [...]NADRA operated a grievance desk in Jalozai Camp from 1 to 11 September to address registration-related problems of the registered IDPs in the camp. The majority of the problems were caused by incorrectly-written Identity Card numbers on the original registration forms, and by registration records that had not been included in the NADRA database. Community services partners requested NADRA to provide the same service in the other camps."

The News, 25 September 2009:

"PESHAWAR: The NWFP government decided to further activate the ongoing Health and Nutrition Program and a strategy in this regard is being hammered out, Geo News reported Friday.

The sources said Sanitary inspectors have been assigned the powers to check the sample of eatables, adding the focal persons have been appointed for the Nutrition Program in five districts including Peshawar, Charsadda, Noshehra, Mardan and Kohat.

According to sources, the school students would be apprised to further mobilize the Nutrition Program, so that awareness regarding healthcare could be boosted in children."

Oxfam, 1 October 2009:

"The government's smart-cards scheme was remarkably innovative and showed a real appreciation of what displaced people needed. It shows how aid agencies should respond by giving things people need or want rather than giving the kind of help we would like to provide".

IFRC, 8 October 2009:

"The armed forces claim to have cleared 90 per cent of the Malakand division and IDPs are returning to their places of residence. However, there is renewed fighting in Waziristan and as such, the government has decided to de-link new IDP registration from cash grants of PKR 25,000 (CHF 309 or USD 300). New IDPs will be eligible for humanitarian aid only.

The provincial relief, rehabilitation and settlement authority (PARRSA) has developed a draft for early recovery interventions; this draft was discussed in the recently held 'Friends of Pakistan' meeting. According to the provincial government, 2.1 million IDPs have received the grant for PKR 25,000."

Amnesty International, 16 October 2009:

"Several displaced residents of South Waziristan told Amnesty International that local government officials had refused to register them indicating a possibly serious under estimation of the total number of displaced people. "

OCHA, 1 October 2009:

"IDP Registration and Government Cash Grants: The government has decided to re-open registration of newly displaced people, and to de-link registration from the distribution of the government cash grant of Rs 25,000 (about \$300). All new registered internally displaced people (IDPs) will only be eligible for humanitarian assistance, but not for the government cash grant. IOM and the Provincial Disaster Management Authority (PDMA) are organizing a broad public information campaign about this decision.

According to the National Database Registration Authority (NADRA), over 2.1 million of the close to 2.7 million individuals (382,950 families) with official IDP status have benefited from the government cash grant. However, approximately a half million individuals (some 68,000 families) have not yet been processed to receive the government cash grant. The government has previously agreed that IDPs who are already registered and verified by NADRA are eligible to obtain cash grants.

Planning continues on the re-screening process for IDPs remaining in camps and host communities. The proposed re-screening process will provide data on registered and unregistered vulnerable individuals currently residing in Peshawar, Mardan, Swabi, Nowshera and Charsadda Districts."

Dawn, 24 October 2009:

"Minister for Information and Broadcasting, Qamar Zaman Kaira Saturday said the government has released Rs2.5 billion to meet the urgent needs of the dislocated persons from South Waziristan.

[....]

He said 11,000 families from South Waziristan Agency have already been registered and each displaced family is being provided with Rs5,000 as food-aid through cash cards, while they would also be provided money for purchase of non-food items."

Government of Pakistan, 2 November 2009:

"The Prime Minister said the Minister of State for Finance Ms. Hina Rabbani Khar has already been directed to oversee and monitor the implementation of developmental work in FATA and to ensure better coordination, hold monthly meetings with the FATA Parliamentarians.

He said the government has already released Rs. 2.5 billion for the dislocated people of South Waziristan where every family is being given Rs. 5000 and will receive a cash amount of Rs. 25000 on their return.

He said the Special Support Group has been directed to look after the people as no war can be won without winning the hearts and minds of the people.

The Prime Minister said he had asked the NWFP government to formulate a comprehensive strategy suggesting measures for reconstruction and rehabilitation phase of the dislocated persons of South Waziristan."

UNHCR, 6 November 2009:

"UNHCR is also supporting the registration of displaced people from South Waziristan which is being carried out by the provincial Social Welfare Department, with help from our local NGO partner. Some 350,000 people, comprising almost 48,000 families, have now been registered in Dera Ismail Khan and Tank, though only about 175,000 people (or 24,000 families) have yet been verified by the National Database and Registration Authority (NADRA). The verification process is ongoing but, at this stage, early indications suggest about 17% of families could be ineligible due to multiple registrations. A further 10% are not verified due to problems with their national ID cards, and another 2% are deemed not from areas affected by the military operations."

Ad-hoc provincial response in North West Frontier Province and Waziristan (March 2008)

- Provincial governments have carried out efforts to assist IDPs in Swat Valley and Waziristan which have had varying levels of success
- The protection of IDPs has sometimes not been possible, with camps set up by provincial governments under militant threats, or militants having open access to the camps

The government of Pakistan does not seem to have any systematic response to conflict-related IDPs; whatever response there has been so far seems to be from initiatives by provincial governments.

Integrated Regional Information Networks, November 2007:

"Efforts to establish a displaced persons camp in Pakistan's Swat Valley are under threat from militants fighting the government, according to aid officials.

"At present, there is no shortage of food or tents, but without any security, people don't want to come," Mohammad Munir, district manager of Pakistan's Red Crescent Society in Swat, told IRIN on 6 November from the town of Kanju, near the district capital Saidu Sharif.

On the evening of 2 November, one family arrived at the camp recently set up in the town of Barikot, 20km outside the capital, only to leave the following morning out of fear."

Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies, March 2008:

"State authorities established a relief camp near Kot Azam but it failed to provide any visible relief to the displaced people. Meanwhile ministry of defense announced an aid package of Rs 20 million for rehabilitation of the affected people. But the camps, so erected, lack relief facilities.

The camp administrators had demanded 5,000 tents but they got only 250. Food, medicines and quilts were not available in the camps at all. It means no appropriate measures were taken for provision of the basic needs and protection from the cold winter. In addition, gangs of militants had an open access to the camps, which prevented the people from receiving aid. No photographers were allowed to go inside and take the photographs of the inmates. State authorities and Taliban militants equally wanted that the miseries and sufferings of the people remain covered."

International

Humanitarian community (November 2009)

- Humanitarian agencies did their best to respond to the crisis, however, sectoral mandates and institutional agendas have sometimes taken precedence over beneficiary needs.
- There is a need for coordination mechanisms, especially in areas such as in the Swat District, where the number of aid organizations is growing, to avoid possible overlaps or gaps.
- ICRC has provided emergency assistance since May in Malakand.

Refugees International, 24 June 2009:

"The international response so far has been far too slow. The ongoing humanitarian operation is only the start of what will have to be prolonged and massive aid effort. Displaced families need immediate relief, and in time will require renewed confidence and support to return home in safety and dignity."

Logistics Cluster, September 2009:

"Intensified fighting between the Government and militant groups in NWFP has prompted further displacements of people, bringing the total number of IDPs to approx. 2.7 million. Whilst significant amounts of medicine, shelter, food and other life saving relief items are required, the gearing up of humanitarian response necessitates a strengthened and coordinated logistics approach to avoid bottlenecks, possible overlaps and/or gaps. The Logistics Cluster aims to address logistical challenges and facilitates the deliverance of humanitarian assistance to the displaced population in northwestern Pakistan. Initial and ongoing logistics assessments indicate increased needs primarily in humanitarian cargo consolidation and storage, as well as logistics coordination and information sharing."

Oxfam, 1 October 2009:

"Humanitarian agencies did their best to respond to a rapidly unfolding crisis with the tools and resources that they knew well or had at their immediate disposal. Unfortunately, as in many global emergency responses, the humanitarian response in Pakistan reflected a resource driven approach in which agencies' sectoral mandates and institutional agendas (including the kind of assistance that they would like to provide) has tended to take precedence over actual beneficiary need or preference, which in the case of Pakistan would have required a far greater use of cash-based assistance.

[...]

Cluster lead agencies should radically rethink their standard assistance models and ensure that their cluster explicitly and regularly considers what type of assistance would be the most appropriate in each phase of a humanitarian response."

OCHA, 16 October 2009:

"The need for coordination mechanisms in all areas of return is becoming more critical as the number of aid organisations working in these areas increase. This is particularly apparent in Swat District."

ICRC, 5 November 2009:

"Over 315,000 people will receive wheat seed and fertilizer in Dir and Buner as part of the programme. ICRC specialists will work closely with local experts to monitor the progress of the crop until its harvest next May, when most families are expected to be self-reliant again. Until then, the ICRC and the Pakistan Red Crescent will continue to provide those most in need with food."

"We have provided emergency assistance since late May, but our priority today is to help Malakand families to rapidly become self-reliant," said Pascal Cuttat, the head of the ICRC delegation in Pakistan. "We expect this programme to help kick-start local agriculture and boost small business, which is indispensable if the people affected are to lead dignified lives."

"We would like to eventually extend this programme to Swat but are unable to do so at the moment," said Muhammad Sheikh Ali, the head of the ICRC's economic security programme in Pakistan. "Assistance on this scale requires direct supervision, and at present we are not yet assured of continuous access." "

Slow funding (November 2009)

- In May 2009, the UN issued a revised humanitarian appeal for the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan (PHRP) of 543 million dollars and asked the donors to respond generously and immediately. However, despite the emergency of the situation, the response has been insufficient and slow and the appeal remained severely underfunded.
- As of November 2009, the PHRP had been funded at 70,5 per cent of the total requirement, which had been increased at 680 million dollars.
- Most of the clusters under the PHRP are gravely underfunded. Early Recovery Cluster is the last funded sector in the PHRP, with only three percent coverage as of September 2009.
- In October 2008, the IFRC stated that the appeal coverage of the Pakistan Red Crescent Society was at 45 per cent and that funds were urgently needed to enable to scale up emergency and recovery activities.
- NGOs have also received insufficient funding to implement their projects. For instance, lack of funding forced Oxfam GB to exclude 30,000 families from receiving emergency water, sanitation and non food items. Lack of funds also prevented Save the Children from scaling up health and nutrition services. ACTED beneficiaries had to wait for three months before receiving shelter material.
- The late and insufficient donor contributions have prevented humanitarian agencies from meeting the needs of the affected communities.

OCHA, 17 September 2009:

"Funding outside the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan (PHRP) has increased by 27 percent and is currently at US\$152.9 million. In the reporting period, there were no changes in the funding situation inside the PHRP, which is currently covered at 68 percent or \$367 million. Some \$26

million of the funds are pledged. Donors are encouraged to turn their pledges into commitments as soon as possible."

OCHA, 1 October 2009:

"In the last two weeks, the funding requirements in the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan have been increased by 20 percent- from \$542 million to \$680 million. [...] The PHRP is currently funded at 60.4 percent after several Member States significantly increased their contributions."

OCHA, 12 October 2009:

"To date, 60 percent of the \$680 million revised requirements for the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan has been funded by more than 20 countries and private individuals and organisations."

IFRC, 8 October 2009:

Appeal target (current): CHF 7,974,809 (USD 7.58 million or EUR 5.3 million);

<click here to view the attached Revised Emergency Appeal Budget>

Appeal coverage: 45%. Funds are still urgently needed to enable Pakistan Red Crescent Society (PRCS) to

scale up its emergency and recovery activities in this humanitarian crisis.

<click here to go directly to the updated donor response report, or here to link to contact details >

The Frontier Post, 6 November 2009:

"United Nations has said it requires \$ 201 million more to continue its efforts on the humanitarian response to the IDPs in Pakistan with a special focus over the people now leaving South Waziristan Agency in the wake of the operation against militants. At present \$ 479 million has been funded to the Pakistan humanitarian Response Plan at 70.5 per cent of the total requirement that is \$ 680 million. Addressing a news conference here Thursday, Martin Mogwanja, UN humanitarian coordinator in Pakistan, said that 17 per cent of refugees from SWA could be ineligible for registration purpose due to multiple registration type issues while further 11 per cent may not be verified due to their CINC issues and another 2.4 per cent are facing difficulties in the process of registration as they do not belong to the affected operation zone."

Refugees International, 24 June 2009:

"To respond to this humanitarian emergency, the United Nations issued at the end of May a \$543 million humanitarian appeal (HAP), which was a revision of an initial appeal aimed to respond to the half million displaced from FATA. This latest HAP includes emergency relief projects by all UN agencies and a number of international NGOs, and calls on donors to respond generously and immediately to one of the largest displacement crises in the world. Despite the urgency of the situation, and the strategic importance of the region, the response has been insufficient and the appeal remains severely underfunded, with only 35% of it pledged to date. The protection cluster of the appeal has only received 21% of the funding requested."

UNICEF, 3 July 2009:

"The Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan, revised in May to cope with new displacements caused by the military operations in Swat and Buner, has so far raised less than a third of the \$543 million required to support 1.7 million IDPs for six months. As part of the Appeal, UNICEF requested \$52 million. To date \$22.5 million has been received from donors and is in hand –and another \$9.3 million has been pledged."

UNHCR, 6 July 2009:

"ABU DHABI, United Arab Emirates, July 6 (UNHCR) – The government of the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and UNHCR on Monday signed a partnership agreement to support vital humanitarian operations in Pakistan.

The agreement – signed on the UAE's behalf by the Khalifa Bin Zayed Al Nahyan Foundation – will provide for the needs of internally displaced people, mainly women and children, living in precarious conditions. The partnership includes procurement of basic relief items such as tents, blankets, sleeping mats, plastic sheeting, mosquito nets and kitchen sets to displaced Pakistani families living in some 21 camps or with host families.

It will also help facilitate the voluntary return of displaced people in north-west Pakistan. UNHCR considers the current humanitarian crisis, with more than 2 million displaced Pakistanis in the North West Frontier Province and the Federally Administered Tribal Areas, as one of the largest, fastest and most complex operations it has faced in years.

"We would like to express our deep gratitude and respect to the leadership and people of the UAE for their generous support, which underscores their important role in international humanitarian work," said Panos Moumtzis, head off UNHCR's resource mobilization service. "We value tremendously the UNHCR-Khalifa Foundation cooperation and consider it as one of the most important partnerships we have embarked upon in the region in the last decade." "

IRIN, 7 July 2009:

" "Within two to three weeks we won't have any more essential drugs for treating people in the camps," Laroche said, adding that the international community had failed to deliver.

Laroche also said the shortage of medicines was coinciding with the start of the rainy season when cholera, malaria and other diseases usually become more prevalent. "

Dawn, 8 July 2009:

"Aid officials also say they will struggle to provide for people going back as donors have only come forward with about one third of the 543 million dollars requested to alleviate the humanitarian crisis.

'Somehow this IDP (internally displaced persons) issue has been relatively neglected,' said Holmes, who arrived on Tuesday on his first official visit to Pakistan, and will stay until Saturday."

Dawn, 11th September 2009:

"Pakistan's role as a frontline US ally in the struggle against the Taliban has made it a priority for international support, but aid workers say a global credit crunch has meant donors have held back funding.

The UN had only received three per cent of around \$58 million it needed for what it calls 'early recovery' projects – the provision of food as well as the restoration of schools, hospitals and water supply systems, UN Humanitarian Coordinator in Pakistan Martin Mogwanja told a press conference.

The United Nations estimated more than two-thirds of the 2.7 million displaced by the conflict had gone home. The estimate is the highest yet, and based on data provided by the government.

[...]

Those living in rural communities have returned to find they have lost their crops and animals.

Schools, hospitals and roads have been damaged or destroyed, and many people are finding it difficult to earn livelihoods in areas still subject to a fluid security situation.

The NWFP government and authorities in tribal areas undertook a survey to assess needs of people now living in the conflict zone."

OCHA, 4 September 2009:

"So far, the WFP Augmentation Project, which includes the Logistics Cluster component, is only 29 percent funded against a total requirement of US\$ 6.5 million. [...]The agriculture cluster is only funded at 16 percent of its total requirement of \$21.9 million in the revised Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan. [...]The Early Recovery Cluster is the least funded sector in the

Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan (PHRP), with only three percent coverage so far. This translates to less than one million dollars in funding of the \$28.6 million needed."

OCHA, 11 September 2009:

"There has been no change in funding since the last report. PHRP funding remains at 68 percent of the \$542 million required."

Oxfam, 1 October 2009:

"[...] that late and insufficient donor contributions prevented humanitarian agencies from responding on a scale that would have met the actual needs of affected communities. Oxfam, for example, had to dramatically revise its initial response plan after failing to receive sufficient donor funding, and was thereby forced to exclude 30,000 families (or more than 200,000 people) from receiving emergency water, sanitation and non-food items during the first three months of the response. [...] An eventual increase of donor funds to the Pakistan Humanitarian Response Plan and other emergency activities reflected a gradual acknowledgement on the part of donors of the scale of humanitarian needs created by Pakistan's displacement crisis. Unfortunately, this realisation came too late to allow aid agencies to reach their target number of beneficiaries, and some funding gaps persist today – for example, in the education, agriculture, and early recovery sectors.

[...]

While the provincial government's Emergency Response Unit (ERU) received an immediate central government transfer of approximately US \$10m to quickly set up IDP camps and extend services in displacement areas, the majority of humanitarian agencies lacked this kind of access to ready-made resources. Following the mass exodus of people (and the UN's announcement on 22 May of a revised humanitarian appeal requiring US \$542m⁵), only a handful of donors took immediate measures to allocate new funds for the sudden increase in humanitarian needs. [...] Even donors who have given generously to major humanitarian crises in the past failed to live up to the occasion – the Netherlands, for example, provided only around 3 million euros to the response, while DFID gave less than half of the amount that it had provided after 2005 Pakistan earthquake⁷. More than one month into the emergency, on 11 June, the UN's emergency appeal had received less than a quarter of required funds (a significant proportion of which, it must be noted, had been earmarked or already spent to assist the 500,000 displaced people who fled their homes before April 2009).

Even more problematic than the absence of sufficient funds were the slow and ineffective disbursement mechanisms chosen by some of the major donors to the Pakistan IDP crisis. There is a global shift away from bilateral funding agreements that channel donor money directly to frontline NGOs (who generally deliver the bulk of global humanitarian assistance). Reflecting this, the majority of donors in Pakistan preferred to deposit their money with UN agencies or to follow other multilateral allocation processes (see Box 2), and this added additional layers of time and bureaucracy to the disbursement. By 24 June, seven weeks into the crisis, OCHA's Financial Tracking Service showed that only 13 per cent of NGO-implemented projects had received any funding from donors. UN projects also remained under-funded at 47 per cent, but had fared proportionally better than those of their NGO counterparts. Given UN agencies' tendency to work through international or local partners (rather than implement their own operational programmes) and the additional limitations that the insecure environment has placed on the UN's ability to operate in Pakistan, it should have been clear to donors that the majority of their funds would ultimately be transferred from UN-cluster lead agencies to operational NGOs. Unfortunately, global experiences have shown that this is rarely a rapid or simple process.

Bilateral contributions to NGOs from donors such as OFDA and Ausaid managed to reach affected people quickly and effectively, but a number of multilateral contributions to UN-cluster lead agencies (including major actors like UNHCR and UNICEF) did not manage to pass through the system in time to reach thousands of displaced families waiting for assistance with water, sanitation, health and even shelter.

The overall impact of donors' decisions regarding the size of their humanitarian contributions or disbursement mechanism is difficult to quantify, but examples provided by operational actors during interviews speak volumes about missed opportunities to prevent human suffering.

While most frontline agencies were able to set up operations and launch initial assistance activities by drawing on their own funds, the overall funding gaps proved too wide to transition seamlessly from this small start-up phase to the implementation of more substantial donor funded projects. In essence, it meant that fewer beneficiaries received assistance, and in a smaller number of emergency sectors. To provide illustrations from just four NGOs:

A lack of readily available funding forced Oxfam GB to exclude 30,000 families from receiving emergency water, sanitation, and nonfood items in the first three months of the crisis.

Lack of funds prevented Save the Children from scaling up health and nutrition services that could have assisted an additional 2400 beneficiaries each day, and from launching an emergency education programme that could have benefited 10,000 children.

The slow arrival of funds through unwieldy disbursement mechanisms meant that ACTED beneficiaries had to wait for three months before the NGO could provide shelter materials to more than 1000 families who were suffering from intense temperatures in their IDP camp.

Slow disbursements of promised funding forced Islamic Relief to borrow start-up funds for the emergency response against their longer-term programmes – causing several months of delays in the implementation of valuable development work (including the construction and rehabilitation of schools and basic health units) in other parts of Pakistan."

Refugees International, 24 June 2009:

"[...] immediate aid effort now, including funding for food, shelter, and drinking water, as well as trauma-related services which aid agencies report is a severe need especially amongst children. It must also prepare to allocate further monies to assistance and reconstruction as needed."

OCHA, 12 October 2009:

"Millions of people have been affected by the conflict in Pakistan, and humanitarian assistance is needed for those who are still displaced, the newly displaced, those who have returned to their areas of origin, those who never left the conflict-affected areas, and families providing shelter for internally displaced persons (IDPs)."

International and national agencies denied access to displaced in Balochistan and Waziristan (March 2008)

- International humanitarian organizations such as the ICRC assisted IDPs in the North West Frontier Province's Swat Valley, often in partnership with local groups
- The conflict areas of Waziristan are off limits to international aid agencies
- The government has prevented international agencies from assisting the IDPs in Balochistan despite the agencies having plans in place to assist the displaced

International Committee of the Red Cross, January 2008:

"In the NWFP, while running the already ongoing medical projects in Miranshah, Bannu, Tank and Peshawar for those injured by weapons, ICRC has advanced its endeavours. The Internally Displaced Persons in Swat were assisted by distributing blankets and soap to three hundreds families who had left their homes due to the crisis and shifted to safer places in Udigran, Tandodag and Qambar villages. The x-ray material and medical kits meant to treat and support hundred weapon-wounded patients injured during the clashes were also distributed in Sadda, Parachinar and Saidu Sharif hospitals, and requests for further assistance are followed."

International Development and Relief Foundation, November 2007:

“This project is providing food for 500 families displaced in Swat and Shangla districts. Supplies in packages are provided to the poorest and most vulnerable families living in temporary shelters. The assistance will be provided through the Relief and Reconstruction Teams of Sarhad Rural Support Programme (SRSP), who have been coordinating its efforts with government in Swat and Shangla. Shelter, food and medicine have been identified as important activities that need to be addressed in the area. SRSP is focusing on food supplies while other organizations are dealing with shelter and medicine. These supplies in packages will be provided to the poorest and most vulnerable families living in these temporary shelters. An effort would be made to ensure that poor, women headed families and children are given particular attention.”

McClatchy Newspapers, March 2008:

“The region [Waziristan] is closed to foreign journalists and international aid organizations, and local journalists operate under self-imposed restrictions to protect themselves.”

International Crisis Group, October 2007:

“Since December 2005 when military operations began, at least 84,000 people have been displaced by the conflict in Dera Bugti and Kohlu districts alone. According to a UN internal assessment in July-August 2006 that was leaked to the press, the displaced persons, mostly women (26,000) and children (33,000), were living in makeshift camps without adequate shelter in Jafarabad, Naseerabad, Quetta, Sibi and Bolan districts. 28 per cent of five-year-old children were acutely malnourished, and more than 6 per cent were in a state of “severe acute malnourishment”, with their survival dependent on receiving immediate medical attention. Over 80 per cent of deaths among those surveyed were among children under five. The government initially dismissed the UN assessment as exaggerated, claiming that almost all the internally displaced (IDPs) had gone home. However, it denied aid agencies and media access to the areas to which they had supposedly returned. In December 2006, in the first official acknowledgement of the gravity of the humanitarian crisis, the government gave UN agencies permission to conduct relief efforts, albeit with preconditions, including that aid would have to be disbursed under the supervision of local authorities. UN officials were also reportedly told not to speak to the media. Soon after, the government reportedly backtracked and blocked access to the UN and other aid agencies. Local non-governmental organisations’ (NGOs) efforts, including that of the Edhi Foundation, were also halted.”

LIST OF SOURCES USED

(alphabetical order)

Agence France-Presse (AFP), 2 November 2009, UN pulls international staff from northwest Pakistan: official

Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/JBRN-7XEDGV?OpenDocument> , accessed 19 November 2009

Agence France-Presse (AFP), 3 November 2009, Aid workers worry over Pakistan war zone

Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/SNAA-7XF9LU?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 13 November 2009

Ahmed, Khaled, 20 May 2004, Plight of Hindus in Sindh and Balochistan

Internet : <http://www.hvk.org/articles/0504/78.html> , accessed 17 January 2006

Amnesty International (AI), 13 April 2006, Pakistan: Concern about escalating sectarian violence (ASA 33/010/2006)

Internet : <http://web.amnesty.org/library/Index/ENGASA330102006?open&of=ENG-2S4> , accessed 7 September 2006

Amnesty International (AI), 16 October 2009, Pakistan government must prepare for South Waziristan displacement crisis

Internet : <http://www.amnesty.org/en/news-and-updates/pakistan-government-must-prepare-south-waziristan-displacement-crisis-20091016> , accessed 20 October 2009

Asian Human Rights Commission (AHRC), 21 July 2006, General Appeal: Urgent help is needed for 200,000 displaced victims of military operations in Balochistan province

Internet : <http://www.ahrchk.net/ua/mainfile.php/2006/1872/> , accessed 7 September 2006

Asian Human Rights Commission (AHRC), 21 December 2006, The State of Human Rights in Eleven Asian Nations

Asian Indigenous & Tribal Peoples Network (AITPN), 27 January 2007, Jackboot justice in tribal heartland

Internet : <http://www.aitpn.org/Issues/II-01-07-Balochis.pdf> , accessed 30 April 2008

BBC News, 7 March 2006, Pakistan points finger at Afghans

Internet : http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/world/south_asia/4781010.stm , accessed 7 March 2006

Bhushan, Nagesh, 8 March 2006, Balochistan : Pakistan playing divide and rule game with balochi tribes

Internet : <http://intellibriefs.blogspot.com/2006/03/balochistan-pakistan-playing-divide.html> , accessed 22 September 2006

Center of Excellence in Disaster Management & Humanitarian Assistance (COE-DMHA), 9 March 2006, Violence continues in Pakistan's western tribal region as rights groups call for protection of civilians

Council of Europe (COE), 27 October 2009, Strengthening EU Action in Afghanistan and Pakistan

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/0758207BC7D387D6C125766D003A73EE/\\$file/Council+for+the+EU-+27+Oct+2009-+Strengthening+EU+action+in+Afghanistan+and+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/0758207BC7D387D6C125766D003A73EE/$file/Council+for+the+EU-+27+Oct+2009-+Strengthening+EU+action+in+Afghanistan+and+Pakistan.pdf) ,

Dawn, 13 July 2006, When pride stands in the way of tears

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2006/07/13/top17.htm> , accessed 13 September 2006

Dawn, 13 October 2007, HRCP urges end to hostilities in N. Waziristan

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2007/10/13/nat4.htm> , accessed 20 April 2008

Dawn, 8 December 2007, Swat DPs start returning home

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2007/12/09/top4.htm> , accessed 30 April 2008

Dawn, 29 January 2008, Mass exodus as clashes continue in South Waziristan

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2008/01/29/top7.htm> , accessed 29 January 2008

Dawn, 4 February 2008, Unofficial 'ceasefire' in South Waziristan

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2008/02/04/top1.htm> , accessed 4 February 2008

Dawn, 9 February 2008, DERA ISMAIL KHAN: Displaced tribesmen want end to war

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/2008/02/09/local18.htm> , accessed 28 April 2008

Dawn, 7 October 2009, FAO project to benefit 86,000 families

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/business/09-fao-project-to-benefit-86000-families--szh-08> , accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 26 October 2009, Around 200,000 flee Waziristan offensive

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/03-around-200000-flee-pakistan-offensive-ss-02> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 30 October 2009, Clinton faces Pakistani anger at drone attacks

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/03-clinton-faces-pakistani-anger-at-drone-attacks-ss-12> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 12 September 2009, Future of IDPs

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/08-future-of-idps-ts-02> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 11 September 2009, Only 3pc of required \$58m received: UN

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/09-only-3pc-of-required--58m-received-un--szh-07> , accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 25 October 2009, Access denied

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/11-access-denied--il-08> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 20 October 2009, Refugees see Waziristan operation as pointless

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/11-disillusioned-pakistanis-uprooted-by-offensive--il-07> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 30 July 2009, One million children face threat to education: UN

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/12-one+million+children+face+threat+to+education+un--bi-03> , accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 24 October 2009, Rs2.5bn released to meet urgent needs of IDPs

Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/13+rs2-5bn+released+to+meet+urgent+needs+of+idps-za-05> , accessed 13 November 2009

Dawn, 7 September 2009, IDPs returning to Lower Dir short of food
Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/provinces/03-idps-returning-to-lower-dir-short-of-food-ss-02> ,
accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 28 September 2009, Civilians fleeing South Waziristan to 'safety'
Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/provinces/04-civilians-fleeing-south-waziristan-qs-10> , accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 8 July 2009, UN aid chief urges security before IDPs return
Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/news/pakistan/provinces/09-un-aid-chief-urges-security-before-idps-return--szh-04> ,
accessed 13 October 2009

Dawn, 29 October 2009, At least 101 killed, 150 injured; fire destroys several buildings; many trapped in debris: Peshawar bomb targets women, children
Internet : <http://www.dawn.com/wps/wcm/connect/dawn-content-library/dawn/the-newspaper/front-page/at-least-101-killed%2C-150-injured-fire-destroys-several-buildings-many-trapped-in-debris-peshawar-bomb-targets-women%2C-children-909> , accessed 13 November 2009

European Commission - Humanitarian Aid Office (ECHO), September 2009, Commission Decision of on the financing of humanitarian Actions from the general budget of the European Communities in Pakistan
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/642719B1BCC58BAD1257655004BCBA7/\\$file/ECHO-+September+2009-+Commission+Decision+Aid+to+Pakistan+45+mE.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/642719B1BCC58BAD1257655004BCBA7/$file/ECHO-+September+2009-+Commission+Decision+Aid+to+Pakistan+45+mE.pdf) ,

Financial Times, 14 June 2009, Transcript: Interview with Pakistan's foreign minister
Internet : <http://www.ft.com/cms/s/0/e58cab6c-58bf-11de-80b3-00144feabdc0.html> , accessed 13 November 2009

Government of Pakistan, 2 November 2009, Govt accords high priority to development of FATA - PM
Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/JBRN-7XFHEL?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 13 November 2009

Handicap International, 26 May 2009, 2.4 million displaced persons, an unprecedented crisis
Internet : [http://www.handicap-international.fr/en/around-the-world0/more-than-60-programmes-in-the/programs/pakistan-1/actus/25-million-displaced-persons-an-unprecedented-crisis/index.html?dechi_programmes\[cat\]=&dechi_programmes\[action\]=&cHash=d6cbc97d5a](http://www.handicap-international.fr/en/around-the-world0/more-than-60-programmes-in-the/programs/pakistan-1/actus/25-million-displaced-persons-an-unprecedented-crisis/index.html?dechi_programmes[cat]=&dechi_programmes[action]=&cHash=d6cbc97d5a) ,
accessed 13 November 2009

Handicap International, 24 August 2009, Intervening to help the most vulnerable
Internet : <http://www.handicap-international.fr/en/around-the-world0/more-than-60-programmes-in-the/programs/pakistan-1/actus/intervening-to-help-the-most-vulnerable/index.html?cHash=b75f2c1cb5> , accessed 13 November 2009

Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, April 2008, HRCP Annual Report - State of Human Rights in 2007: Refugees Section
Internet : <http://hrcp-web.org/6-5%20refugees.pdf> , accessed 20 April 2008

Human Rights Commission of Pakistan, April 2008, Human Rights Commission Report 2007-Refugees Section
Internet : <http://hrcp-web.org/6-5%20refugees.pdf> , accessed 1 May 2008

Human Rights Watch (HRW), 8 March 2006, Pakistan: Protect Civilians From Fighting in North Waziristan - Government Should Open Area to Independent Observers
Internet : <http://hrw.org/english/docs/2006/03/08/pakist12774.htm> , accessed 17 July 2006

Human Rights Watch (HRW), 31 January 2008, Events of 2007
Internet : <http://www.hrw.org/englishwr2k8/docs/2008/01/31/pakist17611.htm> , accessed 28 April 2008

Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses (IDSA), 5 October 2009, The Situation in Balochistan
Internet : http://www.idsa.in/idsastrategiccomments/TheSituationinBalochistan_AGupta_051009 , accessed 2 December 2009

Institute of Peace and Conflict Studies (IPCS), 28 June 2006, Balochistan: Kalpars, Masuris and the Intra Bugti Clashes in Dera Bugti
Internet : http://www.ipcs.org/Pak_articles2.jsp?action=showView&kValue=2066&country=1016&status=article&mod=a&portal=pakistan , accessed 17 July 2006

Institute of Peace and Conflict Studies (IPCS), 28 December 2007, The Swat Offensive
Internet : http://www.ipcs.org/Pak_articles2.jsp?action=showView&kValue=2468&country=1016&status=article&mod=a , accessed 26 April 2008

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 6 November 2007, Militants threaten to burn Swat camp
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=75171> , accessed 15 November 2007

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 20 November 2007, Thousands flee Swat Valley as army moves in to tackle militants
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=75410> , accessed 22 November 2007

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 17 December 2007, Swat Valley picks up the pieces after clashes
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=75903> , accessed 18 April 2008

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 16 April 2008, Displaced people begin returning to conflict-hit Waziristan
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=77798> , accessed 17 April 2008

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 5 July 2009, Timeline on human displacement since 2004
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=85137> , accessed 7 July 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 7 July 2009, IDP health in the spotlight
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=85167> , accessed 7 July 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 2 September 2009, Tension in Waziristan prompts fear of further displacements
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=85964> , accessed 13 October 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 16 September 2009, Tens of thousands displaced from Khyber Agency - official
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=86166> , accessed 13 October 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 22 September 2009, In Brief: New Pakistan IDPs staying mostly with relatives
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=86237> , accessed 13 October 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 22 October 2009, Harrowing tales of flight from Waziristan
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=86688> , accessed 13 November 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 26 October 2009, Waziristan IDPs get measles vaccinations for first time
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=86751> , accessed 20 November 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 17 November 2009, South Waziristan IDPs move further from conflict zone
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/Report.aspx?ReportId=87079> , accessed 18 November 2009

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 8 September 2004, "AFGHANISTAN-PAKISTAN: Displaced in Wana say they are receiving little support"
Internet : http://www.irinnews.org/report.asp?ReportID=43083&SelectRegion=Central_Asia , accessed 20 September 2004

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 7 September 2006, Interview with UN Humanitarian Coordinator, Jan Vandemoortele
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/report.asp?ReportID=55441&SelectRegion=Asia&SelectCountry=PAKISTAN> , accessed 6 October 2006

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN), 14 September 2006, Landmine toll increasing in restive Balochistan
Internet : <http://www.irinnews.org/report.asp?ReportID=55565> , accessed 25 September 2006

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 6 October 2009, Protecting detainees a priority
Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/htmlall/pakistan-interview-061009> , accessed 20 October 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 30 July 2009, Future uncertain for many displaced people returning home
Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/htmlall/pakistan-update-300709> , accessed 13 October 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), April 2008, The ICRC in Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/Web/Eng/siteeng0.nsf/htmlall/pakistan?OpenDocument> , accessed 20 April 2008

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 12 November 2009, Internally displaced people: facing up to the challenges
Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/displacement-interview-121109?opendocument> , accessed 13 November 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 18 May 2009, Alina learns to walk again
Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/pakistan-feature-180509> , accessed 20 October 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 23 October 2009, Protection of civilians a priority as violence grows

Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/pakistan-interview-231009> , accessed 13 November 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 29 October 2009, ICRC supports medical facilities in Waziristan

Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/pakistan-interview-291009> , accessed 13 November 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 5 November 2009, ICRC launches large-scale economic assistance in Malakand Division

Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/pakistan-news-051109!OpenDocument> , accessed 13 November 2009

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), 22 September 2009, ICRC and Pakistan Red Crescent assist displaced and returnees

Internet : <http://www.icrc.org/web/eng/siteeng0.nsf/html/pakistan-update-220909> , accessed 13 October 2009

International Crisis Group (ICG), 14 September 2006, Pakistan: The Worsening Conflict in Balochistan

Internet : <http://www.crisisgroup.org/home/index.cfm?id=4373&l=1> , accessed 6 October 2006

International Crisis Group (ICG), 22 October 2007, Pakistan: The Forgotten Conflict in Balochistan

Internet : <http://www.crisisgroup.org/home/index.cfm?id=5131&l=1> , accessed 30 October 2007

International Crisis Group (ICG), 15 June 2006, India, Pakistan and Kashmir: Stabilising a Cold Peace

Internet : http://www.crisisgroup.org/library/documents/asia/south_asia/b51_india_pakistan_and_kashmir_stabilising_a_cold_peace.pdf , accessed 19 June 2006

International Crisis Group (ICG), 22 October 2007, The Forgotten Conflict in Balochistan

Internet : http://www.crisisgroup.org/library/documents/asia/south_asia/b69_pakistan_the_forgotten_conflict_in_balochistan.pdf , accessed 5 May 2008

International Crisis Group (ICG), 4 December 2003, Kashmir: learning from the past, Asia Paper no. 70

Internet : http://www.crisisweb.org/library/documents/asia/070_kashmir_learning_from_the_past.pdf , accessed 8 December 2003

International Crisis Group (ICG), 11 July 2002, Kashmir: Confrontation and Miscalculation

Internet : http://www.icg.org/library/documents/report_archive/A400696_11072002.pdf , accessed 28 August 2002

International Development and Relief Foundation (IDRF), April 2008, Swat & Shangla Humanitarian Crisis Relief

Internet : http://idrf.com/index.php?option=com_content&task=view&id=221&Itemid=147 , accessed 20 April 2008

International Federation of the Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC), 4 November 2009, Pakistan Red Crescent responds as escalating violence hits major cities

Internet : <http://www.ifrc.org/Docs/News/09/09110401/index.asp> , accessed 13 November 2009

International Federation of the Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC), 8 October 2009, Operations Update n°9
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/3D97AEC6094D614CC125767400486B55/\\$file/MDRPK003_OU9.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/3D97AEC6094D614CC125767400486B55/$file/MDRPK003_OU9.pdf) ,

International Rescue Committee (IRC), 13 October 2009, Pakistan's Forgotten Crisis
Internet : <http://www.theirc.org/news/pakistans-forgotten-crisis-6471> , accessed 13 November 2009

IPS News, 3 November 2007, Pro-Taliban Militants Grip Swat Valley, Defy Army
Internet : <http://ipsnews.net/news.asp?idnews=39916> , accessed 26 April 2008

Islamic Relief (IR), 23 June 2009, Sanitation systems close to collapse
Internet : <http://www.islamic-relief.com/Emergencies-And-Appeals/emArticleView.aspx?emID=58&artID=567> , accessed 13 October 2009

Islamic Relief (IR), 31 July 2009, Displaced families return to desolate Swat valley
Internet : <http://www.islamic-relief.com/Emergencies-And-Appeals/emArticleView.aspx?emID=58&artID=578> , accessed 14 August 2009

Islamic Relief (IR), 2009, Pakistan (NWFP) Emergency Appeal
Internet : <http://www.islamic-relief.com/Emergencies-And-Appeals/emBackground.aspx?emID=58>
accessed 13 October 2009

Islamic Relief (IR), 22 July 2009, Families returning to Swat face hunger this Ramadan
Internet : <http://www.islamicrelief.com/NewsRoom/NewsDetails.aspx?newsID=250> , , accessed 13 October 2009

Kashmir Herald, 3 December 2007, The Sledgehammer in Swat
Internet : <http://kashmirherald.com/main.php?t=OP&st=D&no=343> , accessed 18 April 2008

Logistics Cluster, 29 September 2009, Logistics Cluster Meeting, Islamabad
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/36A0D1FF686CB673C125765600423416/\\$file/Logistics+Cluster-+29+September+2009-+Pakistan-Minutes+of+the+Meeting.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/36A0D1FF686CB673C125765600423416/$file/Logistics+Cluster-+29+September+2009-+Pakistan-Minutes+of+the+Meeting.pdf) ,

Logistics Cluster, September 2009, IDP Operation Monthly Bulletin
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/A0A47048E231CA80C125765600429E06/\\$file/Logistics+Cluster-+September+2009+Bulletin-+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/A0A47048E231CA80C125765600429E06/$file/Logistics+Cluster-+September+2009+Bulletin-+Pakistan.pdf) ,

Medecins Sans Frontieres (MSF), 29 June 2009, Difficultés d'accès aux soins pour les blessés
Internet : <http://www.msf-azg.be/fr/main-menu/actualites/infos/news-detail/table/1338.html> ,
accessed 13 November 2009

Medecins Sans Frontieres (MSF), 27 August 2009, MSF renforce sa présence à Mardan et dans le Lower Dir
Internet : <http://www.msf-azg.be/fr/main-menu/actualites/infos/news-detail/table/1364.html> ,
accessed 13 October 2009

Medical Emergency Relief International (MERLIN), 30 October 2009, Mass displacement in Waziristan causing humanitarian crisis
Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/MUMA-7XC2SC?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 13 November 2009

New York Times (NYT), 17 July 2007, Pakistan Sends Tribal Leaders to Salvage Truce Broken by Taliban
Internet : <http://www.nytimes.com/2007/07/17/world/asia/17pakistan.html> , accessed 28 April 2008

New York Times (NYT), 26 October 2007, Fighting Intensifies Around Stronghold of Pakistani Cleric
Internet : <http://www.nytimes.com/2007/10/27/world/asia/27pakistan.html> , accessed 26 April 2008

Newsline, June 2007, Pakistan's 'Other' War
Internet : <http://www.newsline.com.pk/NewsJun2007/newsbeatjune2007.htm> , accessed 20 April 2008

Oxfam, October 2009, Millions of displaced Pakistanis missed out on aid because rich countries gave too little too late
Internet : <http://www.oxfam.org/en/pressroom/pressrelease/2009-10-01/millions-displaced-pakistanis-missed-out-aid> , accessed 13 October 2009

Oxfam, October 2009, Oxfam Briefing Paper: Missing pieces? Assessing the impact of humanitarian reform in Pakistan
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/D6852369449C25D4C125764E00582C5E/\\$file/Oxfam+Briefing+Paper-+1+October+2009-+Missing+Pieces+Assessing+the+Impact+of+Humanitarian+Reform+in+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/D6852369449C25D4C125764E00582C5E/$file/Oxfam+Briefing+Paper-+1+October+2009-+Missing+Pieces+Assessing+the+Impact+of+Humanitarian+Reform+in+Pakistan.pdf) ,

Pakistan Institute for Peace Studies, 11 March 2008, Enforced Displacement of Tribal People will Strengthen Militants
Internet : <http://san-pips.com/PIPS-SAN-Files/SAN-Pakistan/SAN-PAK-Article58/San-Pak-Main-A58-D.asp> , accessed 20 April 2008

Pakistan Red Crescent Society, 16 September 2009, PRCS Humanitarian Operation in Swat District (NWFP) Report Update no.42
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/3193976518E64EA7C125764F002DA128/\\$file/PRCS-+Update+n+42-+16+September+2009-+Humanitarian+Operation+in+Swat+District.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/3193976518E64EA7C125764F002DA128/$file/PRCS-+Update+n+42-+16+September+2009-+Humanitarian+Operation+in+Swat+District.pdf) ,

Pashtun Post, 5 April 2009, John Solecki Released: Ban Ki-moon Hails Release
Internet : <http://www.pashtunpost.com/news.php?news=213&category=> , accessed 17 November 2009

Pashtun Post, 18 May 2009, Displaced Students Are Uncertain About Their Future
Internet : <http://www.pashtunpost.com/news.php?news=246> , accessed 13 November 2009

Provincial Disaster Management Authority, Government of NWFP, 27 October 2009, IDP Figures
Internet : http://www.helpidp.org/idps_figures.php , accessed 23 November 2009

Radio Free Europe/Radio Liberty (RFE/RL), 24 March 2006, Afghanistan: 'Pashtunistan' Issues Linger Behind Afghan-Pakistani Row
Internet : <http://www.rferl.org/featuresarticle/2006/03/a42bd7b4-8f71-46d3-9676-9faab6d745f4.html> , accessed 12 July 2006

Refugees International (RI), 26 October 2009, Protect People First

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/3E4D1135908A742DC125766D0050606C/\\$file/Refugees+International-+26+Oct+2009-+Pakistan,+Protect+People+First.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/3E4D1135908A742DC125766D0050606C/$file/Refugees+International-+26+Oct+2009-+Pakistan,+Protect+People+First.pdf) ,

Refugees International (RI), 24 June 2009, Field Report: Invisible People, Visible Consequences

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/FC04A68E37BDB9BDC12576560045A3B3/\\$file/Refugees+International-+24+June+2009-+Pakistan+Invisible+People,+Visible+consequences.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/FC04A68E37BDB9BDC12576560045A3B3/$file/Refugees+International-+24+June+2009-+Pakistan+Invisible+People,+Visible+consequences.pdf) ,

Reuters AlertNet, 16 October 2009, Aid struggling to reach people fleeing Pakistani fighting

Internet : http://www.alertnet.org/db/an_art/59567/2009/09/16-150514-1.htm , accessed 20 October 2009

Reuters AlertNet, May 2006, Violence escalates on western border

Internet : http://www.alertnet.org/printable.htm?URL=/db/crisisprofiles/PK_VIO.htm , accessed 17 July 2006

Reuters AlertNet, 31 October 2007, Villagers flee conflict-hit Swat

Internet : <http://www.alertnet.org/thenews/newsdesk/IRIN/6287a95fee29132b98e24f412b0e1f51.htm> , accessed 29 April 2008

Shaheen Buneri, 17 November 2007, Fighting displaced thousands in Swat valley

Internet : <http://pashtopoint.blogspot.com/2007/11/pakistan-fighting-displaced-thousands.html> , accessed 29 April 2008

South Asia Analysis Group (SAAG), 17 January 2006, Need to draw US attention to bloodshed in Balochistan, by B. Raman

Internet : <http://www.saag.org/papers17/paper1678.html> , accessed 24 January 2006

Swat Youth Front, May 2009, Appeal for the Humanitarian Assistance to IDPs in NWFP Pakistan

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/6D7AE421B588E156C1257656004C5585/\\$file/Swat+Youth+Front-+May+2009-+Appeal+for+the+Humanitarian+Assistance+to+IDPs+in+NWFP+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/6D7AE421B588E156C1257656004C5585/$file/Swat+Youth+Front-+May+2009-+Appeal+for+the+Humanitarian+Assistance+to+IDPs+in+NWFP+Pakistan.pdf) ,

The Frontier Post, 6 November 2009, UN needs \$201m for Waziristan IDPs Anwer Abbas

Internet : http://209.85.135.132/search?q=cache:v_t8BcSKnfUJ:thefrontierpost.com/News.aspx%3Fncat%3Dts%26nid%3D3044&cd=1&hl=en&ct=clnk&gl=ch&lr=lang_en&client=firefox-a , accessed 13 November 2009

The Nation, 11 October 2007, Option in Waziristan

Internet : <http://www.nation.com.pk/daily/oct-2007/11/columns2.php> , accessed 28 April 2008

The Nation, 16 July 2009, NADRA issues 155,348 cash cards to IDPs

Internet : <http://www.nation.com.pk/pakistan-news-newspaper-daily-english-online/Regional/Islamabad/16-Jul-2009/NADRA-issues-155348-cash-cards-to-IDPs> , accessed 21 October 2009

The News, 18 September 2009, Unexploded mines serious threat to civilians: ICRC

Internet : http://www.thenews.com.pk/daily_detail.asp?id=199152 , accessed 14 October 2009

The News, 25 September 2009, NWFP govt to further activate Nutrition Program
Internet : <http://www.thenews.com.pk/print.asp?id=87611> , accessed 14 October 2009

The News, 10 April 2009, 60 drone hits kill 14 al-Qaeda men, 687 civilians
Internet : http://www.thenews.com.pk/top_story_detail.asp?id=21440 , accessed 16 November 2009

The News, 21 October 2009, UN food centres closed in northwest Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.thenews.com.pk/updates.asp?id=89609> , accessed 16 November 2009

The News, 21 October 2009, Migration from S Waziristan to Bannu continues
Internet : <http://www.thenews.com.pk/updates.asp?id=89614> , accessed 16 November 2009

The News, 21 October 2009, UN World Food Program offices closed in NWFP
Internet : <http://www.thenews.com.pk/updates.asp?id=89621> , accessed 16 November 2009

TIME Magazine, 22 November 2007, Pakistan's Valley of Extremism
Internet : <http://www.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,1687013,00.html> , accessed 23 November 2007

UN News Centre, 28 October 2009, UN rights expert voices concern over use of unmanned drones by United States
Internet : <http://www.un.org/apps/news/story.asp?NewsID=32764&Cr=alston&Cr1=> , accessed 16 November 2009

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 12 October 2009, United Nations mission discusses allocation of Saudi Arabia's \$100 million pledge for Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/EDIS-7WRKB7?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 21 October 2009

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 24 October 2009, United Nations assists tens of thousands of civilians fleeing the conflict in South Waziristan in Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900sid/MYAI-7X62YH?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 13 November 2009

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 3 July 2009, NWFP Displacement Situation Report #7
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/0B664F07C926F99DC125766D004F5E88/\\$file/OCHA+Situation+report+#7-+3+July.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/0B664F07C926F99DC125766D004F5E88/$file/OCHA+Situation+report+#7-+3+July.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 27 November 2009, Pakistan Humanitarian Update, Issue 4
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/0E9698B5E0D5AD9CC1257680003CDD4/\\$file/full_report+OCHA+27+nov.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/0E9698B5E0D5AD9CC1257680003CDD4/$file/full_report+OCHA+27+nov.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 4 September 2009, NWFP Displacement Situation Report #16
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/26D3CA4BE7330E0EC125764E0057A6A4/\\$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+16-+4+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/26D3CA4BE7330E0EC125764E0057A6A4/$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+16-+4+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 17 September 2009, NWFP Displacement Situation Report #18

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/457B318FA5276535C125764E0057DB68/\\$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+18-+17+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/457B318FA5276535C125764E0057DB68/$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+18-+17+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 16 October 2009, Pakistan Humanitarian Update, Issue 1 - 16 October 2009

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/4E13278E1D5A52FBC125765600438E42/\\$file/OCHA-+16+October+2009-+Humanitarian+Update+1.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/4E13278E1D5A52FBC125765600438E42/$file/OCHA-+16+October+2009-+Humanitarian+Update+1.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), October 2009, NWFP Displacement Situation Report #19

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/4E9EC8AEDA39BF26C125766D004FCD6A/\\$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+#19-+1+Oct+2009.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/4E9EC8AEDA39BF26C125766D004FCD6A/$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+#19-+1+Oct+2009.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 5 November 2009, South Waziristan Displacement - Situation Report #3

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/7E7B8597835A7001C125766D004FFC9B/\\$file/OCHA_Situation-report-3_South-Waziristan_5Nov2009.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/7E7B8597835A7001C125766D004FFC9B/$file/OCHA_Situation-report-3_South-Waziristan_5Nov2009.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 19 October 2009, South Waziristan Displacement

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/A90AD97BCCAB5553C125766D004E80CE/\\$file/OCHA-+19+october+2009-+South+Waziristan+displacement.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/A90AD97BCCAB5553C125766D004E80CE/$file/OCHA-+19+october+2009-+South+Waziristan+displacement.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 23 October 2009, South Waziristan Displacement

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/B2796D7C96F452F5C125766D004E9F51/\\$file/OCHA-+23+Oct+2009-+Situation+Report+2-+South+Waziristan+displacement.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/B2796D7C96F452F5C125766D004E9F51/$file/OCHA-+23+Oct+2009-+Situation+Report+2-+South+Waziristan+displacement.pdf) ,

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA), 11 September 2009, NWFP Displacement Situation Report #17

Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/EC6D50927C94D2E7C125764E0057C69B/\\$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+17-+11+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/EC6D50927C94D2E7C125764E0057C69B/$file/OCHA+Situation+Report+17-+11+September+2009+Pakistan.pdf) ,

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), 23 October 2009, UNICEF Pakistan responds to new wave of displaced children and families from South Waziristan

Internet : http://www.unicef.org/infobycountry/media_51520.html , accessed 2 December 2009

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), 29 October 2009, Polio vaccination effort reaches children in Pakistan

Internet : http://www.unicef.org/infobycountry/pakistan_51582.html , accessed 17 November 2009

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), 3 July 2009, Children and women displaced by conflict in Pakistan need urgent and ongoing support

Internet : http://www.unicef.org/pakistan/media_5245.htm , accessed 21 October 2009

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), June 2009, Reaching conflict-affected orphans in Swat Valley

Internet : http://www.unicef.org/pakistan/reallives_5152.htm , accessed 21 October 2009

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), 8 July 2009, In north-west Pakistan, host families welcome the displaced but struggle to cope
Internet : http://www.unicef.org/pakistan/reallives_5264.htm , accessed 21 October 2009

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), 10 August 2009, Children who stayed behind in conflict-affected areas need support
Internet : http://www.unicef.org/pakistan/reallives_5377.htm , accessed 21 October 2009

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), 6 November 2009, Update on IDP operations in north-west Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.reliefweb.int/rw/rwb.nsf/db900SID/JBRN-7XJHNL?OpenDocument&rc=3&cc=pak> , accessed 16 November 2009

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), 6 July 2009, United Arab Emirates and UNHCR sign partnership agreement for operations in Pakistan
Internet : <http://www.unhcr.org/cgi-bin/texis/vtx/search?page=search&docid=4a51f4359> , accessed 14 October 2009

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), 16 October 2009, Pakistani civilians flee to safety amid fears of fresh fighting in Waziristan
Internet : <http://www.unhcr.org/cgi-bin/texis/vtx/search?page=search&docid=4ad88bb66> , accessed 21 October 2009

Voice of America (VOA), 23 January 2008, Pakistan Sends Military Reinforcements to Fight Militants in South Waziristan
Internet : <http://www.voanews.com/english/archive/2008-01/2008-01-23-voa21.cfm?CFID=42671256&CFTOKEN=43513256> , accessed 20 April 2008

World Health Organisation (WHO), 30 October 2009, Health Cluster Pakistan, Weekly Bulletin N°16, Crisis in NWFP
Internet : [http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/\(httpDocuments\)/51D2AF849623EAEAC125767100371A0D/\\$file/WHO-+30+Oct+2009-+Health+Cluster+Pakistan.pdf](http://www.internal-displacement.org/8025708F004CE90B/(httpDocuments)/51D2AF849623EAEAC125767100371A0D/$file/WHO-+30+Oct+2009-+Health+Cluster+Pakistan.pdf) ,